

व्याकरण

BOOK 2 · GRAMMAR WORKBOOK

The Grammar of Everyday Delhi Hindi

*Twenty-four units — every pattern explained, drilled, and answered in
the key.*

JACOB'S DELHI HINDI COURSE

A complete six-month self-study program · Standard Hindi of Delhi (Khari Boli) · 2026

Contents

Before You Start — How to Read Every Entry in This Course	4
Unit 1 — How Hindi Sentences Work	6
Unit 2 — Pronouns & honaa (to be)	15
Unit 3 — Nouns & Gender	24
Unit 4 — Plurals	32
Unit 5 — Possession: kaa, ke, kee & apnaa	41
Unit 6 — Adjectives & Agreement	50
Unit 7 — Postpositions & the Oblique Case	59
Unit 8 — The Present Habitual	69
Unit 9 — The Present Continuous	78
Unit 10 — ko-Constructions: Liking, Wanting, Feeling, Knowing	85
Unit 11 — The Past with था — and Past Habits & Ongoing Past	94
Unit 12 — The Future Tense	102
Unit 13 — Imperatives & Requests	109
Unit 14 — Simple Past & the Ergative ने ne	119
Unit 15 — Perfect Tenses: "has done" & "had done"	129
Unit 16 — Can, Manage, Already Done: सकना · पाना · चुकना	137
Unit 17 — Must & Should: Obligation	145
Unit 18 — If & Maybe: the Subjunctive + अगर...तो agar...to	153
Unit 19 — Compound Verbs — the Flavor System	162
Unit 20 — Joining Ideas & Reported Speech	172
Unit 21 — Relative Clauses: जो...वह	180
Unit 22 — Comparisons & Superlatives	187
Unit 23 — Causatives & Passive (light touch)	194
Unit 24 — The Finishing Touches	202

Answer Key — Unit 1	211
Answer Key — Unit 2	213
Answer Key — Unit 3	215
Answer Key — Unit 4	217
Answer Key — Unit 5	219
Answer Key — Unit 6	221
Answer Key — Unit 7	223
Answer Key — Unit 8	225
Answer Key — Unit 9	227
Answer Key — Unit 10	229
Answer Key — Unit 11	231
Answer Key — Unit 12	233
Answer Key — Unit 13	235
Answer Key — Unit 14	237
Answer Key — Unit 15	239
Answer Key — Unit 16	241
Answer Key — Unit 17	243
Answer Key — Unit 18	245
Answer Key — Unit 19	247
Answer Key — Unit 20	249
Answer Key — Unit 21	251
Answer Key — Unit 22	253
Answer Key — Unit 23	255
Answer Key — Unit 24	257

BEFORE YOU START

How to Read Every Entry in This Course

Every Hindi word and sentence in all of these books appears in **three layers**, always in the same order:

मैं दिल्ली में रहता हूँ।

main dillee mein rehtaa hoon. [meh(n) dil-lee may(n) reh-tah hoo(n)]

I live in Delhi.

Line 1 — Devanagari, the real Hindi script. Even in week 1, let your eyes rest on it before reading the other lines; recognition builds silently. **Line 2 — Roman** (*italics*), Hindi in English letters, spelled the way this course always spells it. **Line 3 — Say it** [in brackets], a phonetic respelling an American can read cold, hyphenated by syllable.

The Roman spelling system (training wheels with rules)

Long vowels doubled	<i>a / aa</i> (अ/आ), <i>i / ee</i> (इ/ई), <i>u / oo</i> (उ/ऊ) — so की is <i>kee</i> , का is <i>kaa</i>
CAPITALS = retroflex	<i>T Th D Dh N R Rh</i> (ट ठ ड ढ ण ढ ढ) — tongue curled back. Lowercase <i>t th d dh n</i> (त थ द ध न) = dental, tongue on the teeth. This is the single most useful habit in this course.
h = puff of air	<i>kh gh chh jh Th Dh th dh ph bh</i> are one sound each, said with extra breath
Urdu-flavored letters	<i>z</i> (ज़), <i>f</i> (फ़), <i>q</i> (क़) — Delhi speech is full of z and f
Nasal vowels	Roman keeps a plain <i>n</i> (<i>haan, mein, hoon</i>); the phonetic line shows the truth with (n): [hah(n)] — air through the nose, tongue touches nothing

Reading the phonetic line

uh	अ, like the a in <i>about</i>	ah	आ, as in <i>father</i>
i / ee	इ as in <i>bit</i> / ई as in <i>feet</i>	u / oo	उ as in <i>put</i> / ऊ as in <i>food</i>
ay	ए, like <i>say</i> but pure — freeze the vowel, no glide at the end	eh	ऐ, like <i>bed</i> held a beat longer (this is the Delhi value — है = [heh])
oh	ओ, like <i>go</i> but pure, no glide	aw	औ, like <i>law</i> with rounded lips (Delhi value — और = [awr])

Doubled consonants are split across the hyphen and genuinely held: दिल्ली [dil-lee] — park your tongue on the l for an extra beat. There are no stress capitals: Hindi syllables are far more even than English; the long vowels carry the weight naturally.

Other marks you'll meet

(m)/(f) after a noun is its gender — always learn it with the word. (vt)/(vi) marks verbs that do/don't take *ne* in the past (a Unit 14 story). (lit. ...) is a word-for-word gloss so you can see the Hindi skeleton. The bar | is the Hindi full stop.

NOTE

Two honest wrinkles, so they never confuse you: (1) written Hindi has वह/यह for he/she/it/this/that, but Delhi mouths say *voh* and *yeh*, and casual writing uses वो/ये freely — you'll see both in this course, exactly as you will in real life. (2) Everyday Delhi Hindi happily uses English words (स्कूल, फ़ोन, मेट्रो, टाइम); that's not "cheating," that's the dialect.

UNIT 1

How Hindi Sentences Work

What you'll be able to say: introduce yourself, name the things around you, ask simple questions and answer them — with every verb landing where Hindi wants it: at the end.

मैं जैकब हूँ।

main Jacob hoon. [meh(n) jay-kub hoo(n)]

I am Jacob. (lit. I Jacob am)

यह चाय है।

yeh chaay hai. [yeh chah-ay heh]

This is chai. (lit. this chai is)

क्या आप ठीक हैं?

kyaa aap Theek hain? [kyah ahp Theek heh(n)]

Are you okay? (lit. what you okay are?)

The one big rule: the verb goes last

English builds sentences *subject - verb - everything else*: “I **am** Jacob.” Hindi keeps the subject first but parks the verb at the very end: *subject - everything else - verb*. Grammar books call this SOV (subject-object-verb) order. You can think of the verb as the caboose: whatever else the train is carrying, the caboose closes it.

In this unit you learn the habit, not the machinery. Every sentence here is a ready-made, high-frequency phrase you can use today. The little words *hoon*, *hai*, *hain* all mean “am / is / are” — Unit 2 sorts out which is which. For now, copy the patterns whole.

Two more everyday chunks, in both speaker versions — Jacob uses the first of each pair; a female speaker uses the second:

मैं दिल्ली में रहता हूँ।

main dillee mein rehtaa hoon. [meh(n) dil-lee may(n) reh-tah hoo(n)]

I live in Delhi. (male speaker) (lit. I Delhi-in living am)

मैं दिल्ली में रहती हूँ।

main dillee mein rehtee hoon. [meh(n) dil-lee may(n) reh-tee hoo(n)]

I live in Delhi. (female speaker)

मैं हिन्दी सीख रहा हूँ।

main hindee seekh rahaa hoon. [meh(n) hin-dee seekh ruh-hah hoo(n)]

I am learning Hindi. (male speaker) (lit. I Hindi learning am)

मैं हिन्दी सीख रही हूँ।

main hindee seekh rahee hoon. [meh(n) hin-dee seekh ruh-hee hoo(n)]

I am learning Hindi. (female speaker)

Now watch the skeletons side by side. The verb slot is marked in bold:

ENGLISH — VERB IN THE MIDDLE	HINDI — VERB AT THE END
I am Jacob.	मैं जैकब हूँ। <i>main Jacob hoon.</i>
This is chai.	यह चाय है। <i>yeh chaay hai.</i>
I live in Delhi.	मैं दिल्ली में रहता हूँ। <i>main dillee mein rehtaa hoon.</i>
I am learning Hindi.	मैं हिन्दी सीख रहा हूँ। <i>main hindee seekh rahaa hoon.</i>

NOTE

Two things Hindi simply doesn't have: the words *a* and *the*. यह चाय है। (*yeh chaay hai.*) covers “This is chai”, “This is a chai”, and “This is the chai”. One worry gone. (Devanagari has no capital letters either.)

WATCH OUT

Don't transplant English word order. Beginners say मैं हूँ जैकब (*main hoon Jacob*) because it mirrors “I am Jacob”. To a Hindi ear that's Yoda-speak. Verb last, always: मैं जैकब हूँ। (*main Jacob hoon.*)

The middle of the sandwich

Subject at the front, verb at the back — everything else (places, “from America”, “in Delhi”) sits in the middle. Notice something curious: Hindi says “Delhi *in*”, “America *from*” — the little relation words come *after* their noun. They're called postpositions, and they get their own unit (Unit 7). For now, swallow these as chunks:

हम अमेरिका से हैं।

ham amerikaa se hain. [hum uh-may-ri-kah say heh(n)]

We are from America. (lit. we America-from are)

मैं दिल्ली में हूँ।

main dillee mein hoon. [meh(n) dil-lee may(n) hoo(n)]

I am in Delhi. (lit. I Delhi-in am)

Dropping “I” — Hindi loves shortcuts

Because *hoon* already means “(I) am”, Hindi happily drops मैं (*main*) in quick answers. This is completely natural speech, not laziness:

आप कैसे हैं?

aap kaise hain? [ahp keh-say heh(n)]

How are you? (asking a man)

आप कैसी हैं?

aap kaisee hain? [ahp keh-see heh(n)]

How are you? (asking a woman)

ठीक हूँ, शुक्रिया।

Theek hoon, shukriyaa. [Theek hoo(n), shuk-ri-yah]

(I'm) fine, thanks. (lit. fine am, thanks)

Yes/no questions: क्या + a rising tune

English flips the verb to ask a question (“This is chai” → “Is this chai?”). Hindi never reshuffles. Take the statement exactly as it is, drop क्या (*kyaa*) [kyah] in front, and let your voice rise at the end — that's the whole trick:

क्या यह चाय है?

kyaa yeh chaay hai? [kyah yeh chah-ay heh]

Is this chai? (lit. what this chai is?)

जी हाँ, यह चाय है।

jee haan, yeh chaay hai. [jee hah(n), yeh chah-ay heh]

Yes, this is chai.

क्या यह कॉफी है?

kyaa yeh kofee hai? [kyah yeh kaw-fee heh]

Is this coffee?

जी नहीं, यह चाय है।

jee naheen, yeh chaay hai. [jee nuh-hee(n), yeh chah-ay heh]

No, it's chai.

DELHI STREET NOTE

How Delhi actually asks. In fast speech the *kyaa* usually vanishes and the rising tune does all the work: आप ठीक हैं? (*aap Theek hain?*) At the chai stall a single word with raised eyebrows is a full sentence: चाय? (*chaay?*) [chah-ay] And agreement comes back with a bounce: हाँ जी! (*haan jee!*) [hah(n) jee] — “yes indeed!”

Question words sit just before the verb

Who/what/where words do *not* jump to the front like in English. They slide into the sentence right before the verb — usually the second-to-last word you say:

यह क्या है?

yeh kyaa hai? [yeh kyah heh]

What is this? (lit. this what is?)

वह कौन है?

voh kaun hai? [voh kawn heh]

Who is that? (lit. that who is?)

बाथरूम कहाँ है?

baathroom kahaan hai? [bahth-room kuh-hah(n) heh]

Where is the bathroom? (lit. bathroom where is?)

NOTE

क्या does double duty. At the *start* of a sentence, *kyaa* is just an audible question mark: क्या यह चाय है? (*kyaa yeh chaay hai?*) “Is this chai?” Right *before the verb*, it means “what”: यह क्या है? (*yeh kyaa hai?*) “What is this?” Position tells you which one you're hearing.

The Hindi full stop

Hindi statements end with a standing bar | called the *purnviraam* — it does exactly what a period does. Questions keep the familiar ?. You'll see both throughout this book; use | whenever you write a Hindi statement.

Frozen phrases — your survival kit

Memorize these as single blocks. They work in any situation from day one, and every one of them quietly obeys the verb-last rule.

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
नमस्ते	<i>namaste</i>	nuh-muhs-tay	hello / goodbye (all-purpose)
जी हाँ	<i>jee haan</i>	jee hah(n)	yes (polite)
जी नहीं	<i>jee naheen</i>	jee nuh-hee(n)	no (polite)
शुक्रिया	<i>shukriyaa</i>	shuk-ri-yah	thanks (everyday)
धन्यवाद	<i>dhanyavaad</i>	dhun-yuh-vahd	thank you (a shade formal)
ठीक है	<i>Theek hai</i>	Theek heh	okay / fine / it's a deal
कोई बात नहीं	<i>koe baat naheen</i>	koh-ee baht nuh-hee(n)	no problem / don't mention it
माफ़ कीजिए	<i>maaf keejiye</i>	mahf kee-ji-yay	excuse me / sorry (polite)
धीरे बोलिए	<i>dheere boliye</i>	dhee-ray boh-li-yay	please speak slowly
मुझे हिन्दी नहीं आती	<i>mujhe hindee naheen aatee</i>	mu-jhay hin-dee nuh-hee(n) ah-tee	I don't know Hindi (yet)
फिर मिलेंगे	<i>phir milenge</i>	phir mi-lay(n)-gay	see you later
और	<i>aur</i>	awr	and
चलो	<i>chalo</i>	chuh-loh	let's go / come on

Words used in this unit

Each noun is tagged (m) or (f). Ignore the tags for now — Unit 3 explains them — but let your eyes get used to seeing them.

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
चाय	<i>chaay</i> (f)	chah-ay	chai, tea
काँफ़ी	<i>koffee</i> (f)	kaw-fee	coffee

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
पानी	<i>paanee</i> (m)	pah-nee	water
खाना	<i>khaanaa</i> (m)	khah-nah	food
बाथरूम	<i>baathroom</i> (m)	bahth-room	bathroom
दिल्ली	<i>dillee</i> (f)	dil-lee	Delhi
हिन्दी	<i>hindiee</i> (f)	hin-dee	Hindi
अमेरिका	<i>amerikaa</i> (m)	uh-may-ri-kah	America

CULTURE

नमस्ते (namaste) [nuh-muhs-tay] with feeling. Palms together at the chest, a small nod — that's the classic greeting, and it works for hello *and* goodbye, for strangers *and* for your partner's grandmother. In many Delhi families, younger people also bend to touch an elder's feet on big occasions; don't panic, just follow your partner's lead. A warm नमस्ते जी (*namaste jee*) [nuh-muhs-tay jee] — with the respect-syllable *jee* — is always safe and always appreciated.

Exercise 1A — Verb at the end

Items 1-5: choose the correct sentence, (a) or (b). Items 6-10: write the missing verb — हूँ (*hoon*), है (*hai*), or हैं (*hain*) — copying from the model sentences in this unit. Answers: Answer Key, Unit 1.

1. (a) मैं जैकब हूँ। (b) मैं हूँ जैकब। (*a: main Jacob hoon. — b: main hoon Jacob.*)

2. (a) यह है चाय। (b) यह चाय है। (*a: yeh hai chaay. — b: yeh chaay hai.*)

3. (a) मैं दिल्ली में रहता हूँ। (b) मैं रहता हूँ दिल्ली में। (*a: main dillee mein rehtaa hoon. — b: main rehtaa hoon dillee mein.*)

4. (a) क्या यह कॉफी है? (b) क्या यह है कॉफी? (*a: kyaa yeh kofee hai? — b: kyaa yeh hai kofee?*)

5. (a) कहाँ बाथरूम है? (b) बाथरूम कहाँ है? (*a: kahaan baathroom hai? — b: baathroom kahaan hai?*)

6. यह चाय ____। (yeh chaay ____.)

7. मैं जैकब ____। (main Jacob ____.)

8. क्या आप ठीक ____? (kyaa aap Theek ____?)

9. हम अमेरिका से ____। (ham amerikaa se ____.)

10. मैं दिल्ली में रहता ____। (main dillee mein rehtaa ____.)

Exercise 1B — Make it a question

Turn each statement into a yes/no question by adding क्या (kyaa) at the front. Do not change the word order. Answers: Answer Key, Unit 1.

1. यह चाय है। (yeh chaay hai.)

2. आप ठीक हैं। (aap Theek hain.)

3. यह पानी है। (yeh paanee hai.)

4. वह राहुल है। (voh Rahul hai. — Rahul is a name)

5. यह खाना है। (yeh khaanaa hai.)

6. आप अमेरिका से हैं। (aap amerikaa se hain.)

7. यह कॉफी है। (*yeh koffee hai.*)

Exercise 1C — Translate into Hindi

Write the Hindi sentence. Devanagari if you can, roman while you're still warming up — one line for each. Answers: Answer Key, Unit 1.

1. I am Jacob. (*use your own name if you like*)

2. This is chai.

3. Is this water?

4. What is this?

5. Where is the bathroom?

6. I am learning Hindi. (*male speaker*)

7. See you later!

Exercise 1D — Translate into English

Write the English meaning. Answers: Answer Key, Unit 1.

1. नमस्ते! आप कैसे हैं? (*namaste! aap kaise hain?*)

2. ठीक हूँ, शुक्रिया। (*Theek hoon, shukriyaa.*)

3. क्या यह चाय है? (*kyaa yeh chaay hai?*)

4. जी नहीं, यह कॉफी है। (*jee naheen, yeh kofee hai.*)

5. मैं दिल्ली में रहता हूँ। (*main dillee mein rehtaa hoon.*)

6. वह कौन है? (*voh kaun hai?*)

UNIT 2

Pronouns & honaa (to be)

What you'll be able to say: who you are, who everyone else is, how you're doing — and all of it with the right level of politeness for the right person.

नमस्ते, मैं जैकब हूँ।

namaste, main Jacob hoon. [nuh-muhs-tay, meh(n) jay-kub hoo(n)]

Hello, I'm Jacob.

आप कैसे हैं?

aap kaise hain? [ahp keh-say heh(n)]

How are you? (respectful, to a man)

तुम कहाँ हो?

tum kahaan ho? [tum kuh-hah(n) hoh]

Where are you? (informal — the classic Delhi phone opener)

Meet होना (honaa) — the verb “to be”

The dictionary form is होना (*honaa*) [hoh-nah], “to be”. In the present it has just four shapes — *hoon*, *hai*, *ho*, *hain* — and each pronoun has claimed its favourite. Learn the pairings as fixed couples; mixing them is the number-one beginner giveaway.

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
मैं हूँ	<i>main hoon</i>	meh(n) hoo(n)	I am
तू है	<i>tu hai</i>	too heh	you are (intimate — handle with care, see below)
तुम हो	<i>tum ho</i>	tum hoh	you are (informal)
आप हैं	<i>aap hain</i>	ahp heh(n)	you are (respectful)
यह है	<i>yeh hai</i>	yeh heh	this / he / she (nearby) is
वह है	<i>voh hai</i>	voh heh	that / he / she is
हम हैं	<i>ham hain</i>	hum heh(n)	we are
ये हैं	<i>ye hain</i>	yay heh(n)	these are; also he/she (nearby, respectful) is
वो लोग हैं	<i>voh log hain</i>	voh loh g heh(n)	they are (people)

NOTE

Spelling vs. sound. वह is *written* that way but everyone says *voh* [voh] — and in texts and WhatsApp Delhiites simply type वो. Same story with यह (*yeh*) [yeh]. Formal written Hindi also has a separate “they” pronoun, वे (*ve*) [vay]; in this course we stick to what Delhi actually says: वो लोग (*voh log*), literally “those people”.

यह vs. वह — near and far

Hindi has no separate word for “he”, “she”, or “it”. Someone or something close by is यह (*yeh*); someone farther away — or just not present — is वह (*voh*). Context does the rest:

यह राहुल है।

yeh Rahul hai. [yeh rah-hul heh]

This is Rahul. (he's right here)

वह नेहा है।

voh Neha hai. [voh nay-hah heh]

That's Neha. (across the room)

The politeness ladder: तू, तुम, आप

English has one “you”; Hindi has three, stacked like rungs. Picking the right rung matters more than any grammar rule in this book:

PRONOUN	USE WITH	VERB PAIRING
तू (<i>tu</i>)	small children, God, childhood-close friends. Intimate — and rude if misjudged. Don't initiate it; just recognize it.	तू है (<i>tu hai</i>)
तुम (<i>tum</i>)	your partner, friends, people your own age you know well	तुम हो (<i>tum ho</i>)
आप (<i>aap</i>)	elders, in-laws (always), strangers, shopkeepers, anyone you've just met	आप हैं (<i>aap hain</i>)

When in doubt, climb up: *aap* never offends. Notice that *aap* takes *hain* — the *plural* verb — even for one person. Speaking of someone respectfully in the third person works the same way: use ये (*ye*) or वो (*voh*) with *hain*:

ये शर्मा जी हैं।

ye Sharma jee hain. [yay shur-mah jee heh(n)]

This is Mr. Sharma. (lit. these Sharma-ji are — plural grammar as respect)

CULTURE

The in-law rule, non-negotiable. With your partner's parents it is *aap* — on day one, in year ten, forever. Between you and your partner, *tum* is the loving default. Delhi guy-friends hammer each other with *tu* constantly and affectionately, but let *them* start it. And sprinkle जी (*jee*) [jee] generously: after names (*Sharma jee*), after yes and no (*jee haan, jee naheen*) — it's the sound of good manners.

WATCH OUT

Don't mix the couples. आप कैसे हो? (*aap kaise ho?*) — you will hear this loose *aap...ho* mix on Delhi streets, and तुम हैं (*tum hain*) is flatly wrong. The standard, always-safe pairings are *tu hai, tum ho, aap hain*. With elders and in-laws, stick to *aap + hain* without exception.

Introducing yourself

Here is the exchange you'll have a hundred times. The chunk आपका नाम (*aapkaa naam*) means “your name” — possessives get their full story in Unit 5; for now it's a fixed phrase.

आपका नाम क्या है?

aapkaa naam kyaa hai? [ahp-kah nahm kyah heh]

What is your name? (lit. your name what is?)

मेरा नाम राहुल है।

meraa naam Rahul hai. [may-rah nahm rah-hul heh]

My name is Rahul.

आप कैसी हैं?

aap kaisee hain? [ahp keh-see heh(n)]

How are you? (respectful, to a woman — kaisee, not kaise)

मैं ठीक हूँ, और आप?

main Theek hoon, aur aap? [meh(n) Theek hoo(n), awr ahp]

I'm fine, and you?

आपसे मिलकर खुशी हुई।

aap se milkar khushee huee. [ahp say mil-kur khu-shee hu-ee]

Pleased to meet you. (fixed phrase — learn it whole)

Between you and your partner it's the *tum* versions — and here both listener-genders matter:

तुम कैसे हो?

tum kaise ho? [tum keh-say hoh]

How are you? (to a man — this is what Jacob hears)

तुम कैसी हो?

tum kaisee ho? [tum keh-see hoh]

How are you? (to a woman — this is what Jacob says back)

मैं अमेरिकन हूँ।

main amerikan hoon. [meh(n) uh-may-ri-kun hoo(n)]

I'm American. (same for male and female speakers)

मैं घर पर हूँ।

main ghar par hoon. [meh(n) ghur pur hoo(n)]

I'm at home. (ghar par = at home — a chunk worth stealing)

Saying “not”: नहीं

नहीं (*naheen*) [nuh-hee(n)] slides in just before the verb — one word, no “do/does” gymnastics:

मैं ठीक नहीं हूँ।

main Theek naheen hoon. [meh(n) Theek nuh-hee(n) hoo(n)]

I'm not okay. (lit. I okay not am)

वह यहाँ नहीं है।

voh yahaan naheen hai. [voh yuh-hah(n) nuh-hee(n) heh]

He/she is not here.

हम दिल्ली से नहीं हैं।

ham dillee se naheen hain. [hum dil-lee say nuh-hee(n) heh(n)]

We are not from Delhi.

NOTE

In snappy replies the verb often disappears after *naheen*: पता नहीं। (*pataa naheen.*) [puh-tah nuh-hee(n)] “No idea.” You already know कोई बात नहीं (*koe baat naheen*) from Unit 1 — same pattern.

Asking “who?” and “what?”

Both question words take the Unit 1 position: just before the verb.

यह क्या है?

yeh kyaa hai? [yeh kyah heh]

What is this?

वह कौन है?

voh kaun hai? [voh kawn heh]

Who is that?

आप कौन हैं?

aap kaun hain? [ahp kawn heh(n)]

Who are you? (polite — say it with a smile at the door)

DELHI STREET NOTE

Street-real greetings. The textbook opener is *aap kaise hain?*; the Delhi opener is क्या हाल है? (*kyaa haal hai?*) [kyah hahl heh] — “how's it going?” Standard replies, in rising order of enthusiasm: ठीक है। (*Theek hai.*) — सब बढ़िया! (*sab baRhiyaa!*) [sub buh-Rhi-yah] “all great!” — एकदम मस्त! (*ekdam mast!*) [ayk-dum must] “totally awesome!” Then bounce it back with और बताओ! (*aur bataao!*) [awr buh-tah-oh] — “so, what else?”

Words used in this unit

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
नाम	<i>naam</i> (m)	nahm	name
घर	<i>ghar</i> (m)	ghur	house, home
दोस्त	<i>dost</i> (m)	dohst	friend (for a female friend, agreement turns feminine — Unit 3)
लोग	<i>log</i> (m)	lohg	people

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
हाल	<i>haal</i> (m)	hahl	state, condition (kyaa haal hai?)
यहाँ	<i>yahaan</i>	yuh-hah(n)	here
वहाँ	<i>vahaan</i>	vuh-hah(n)	there
अमेरिकन	<i>amerikan</i>	uh-may-ri-kun	American (adjective)

Exercise 2A — Fill in the verb

Write the correct present form of honaa: हूँ (hoon), है (hai), हो (ho), or हैं (hain). Answers: Answer Key, Unit 2.

1. मैं जैकब ____। (main Jacob ____.)

2. तुम कहाँ ____? (tum kahaan ____?)

3. आप कैसे ____? (aap kaise ____?)

4. यह चाय ____। (yeh chaay ____.)

5. हम अमेरिका से ____। (ham amerikaa se ____.)

6. वह कौन ____? (voh kaun ____?)

7. ये शर्मा जी ____। (ye Sharma jee ____.)

8. तू कहाँ ____? (tu kahaan ____?)

9. मैं ठीक नहीं ____। (main Theek naheen ____.)

10. वो लोग यहाँ ____। (voh log yahaan ____.)

Exercise 2B — Climb the politeness ladder

These sentences use informal तुम (tum). Rewrite each one for a respected elder, with आप (aap) and its verb. Answers: Answer Key, Unit 2.

1. तुम कैसे हो? (tum kaise ho?)

2. तुम कहाँ हो? (tum kahaan ho?)

3. क्या तुम ठीक हो? (kyaa tum Theek ho?)

4. तुम कौन हो? (tum kaun ho?)

5. क्या तुम दिल्ली से हो? (kyaa tum dillee se ho?)

6. तुम घर पर हो? (tum ghar par ho?)

Exercise 2C — Translate into Hindi

Write the Hindi sentence — Devanagari on one line, roman on the other. Mind the politeness level given in brackets. Answers: Answer Key, Unit 2.

1. Hello! I am Jacob.

2. How are you? (to your mother-in-law)

3. I am fine, and you?

4. Who is she? (she's across the room)

5. This is Mr. Sharma. (respectful)

6. We are from America.

7. He is not here.

Exercise 2D — Translate into English

Write the English meaning. Note who could be speaking, where the item asks. Answers: Answer Key, Unit 2.

1. क्या हाल है? (kyaa haal hai?)

2. सब बढ़िया! (sab baRhiyaa!)

3. आप कौन हैं? (*aap kaun hain?*)

4. वो लोग दिल्ली से हैं। (*voh log dillee se hain.*)

5. तुम ठीक हो? (*tum Theek ho?*)

6. आपसे मिलकर खुशी हुई। (*aap se milkar khushee huee.*)

UNIT 3

Nouns & Gender

What you'll be able to say: nothing new yet — this unit hands you the secret key that makes everything else in Hindi click into place: every noun is either masculine or feminine, and the whole sentence dresses to match.

यह मेरा घर है।

yeh meraa ghar hai. [yeh may-rah ghur heh]

This is my house. (meraa — because ghar is masculine)

यह मेरी गाड़ी है।

yeh merree gaaRee hai. [yeh may-ree gah-Ree heh]

This is my car. (merree — because gaaRee is feminine)

चाय अच्छी है!

chaay achchhee hai! [chah-ay uch-chhee heh]

The chai is good! (achchhee — chaay is feminine too)

Every noun picks a team

In Hindi there is no “it”. Every single noun — table, water, love, Wi-Fi — is grammatically either masculine (**m**) or feminine (**f**). A table is “she”. Water is “he”. This has nothing to do with logic or biology (except for people and animals, where natural gender wins). It's simply each word's team jersey, fixed forever.

Why care? Because Hindi is an agreement language: the words for “my”, “good”, “big”, and most verb forms all change shape to match the gender of the noun they touch. Get the gender right and whole sentences fall into place; get it wrong and everything downstream wobbles. The good news: two rules of thumb cover most nouns, and the exceptions are famous enough to memorize once and keep for life.

Rule of thumb 1: ends in -आ (-aa)? Usually masculine

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
लड़का	<i>laRkaa</i> (m)	luhR-kah	boy
कमरा	<i>kamraa</i> (m)	kum-rah	room
दरवाज़ा	<i>darvaazaa</i> (m)	dur-vah-zah	door

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
केला	<i>kelaa</i> (m)	kay-lah	banana
समोसा	<i>samosaa</i> (m)	suh-moh-sah	samosa
पैसा	<i>paisaa</i> (m)	peh-sah	money, paisa

Rule of thumb 2: ends in -ई (-ee)? Usually feminine

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
लड़की	<i>laRkee</i> (f)	luhR-kee	girl
कुर्सी	<i>kursee</i> (f)	kur-see	chair
सब्ज़ी	<i>sabzee</i> (f)	sub-zee	vegetable(s), veg dish
रोटी	<i>roTee</i> (f)	roh-Tee	roti, flatbread
गाड़ी	<i>gaaRee</i> (f)	gah-Ree	car, vehicle
साड़ी	<i>saaRee</i> (f)	sah-Ree	saree

The famous traitors

A small gang of everyday -ee words defected to the masculine team. They happen to be words you'll use daily, so drill them now:

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
पानी	<i>paanee</i> (m)	pah-nee	water
दही	<i>dahee</i> (m)	duh-hee	yogurt, curd
घी	<i>ghee</i> (m)	ghee	ghee, clarified butter
आदमी	<i>aadmee</i> (m)	ahd-mee	man
हाथी	<i>haathee</i> (m)	hah-thee	elephant

Memory hook: *the kitchen liquids are boys* — *paanee*, *dahee*, *ghee*, all (m). And *aadmee* is a man, so of course he's (m). A couple of -aa words jumped the other way and are feminine: हवा (*havaa* (f)) [huh-vah] “air, wind” and दवा (*davaa* (f)) [duh-vah] “medicine”.

NOTE

People trump endings. Words for male people are (m) and words for female people are (f), no matter how they're spelled. भाई (*bhaaee (m)*) [bhah-ee] “brother” and पिता (*pitaa (m)*) [pi-tah] “father” are masculine because they're men; माँ (*maan (f)*) [mah(n)] “mom”, बहन (*behen (f)*) [beh-hen] “sister”, and औरत (*aurat (f)*) [aw-rut] “woman” are feminine because they're women — no -aa or -ee ending required. One flexible word: दोस्त (*dost*) [dohst] “friend” — it agrees (m) for a male friend and (f) for a female friend: *meraa dost* (he), *merree dost* (she).

The unmarked crowd: no helpful ending

Thousands of nouns end in a consonant or some other vowel and give you no visual clue. Their gender simply has to travel with the word — this is why every noun in this course is tagged (m) or (f):

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
घर	<i>ghar</i> (m)	ghur	house, home
मकान	<i>makaan</i> (m)	muh-kahn	house (the building)
नाम	<i>naam</i> (m)	nahm	name
सेब	<i>seb</i> (m)	sayb	apple
आम	<i>aam</i> (m)	ahm	mango
दिन	<i>din</i> (m)	din	day
हाथ	<i>haath</i> (m)	hahth	hand
काम	<i>kaam</i> (m)	kahm	work
किताब	<i>kitaab</i> (f)	ki-tahb	book
मेज़	<i>mez</i> (f)	mayz	table
चाय	<i>chaay</i> (f)	chah-ay	chai, tea
बात	<i>baat</i> (f)	baht	matter, thing said
चीज़	<i>cheez</i> (f)	cheez	thing
दुकान	<i>dukaan</i> (f)	du-kahn	shop
रात	<i>raat</i> (f)	raht	night

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
आँख	<i>aankh</i> (f)	ah(n)kh	eye

Why gender matters: everything agrees

Here is the payoff, previewed. “My” is मेरा (*meraa*) [may-rah] before a masculine noun and मेरी (*meree*) [may-ree] before a feminine one (full system in Unit 5). Adjectives like *achchhaa* “good” and ठंडा (*ThanDaa*) [Thun-Dah] “cold” do the same dance (Unit 6). Watch the endings flip:

यह मेरा फ़ोन है।

yeh meraa fon hai. [yeh may-rah fohn heh]

This is my phone. (fon m)

यह मेरी मेज़ है।

yeh meree mez hai. [yeh may-ree mayz heh]

This is my table. (mez f)

पानी ठंडा है।

paanee ThanDaa hai. [pah-nee Thun-Dah heh]

The water is cold. (ThanDaa — m form, because paanee is m!)

चाय ठंडी है।

chaay ThanDee hai. [chah-ay Thun-Dee heh]

The chai is cold. (ThanDee — f form for f chaay. Send it back.)

खाना अच्छा है।

khaanaa achchhaa hai. [khah-nah uch-chhah heh]

The food is good. (khaanaa m)

मेरा नाम जैकब है।

meraa naam Jacob hai. [may-rah nahm jay-kub heh]

My name is Jacob. (naam m — now you know why it's meraa naam)

यह मेरा दोस्त राहुल है।

yeh meraa dost Rahul hai. [yeh may-rah dohst rah-hul heh]

This is my friend Rahul. (for a female friend: *yeh meree dost Neha hai*)

मेरी चाय कहाँ है?

meree chaay kahaan hai? [may-ree chah-ay kuh-hah(n) heh]

Where is my chai? (the most important sentence in this unit)

WATCH OUT

The classic trap: trusting the -ee. Learners see *paanee* and *dahee*, think “ends in -ee, must be feminine”, and produce पानी ठंडी है (*paanee ThanDee hai*) — wrong, and instantly heard. The traitors are masculine: पानी ठंडा है। (*paanee ThanDaa hai.*) दही अच्छा है। (*dahee achchhaa hai.*) [duh-hee uch-chhah heh]

DELHI STREET NOTE

English words get jerseys too. Delhi Hindi is full of English nouns, and every one has quietly been assigned a gender: फ़ोन (*fon (m)*) [fohn], टीवी (*Teevee (m)*) [Tee-vee], स्कूल (*skool (m)*) [skool], ऑटो (*auTo (m)*) [aw-Toh], but मेट्रो (*meTro (f)*) [may-Troh], ट्रेन (*Tren (f)*) [Trayn], कॉफी (*kofee (f)*) [kaw-fee]. So a Delhiite shrugs: मेट्रो लेट है। (*meTro leT hai.*) [may-Troh layT heh] — “the metro's late.”

Your strategy from today

NOTE

Never learn a bare noun again — learn it wearing its jersey. The cheapest trick: memorize each noun inside a *meraa/merree* phrase, because you already own those two words. *meraa ghar, meraa paanee, meraa kamraa — merree chaay, merree kitaab, merree gaaRee*. Say the pair out loud once and the gender rides along for free. Every word list and flashcard in this course carries the (m)/(f) tag; treat the tag as part of the word's spelling.

Exercise 3A — Pick the team

Write *m* or *f* for each noun. Answers: Answer Key, Unit 3.

1. लड़का (*laRkaa*)

2. किताब (*kitaab*)

3. पानी (*paanee*)

4. कुर्सी (*kursee*)

5. घर (*ghar*)

6. चाय (*chaay*)

7. समोसा (*samosaa*)

8. गाड़ी (*gaaRee*)

9. आदमी (*aadmee*)

10. मेज़ (*mez*)

Exercise 3B — meraa or meree?

Turn each noun into a “my ...” phrase: write मेरा (*meraa*) or मेरी (*meree*) plus the noun. Watch for traitors. Answers: Answer Key, Unit 3.

1. घर (*ghar*)

2. चाय (*chaay*)

3. फ़ोन (*fon*)

4. किताब (*kitaab*)

5. कमरा (*kamraa*)

6. गाड़ी (*gaaRee*)

7. दही (*dahee*)

8. रोटी (*roTee*)

Exercise 3C — Translate into Hindi

Write the Hindi sentence — Devanagari on one line, roman on the other. Every answer hinges on picking the right gender form. Answers: Answer Key, Unit 3.

1. My name is Jacob.

2. This is my chai.

3. The water is cold.

4. The food is good.

5. This is my house.

6. Where is my book?

Exercise 3D — Translate into English

Write the English meaning. Answers: Answer Key, Unit 3.

1. यह मेरी गाड़ी है। (yeh meree gaaRee hai.)

2. दही ठंडा है। (dahee ThanDaa hai.)

3. मेरी चाय कहाँ है? (meree chaay kahaan hai?)

4. यह मेरा दोस्त राहुल है। (yeh meraa dost Rahul hai.)

5. मेट्रो लेट है। (meTro leT hai.)

UNIT 4

Plurals

What you'll be able to say: more than one of anything — two chais, four samosas, all the books — plus the politest trick in Hindi: making one person grammatically plural to show respect.

एक लड़का, दो लड़के।

ek laRkaa, do laRke. [ayk luhR-kah, doh luhR-kay]

One boy, two boys.

ये मेरी किताबें हैं।

ye meree kitaaben hain. [yay may-ree ki-tah-bay(n) heh(n)]

These are my books.

भैया, दो चाय देना।

bhaiyaa, do chaay denaa. [bheh-yah, doh chah-ay day-nah]

Bhaiya, two chais please. (lit. brother, two chai give)

Four patterns cover everything

How a noun pluralizes depends on two things you now know how to read: its gender (Unit 3) and whether it wears a “marked” ending (-aa for m, -ee for f). That gives exactly four patterns:

NOUN TYPE	SINGULAR	PLURAL	RULE
masculine in -aa	लड़का <i>laRkaa</i> (m) luhR-kah	लड़के <i>laRke</i> luhR-kay	-aa → -e
masculine, everything else	घर <i>ghar</i> (m) ghur	घर <i>ghar</i> ghur	no change at all
feminine in -ee	लड़की <i>laRkee</i> (f) luhR-kee	लड़कियाँ <i>laRkiyaan</i> luhR-ki-yah(n)	-ee → -iyaan
feminine, everything else	किताब <i>kitaab</i> (f) ki-tahb	किताबें <i>kitaaben</i> ki-tah-bay(n)	add -en

Masculine -aa → -e

SINGULAR	PLURAL	SAY THE PLURAL	MEANING
कमरा <i>kamraa</i> (m) kum-rah	कमरे <i>kamre</i>	kum-ray	room → rooms
केला <i>kelaa</i> (m) kay-lah	केले <i>kele</i>	kay-lay	banana → bananas
समोसा <i>samosaa</i> (m) suh-moh-sah	समोसे <i>samose</i>	suh-moh-say	samosa → samosas
बेटा <i>beTaa</i> (m) bay-Tah	बेटे <i>beTe</i>	bay-Tay	son → sons
कुत्ता <i>kuttaa</i> (m) kut-tah	कुत्ते <i>kutte</i>	kut-tay	dog → dogs

NOTE

A few masculine -aa words refuse to change — mostly relationship words and borrowings: पिता (*pitaa* (m)) [pi-tah] “father”, चाचा (*chaachaa* (m)) [chah-chah] “uncle”, राजा (*raajaa* (m)) [rah-jah] “king”, नेता (*netaa* (m)) [nay-tah] “politician”. So: दो चाचा (*do chaachaa*), not “do chaache”.

Masculine unchanged — the verb carries the number

All other masculines — *ghar*, *naam*, *seb*, *fon*, *din*, *dost*, *haath*, and the Unit 3 traitors *aadmee* and *haathee* — look identical in singular and plural. Then how do you know how many?

Listen to the verb:

आदमी यहाँ है।

aadmee yahaan hai. [ahd-mee yuh-hah(n) heh]

The man is here. (hai = one)

आदमी यहाँ हैं।

aadmee yahaan hain. [ahd-mee yuh-hah(n) heh(n)]

The men are here. (hain = more than one — same noun!)

Feminine -ee → -iyaan

SINGULAR	PLURAL	SAY THE PLURAL	MEANING
कुर्सी <i>kursee</i> (f) kur-see	कुर्सियाँ <i>kursiyaan</i>	kur-si-yah(n)	chair → chairs
सब्ज़ी <i>sabzee</i> (f) sub-zee	सब्ज़ियाँ <i>sabziyaan</i>	sub-zi-yah(n)	vegetable → vegetables
रोटी <i>roTee</i> (f) roh-Tee	रोटियाँ <i>roTiyaan</i>	roh-Ti-yah(n)	roti → rotis

SINGULAR	PLURAL	SAY THE PLURAL	MEANING
गाड़ी <i>gaaRee</i> (f) gah-Ree	गाड़ियाँ <i>gaaRiyaan</i>	gah-Ri-yah(n)	car → cars
बेटी <i>beTee</i> (f) bay-Tee	बेटियाँ <i>beTiyaan</i>	bay-Ti-yah(n)	daughter → daughters
साड़ी <i>saaRee</i> (f) sah-Ree	साड़ियाँ <i>saaRiyaan</i>	sah-Ri-yah(n)	saree → sarees

Feminine unmarked: add -एँ (-en)

SINGULAR	PLURAL	SAY THE PLURAL	MEANING
मेज़ <i>mez</i> (f) mayz	मेज़ें <i>mezen</i>	may-zay(n)	table → tables
बात <i>baat</i> (f) baht	बातें <i>baaten</i>	bah-tay(n)	matter → matters, talk
चीज़ <i>cheez</i> (f) cheez	चीज़ें <i>cheezen</i>	chee-zay(n)	thing → things
दुकान <i>dukaan</i> (f) du-kahn	दुकानें <i>dukaanen</i>	du-kah-nay(n)	shop → shops
औरत <i>aurat</i> (f) aw-rut	औरतें <i>auraten</i>	aw-ru-tay(n)	woman → women
बहन <i>behen</i> (f) beh-hen	बहनें <i>behnen</i>	beh-nay(n)	sister → sisters
रात <i>raat</i> (f) raht	रातें <i>raaten</i>	rah-tay(n)	night → nights

Pointing at many: यह → ये, वह → वो

The pointing words pluralize too: nearby यह (*yeh*) becomes ये (*ye*) [yay], and far-away वह (*voh*) becomes वो (*voh*) — which in Delhi speech sounds exactly the same as the singular, so once again the verb does the counting.

यह कमरा है।

yeh kamraa hai. [yeh kum-rah heh]

This is a room.

ये कमरे हैं।

ye kamre hain. [yay kum-ray heh(n)]

These are rooms.

ये समोसे गरम हैं।

ye samose garam hain. [yay suh-moh-say guh-rum heh(n)]

These samosas are hot. (garam = hot — more on adjectives in Unit 6)

मेज़ें यहाँ हैं और कुर्सियाँ वहाँ हैं।

mezen yahaan hain aur kursiyaan vahaan hain. [may-zay(n) yuh-hah(n) heh(n) awr kur-si-yah(n) vuh-hah(n) heh(n)]

The tables are here and the chairs are there.

किताबें मेज़ पर हैं।

kitaaben mez par hain. [ki-tah-bay(n) mayz pur heh(n)]

The books are on the table. (mez par = on the table — chunk; the full “on/in” story is Unit 7)

दो रोटियाँ और एक चाय।

do roTiyaan aur ek chaay. [doh roh-Ti-yah(n) awr ayk chah-ay]

Two rotis and one chai. (a complete, polite order all by itself)

The honorific plural — respect by grammar

Here is the most Indian piece of grammar in this book. To show respect, Hindi treats *one* person as *many*. You've already met it: *aap* takes *hain* even for one listener. The same upgrade applies to anyone respected — parents, in-laws, teachers, elders — whenever you talk *about* them:

पिताजी आ रहे हैं।

pitaajee aa rahe hain. [pi-tah-jee ah ruh-hay heh(n)]

Father is coming. (lit. father coming are — plural out of respect; “aa rahe hain” is a chunk for now)

मम्मी जी आ रही हैं।

mummy jee aa rahee hain. [mum-mee jee ah ruh-hee heh(n)]

Mom is coming. (feminine form keeps its -ee, but the verb still goes plural: hain)

शर्मा जी ठीक हैं।

Sharma jee Theek hain. [shur-mah jee Theek heh(n)]

Sharma-ji is fine. (one man, plural verb — respect)

Using singular *hai* about someone's father isn't just casual — it can sound disrespectful. When in doubt about an elder, go plural.

लोग — people, made explicit

लोग (*log (m)*) [lohg] means “people”, and Delhi bolts it onto pronouns to mean “...and the gang”: हम लोग (*ham log*) “we all”, तुम लोग (*tum log*) “you lot”, आप लोग (*aap log*) “you all (polite)”, वो लोग (*voh log*) “they”.

आप लोग कैसे हैं?

aap log kaise hain? [ahp lohg keh-say heh(n)]

How are you all? (the standard greeting to a room)

हम लोग ठीक हैं।

ham log Theek hain. [hum lohg Theek heh(n)]

We're (all) fine.

Numbers you need right now

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
एक	<i>ek</i>	ayk	one
दो	<i>do</i>	doh	two
तीन	<i>teen</i>	teen	three
चार	<i>chaar</i>	chahr	four

Numbers take the plural noun: दो लड़के (*do laRke*), तीन किताबें (*teen kitaaben*), चार समोसे (*chaar samose*). The full 0–100 lives in Book 3.

WATCH OUT

Two English habits to unlearn. First, no -s, ever: “do samosas” is Hinglish, not Hindi — say दो समोसे (*do samose*). Second, don't force endings onto unchanged masculines: घरेँ (*gharen*) doesn't exist. Two houses are simply दो घर (*do ghar*) — the -en ending belongs to feminine nouns only.

DELHI STREET NOTE

Ordering like a local. At a tea stall nobody says “do chaayen”. Drinks ordered by the cup keep the bare noun: भैया, दो चाय देना। (*bhaiyaa, do chaay denaa.*) — or count the cups: दो कप चाय (*do kap chaay*) [doh kup chah-ay]. That trailing *denaa* is the casual “give (us), would you” — friendly, not bossy. Food still pluralizes normally: चार समोसे देना। (*chaar samose denaa.*)

CULTURE

Everyone is family. भैया (*bhaiyaa (m)*) [bheh-yah] literally means “older brother”, and दीदी (*deedee (f)*) [dee-dee] “older sister” — but in Delhi they're how you warmly address any vendor, auto driver, or shop assistant of roughly your age. Kinship words double as street courtesy; Book 3 hands you the whole set, aunty jee and uncle jee included.

Exercise 4A — Write the plural

Write the plural form (Devanagari and roman). Think: which of the four patterns is this noun?

Answers: Answer Key, Unit 4.

1. लडका (*laRkaa*)

2. किताब (*kitaab*)

3. घर (*ghar*)

4. कुर्सी (*kursee*)

5. समोसा (*samosaa*)

6. औरत (*aurat*)

7. आदमी (*aadmee*)

8. कमरा (*kamraa*)

9. सब्ज़ी (*sabzee*)

10. मेज़ (*mez*)

Exercise 4B — One becomes many

Rewrite each sentence in the plural. Change the pointing word, the noun, and the verb as needed.

Answers: Answer Key, Unit 4.

1. यह लड़का है। (*yeh laRkaa hai.*)

2. यह किताब है। (*yeh kitaab hai.*)

3. वह आदमी है। (*voh aadmee hai.*)

4. यह कुर्सी है। (*yeh kursee hai.*)

5. यह समोसा गरम है। (*yeh samosaa garam hai.*)

6. वह औरत ठीक है। (*voh aurat Theek hai.*)

7. यह मेरी गाड़ी है। (*yeh meree gaaRee hai.*)

Exercise 4C — Translate into Hindi

Write the Hindi sentence — Devanagari on one line, roman on the other. Answers: Answer Key, Unit 4.

1. Bhaiya, two chais please!

2. The boys are here.

3. These are my books.

4. The men are there.

5. Father is coming. (respect!)

6. The books are on the table.

7. How are you all? (polite)

Exercise 4D — Translate into English

Write the English meaning. Watch for honorific plurals — is it really “they”? Answers: Answer Key, Unit 4.

1. ये लड़कियाँ हैं। (*ye laRkiyaan hain.*)

2. दो समोसे और एक चाय, भैया। (*do samose aur ek chaay, bhaiyaa.*)

3. शर्मा जी आ रहे हैं। (*Sharma jee aa rahe hain.*)

4. वो लोग अमेरिका से हैं। (*voh log amerikaa se hain.*)

5. आदमी यहाँ हैं। (*aadmee yahaan hain.*)

6. हम लोग ठीक हैं। (*ham log Theek hain.*)

UNIT 5

Possession: kaa, ke, kee & apnaa

What you'll be able to say: whose everything is — my name, your phone, Rahul's house, my mother-in-law's legendary cooking — with the little linking word dressed to match the right noun.

यह जैकब की किताब है।

yeh Jacob kee kitaab hai. [yeh jay-kub kee ki-tahb heh]

This is Jacob's book.

मेरा नाम जैकब है।

meraa naam Jacob hai. [may-rah nahm jay-kub heh]

My name is Jacob.

ये मेरे ससुर हैं।

ye mere sasur hain. [yay may-ray suh-sur heh(n)]

This is my father-in-law. (plural mere + hain — respect!)

का / के/ की — Hindi's apostrophe-s

To say “X's Y”, Hindi puts a linking word between owner and thing: *owner + kaa/ke/kee + thing*. Now the rule that trips up every English speaker, so read it twice:

The linker agrees with the THING POSSESSED — never with the owner.

THE THING POSSESSED IS...	LINKER	EXAMPLE
masculine, one	का (<i>kaa</i>) kah	राहुल का घर <i>Rahul kaa ghar</i> (m) rah-hul kah ghur — Rahul's house
masculine, many	के (<i>ke</i>) kay	राहुल के जूते <i>Rahul ke joote</i> (m pl) rah-hul kay joo-tay — Rahul's shoes
feminine, one or many	की (<i>kee</i>) kee	राहुल की किताबें <i>Rahul kee kitaaben</i> (f pl) rah-hul kee ki-tah-bay(n) — Rahul's books

So Jacob — very much a man — still says *Jacob kee kitaab*, because *kitaab* is feminine. And Neha's phone takes masculine *kaa*, because *fon* is masculine:

वह नेहा का फ़ोन है।

voh Neha kaa fon hai. [voh nay-hah kah fohn heh]

That is Neha's phone. (kaa matches fon (m), not Neha)

यह पूजा की गाड़ी है।

yeh Pooja kee gaaRee hai. [yeh poo-jah kee gah-Ree heh]

This is Pooja's car.

ये शर्मा जी के बेटे हैं।

ye Sharma jee ke beTe hain. [yay shur-mah jee kay bay-Tay heh(n)]

These are Sharma-ji's sons. (ke — beTe is m plural)

WATCH OUT

Don't match the owner. The instinct is “Pooja is a woman, so... *Pooja kee* everything”. No: पूजा का घर (*Pooja kaa ghar*), because *ghar* is masculine — and जैकब की चाय (*Jacob kee chaay*), because *chaay* is feminine. Eyes on the thing, not the owner.

NOTE

Sharp eyes may protest: signs in Delhi say things like लड़के की किताब (*laRke kee kitaab*) “the boy's book” — why *laRke* and not *laRkaa*? Before a linker like *kaa/ke/kee*, the owner noun slips into a special form called the oblique. That's Unit 7's whole job. Until then, stick to owners that don't change shape: names, *pitaajee*, *bhaaee*, *maan*.

my, your, his, her, our — the full set

Pronoun owners fuse with the linker into one word, and each has the same three shapes: -aa before an m singular, -e before an m plural (and, as you'll see below, for honorifics), -ee before anything feminine.

OWNER	+ M THING	+ M PL THINGS	+ F THING(S)	MEANING
मैं <i>main</i>	मेरा <i>meraa</i> may-rah	मेरे <i>mere</i> may-ray	मेरी <i>merree</i> may-ree	my
तू <i>tu</i>	तेरा <i>teraa</i> tay-rah	तेरे <i>tere</i> tay-ray	तेरी <i>teree</i> tay-ree	your (intimate — same cautions as tu)
तुम <i>tum</i>	तुम्हारा <i>tumhaaraa</i> tum-hah-rah	तुम्हारे <i>tumhaare</i> tum-hah-ray	तुम्हारी <i>tumhaaree</i> tum-hah-ree	your (informal)

OWNER	+ M THING	+ M PL THINGS	+ F THING(S)	MEANING
आप <i>aap</i>	आपका <i>aapkaa</i> ahp-kah	आपके <i>aapke</i> ahp-kay	आपकी <i>aapkee</i> ahp-kee	your (respectful)
यह <i>yeh</i>	इसका <i>iskaa</i> is-kah	इसके <i>iske</i> is-kay	इसकी <i>iskee</i> is-kee	his / her / its (nearby)
वह <i>voh</i>	उसका <i>uskaa</i> us-kah	उसके <i>uske</i> us-kay	उसकी <i>uskee</i> us-kee	his / her / its
हम <i>ham</i>	हमारा <i>hamaaraa</i> huh-mah-rah	हमारे <i>hamaare</i> huh-mah-ray	हमारी <i>hamaaree</i> huh-mah-ree	our
वो लोग <i>voh log</i>	उनका <i>unkaa</i> un-kah	उनके <i>unke</i> un-kay	उनकी <i>unkee</i> un-kee	their — and his/her for one respected person

Note the last row: just as respected people get plural verbs (Unit 4), they get the plural possessive. Talking about your father-in-law's car? उनकी गाड़ी (*unkee gaaRee*), not *uskee* — *uskaa/uskee* about an elder sounds blunt.

आपका नाम क्या है?

aapkaa naam kyaa hai? [ahp-kah nahm kyah heh]

What is your name? (Unit 2's chunk — now fully decoded: naam is m, so aapkaa)

तुम्हारा फ़ोन कहाँ है?

tumhaaraa fon kahaan hai? [tum-hah-rah fohn kuh-hah(n) heh]

Where is your phone? (to your partner)

हमारा घर दिल्ली में है।

hamaaraa ghar dillee mein hai. [huh-mah-rah ghur dil-lee may(n) heh]

Our house is in Delhi.

उसकी गाड़ी यहाँ है।

uskee gaaRee yahaan hai. [us-kee gah-Ree yuh-hah(n) heh]

His car is here. — or her car; uskee only marks the car's gender.

उनका नाम अमित शर्मा है।

unkaa naam Amit Sharma hai. [un-kah nahm uh-mit shur-mah heh]

His name is Amit Sharma. (unkaa — speaking respectfully of one man)

Family words — where possession lives

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
माँ	<i>maan</i> (f)	mah(n)	mom, mother
पिताजी	<i>pitaajee</i> (m)	pi-tah-jee	father (respectful)
भाई	<i>bhaaee</i> (m)	bhah-ee	brother
बहन	<i>behen</i> (f)	beh-hen	sister
दीदी	<i>deedee</i> (f)	dee-dee	older sister
पति	<i>pati</i> (m)	puh-ti	husband
पत्नी	<i>patnee</i> (f)	put-nee	wife
सास	<i>saas</i> (f)	sahs	mother-in-law
ससुर	<i>sasur</i> (m)	suh-sur	father-in-law
बेटा	<i>beTaa</i> (m)	bay-Tah	son
बेटी	<i>beTee</i> (f)	bay-Tee	daughter

Here the honorific plural (Unit 4) meets possession, and it's worth engraving: for elders you respect, the possessive goes plural even for one person — *mere sasur*, *mere pitaajee* — and the feminine form, being identical in singular and plural, just takes the plural verb:

ये मेरी सास हैं।

ye meree saas hain. [yay may-ree sahs heh(n)]

This is my mother-in-law. (meree + hain)

ये मेरे ससुर हैं।

ye mere sasur hain. [yay may-ray suh-sur heh(n)]

This is my father-in-law. (mere, never meraa — the plural IS the respect)

मेरे पिताजी दिल्ली में रहते हैं।

mere pitaajee dillee mein rehte hain. [may-ray pi-tah-jee dil-lee may(n) reh-tay heh(n)]

My father lives in Delhi. (“rehte hain” — the respectful-plural chunk of rehnaa)

यह मेरी पत्नी है।

yeh meree patnee hai. [yeh may-ree put-nee heh]

This is my wife.

मेरी सास का खाना बहुत अच्छा है।

meree saas kaa khaanaa bahut achchhaa hai. [may-ree sahs kah khah-nah bo-hut uch-chhah heh]

My mother-in-law's food is very good. (chains happily: meree saas → kaa khaanaa, each linker matching its own noun)

CULTURE

In-law etiquette, Delhi edition. *saas* and *sasur* are words you use *about* your in-laws, never to their faces. To their faces, most Delhi households run on मम्मी जी (*mummy jee*) [mum-mee jee] and पापा जी (*paapaa jee*) [pah-pah jee] — yes, you call them Mom and Dad too, and it delights them. Always *aap*, always plural forms, and praising the *khaanaa* is the fastest route to their hearts.

अपना — one's own

अपना (*apnaa*) [up-nah] is a special possessive meaning “belonging to whoever the subject is”. Rule of thumb: when the owner IS the subject of the sentence, Hindi swaps *meraa/tumhaaraa/uskaa...* for *apnaa* (which agrees the usual way: *apnaa/apne/apnee* [up-nah / up-nay / up-nee]). The verbs below are chunks from Unit 1's pattern — the machinery arrives in Unit 9:

मैं अपना खाना खा रहा हूँ।

main apnaa khaanaa khaa rahaa hoon. [meh(n) up-nah khah-nah khah ruh-hah hoo(n)]

I'm eating my (own) food. (male speaker; female: *khaa rahee hoon*)

वह अपनी चाय पी रहा है।

voh apnee chaay pee rahaa hai. [voh up-nee chah-ay pee ruh-hah heh]

He's drinking his own chai. (a woman: *pee rahee hai*)

वह उसकी चाय पी रहा है।

voh uskee chaay pee rahaa hai. [voh us-kee chah-ay pee ruh-hah heh]

He's drinking HIS chai — somebody else's! (*uskee* = another person's; *apnee* = his own. One word saves a friendship.)

अपना ख्याल रखना।

apnaa khyaal rakhnaa. [up-nah khyahl rukh-nah]

Take care of yourself. (the classic sign-off — steal it for texts today)

With plain *hona* sentences like यह मेरा घर है you don't need *apnaa* at all — it earns its keep once sentences have action verbs. File the idea now, use it fully from Unit 8 onward.

WATCH OUT

The double-my error. English says “I'm eating my food”, so learners produce मैं मेरा खाना खा रहा हूँ (*main meraa khaanaa...*) — instantly foreign. When the subject owns it, it's *apnaa*: मैं अपना खाना खा रहा हूँ। (*main apnaa khaanaa khaa rahaa hoon.*)

DELHI STREET NOTE

Possession, Delhi-style. English nouns slide right into the pattern: आपका नंबर क्या है? (*aapkaa nambar kyaa hai?*) [ahp-kah num-bur kyah heh] “what's your (phone) number?” — the polite way to stay in touch. And everyone's relatives are फ़ैमिली (*faimilee (f)*) [feh-mi-lee]: आपकी फ़ैमिली कैसी है? (*aapkee faimilee kaisee hai?*) “how's your family?” — small talk gold at any Delhi gathering.

Exercise 5A — kaa, ke, or kee?

Fill in का (*kaa*), के (*ke*), or की (*kee*). The bracketed hint tells you what the thing is. Answers: Answer Key, Unit 5.

1. जैकब ___ किताब (*Jacob ___ kitaab — Jacob's book*)

2. राहुल ___ घर (*Rahul ___ ghar — Rahul's house*)

3. नेहा ___ फ़ोन (*Neha ___ fon — Neha's phone*)

4. पूजा ___ गाड़ी (*Pooja ___ gaaRee — Pooja's car*)

5. शर्मा जी ___ बेटे (*Sharma jee ___ beTe — Sharma-ji's sons*)

6. मेरी सास ___ खाना (*meree saas ___ khaanaa — my mother-in-law's food*)

7. भाई ___ कुर्सी (*bhaaee ___ kursee — brother's chair*)

8. पिताजी ___ फ़ोन (*pitaajee ___ fon — father's phone*)

9. अमित ___ किताबें (*Amit ___ kitaaben — Amit's books*)

10. दीदी ___ जूते (*deedee ___ joote — older sister's shoes*)

Exercise 5B — Build the possessive

Combine the pronoun with the noun: write the correct possessive plus the noun, e.g. (मैं) + चाय → मेरी चाय. Watch item 6! Answers: Answer Key, Unit 5.

1. (मैं) + किताब ((*main*) + *kitaab*)

2. (आप) + घर ((*aap*) + *ghar*)

3. (तुम) + फ़ोन ((*tum*) + *fon*)

4. (हम) + बेटी ((*ham*) + *beTee*)

5. (वह) + गाड़ी ((*voh*) + *gaaRee*)

6. (मैं) + ससुर ((*main*) + *sasur* — careful: respect!)

7. (आप) + किताबें ((*aap*) + *kitaaben*)

Exercise 5C — Translate into Hindi

Write the Hindi sentence — Devanagari on one line, roman on the other. Answers: Answer Key, Unit 5.

1. My name is Jacob.

2. What is your name? (respectful)

3. This is my wife.

4. This is my father-in-law. (respect!)

5. Where is your phone? (to your partner)

6. Our house is in Delhi.

7. Rahul's car is here.

Exercise 5D — Translate into English

Write the English meaning. Watch for honorific plurals and for apnaa. Answers: Answer Key, Unit 5.

1. आपका घर कहाँ है? (*aapkaa ghar kahaan hai?*)

2. ये मेरी सास हैं। (*ye merree saas hain.*)

3. मेरी सास का खाना बहुत अच्छा है। (*merree saas kaa khaanaa bahut achchhaa hai.*)

4. यह उसका फ़ोन नहीं है। (*yeh uskaa fon naheen hai.*)

5. अपना ख्याल रखना! (*apnaa khyaal rakhnaa!*)

6. तुम्हारी चाय कहाँ है? (*tumhaaree chaay kahaan hai?*)

UNIT 6

Adjectives & Agreement

What you'll be able to say: what things are like — good, big, hot, new, red — with the endings dancing in step with gender and number, plus the question that fishes for compliments: *kaisaa*?

खाना बहुत अच्छा है!

khaanaa bahut achchhaa hai! [khah-nah bo-hut uch-chhah eh]

The food is very good! (your most useful sentence at any Delhi table)

चाय अच्छी है।

chaay achchhee hai. [chah-ay uch-chhee eh]

The chai is good. (same adjective, feminine dress)

दिल्ली बड़ी है!

dillee baRee hai! [dil-lee buh-Ree eh]

Delhi is big! (dillee is f, so baRee)

Two teams of adjectives

Hindi adjectives split into two teams, and the split is easy to see. **Marked** adjectives end in -aa and change their ending to agree, exactly like *meraa/mere/merree* did in Unit 5.

Unmarked adjectives end in anything else and never change at all — one shape, every situation.

Here is the whole marked pattern, using *achchhaa* “good”:

GOES WITH...	FORM	SAY IT	EXAMPLE
m singular	अच्छा <i>achchhaa</i>	uch-chhah	अच्छा लड़का <i>achchhaa laRkaa</i> (m) uch-chhah luhR-kah — good boy
m plural (and honorifics)	अच्छे <i>achchhe</i>	uch-chhay	अच्छे लड़के <i>achchhe laRke</i> uch-chhay luhR-kay — good boys
f singular and plural	अच्छी <i>achchhee</i>	uch-chhee	अच्छी लड़कियाँ <i>achchhee laRkiyaan</i> (f) uch-chhee luhR-ki-yah(n) — good girls

One elegant detail: with unchanging masculine nouns, the adjective is what shows the plural — बड़ा घर (*baRaa ghar*) [buh-Rah ghur] “big house” but बड़े घर (*baRe ghar*) [buh-Ray ghur] “big houses”.

The marked team (-aa, they agree)

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
अच्छा	<i>achchhaa</i>	uch-chhah	good
बड़ा	<i>baRaa</i>	buh-Rah	big
छोटा	<i>chhoTaa</i>	chhoh-Tah	small
लंबा	<i>lambaa</i>	lum-bah	tall, long
मोटा	<i>moTaa</i>	moh-Tah	fat, thick
नया	<i>nayaa</i>	nuh-yah	new (irregular spelling: m pl नए naye, f नई nayee)
पुराना	<i>puraanaa</i>	pu-rah-nah	old (for things)
ठंडा	<i>ThanDaa</i>	Thun-Dah	cold
मीठा	<i>meeThaa</i>	mee-Thah	sweet
सस्ता	<i>sastaa</i>	sus-tah	cheap
महंगा	<i>mehngaa</i>	mehn-gah	expensive

The unmarked team (one shape, zero fuss)

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
लाल	<i>laal</i>	lahl	red
साफ़	<i>saaf</i>	sahf	clean
सुंदर	<i>sundar</i>	sun-dur	beautiful
खूबसूरत	<i>khoobsoorat</i>	khoob-soo-rut	gorgeous
गरीब	<i>gareeb</i>	guh-reeb	poor
अमीर	<i>ameer</i>	uh-meer	rich
गरम	<i>garam</i>	guh-rum	hot, warm
खराब	<i>kharaab</i>	khuh-rahb	bad, broken
खुश	<i>khush</i>	khush	happy
आसान	<i>aasaan</i>	ah-sahn	easy

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
मुश्किल	<i>mushkil</i>	mush-kil	difficult
मज़ेदार	<i>mazedaar</i>	muh-zay-dahr	tasty, fun

So: लाल किताब (*laal kitaab*), लाल किताबें (*laal kitaaben*), सुंदर लड़की (*sundar laRkee*), साफ़ कमरा (*saaf kamraa*) — the adjective never blinks.

Agreement in action

यह कमरा साफ़ है।

yeh kamraa saaf hai. [yeh kum-rah sah-f heh]

This room is clean.

चाय गरम है और समोसे भी गरम हैं।

chaay garam hai aur samose bhee garam hain. [chah-ay guh-rum heh awr suh-moh-say bhee guh-rum heh(n)]

The chai is hot and the samosas are hot too. (bhee = also; garam never changes)

लड़के लंबे हैं।

laRke lambe hain. [luhR-kay lum-bay heh(n)]

The boys are tall.

मेरी गाड़ी नई नहीं है, पुरानी है।

merree gaaRee nayee naheen hai, puraanee hai. [may-ree gah-Ree nuh-ee nuh-hee(n) heh, pu-rah-nee heh]

My car isn't new, it's old.

ऑटो महंगा है, मेट्रो सस्ती है।

auTo mehngaa hai, meTro saste hai. [aw-Toh mehn-gah heh, may-Troh sus-tee heh]

The auto is expensive, the metro is cheap. (a very Delhi observation)

मेरे ससुर बहुत अच्छे हैं।

mere sasur bahut achchhe hain. [may-ray suh-sur bo-hut uch-chhay heh(n)]

My father-in-law is very nice. (honorific plural pulls the adjective plural too: achchhe)

मेरी सास बहुत अच्छी हैं।

merree saas bahut achchhee hain. [may-ree sahs bo-hut uch-chhee heh(n)]

My mother-in-law is very nice. (feminine keeps achchhee; the respect shows in hain)

Before the noun or before the verb — same agreement

An adjective can sit attributively (right before its noun) or predicatively (across the verb “is”). Either way it agrees with the same noun:

यह अच्छी किताब है।

yeh achchhee kitaab hai. [yeh uch-chhee ki-tahb heh]

This is a good book. (attributive: achchhee kitaab)

यह किताब अच्छी है।

yeh kitaab achchhee hai. [yeh ki-tahb uch-chhee heh]

This book is good. (predicative: same achchhee)

He says, she says — speaker gender

When the adjective describes *you*, your own gender picks the form. Jacob uses masculine forms; his partner uses feminine ones; and unmarked adjectives shrug at the whole question:

मैं अच्छा हूँ।

main achchhaa hoon. [meh(n) uch-chhah hoo(n)]

I'm good. (male speaker — Jacob's line)

मैं अच्छी हूँ।

main achchhee hoon. [meh(n) uch-chhee hoo(n)]

I'm good. (female speaker — his partner's line)

मैं बहुत खुश हूँ।

main bahut khush hoon. [meh(n) bo-hut khush hoo(n)]

I'm very happy. (khush is unmarked — one line for everyone)

Asking “what's it like?” — kaisaa

कैसा (*kaisaa*) [keh-sah] “how / what like” is itself a marked adjective, so it agrees with whatever you're asking about: *kaisaa* / *kaise* / *kaisee* [keh-sah / keh-say / keh-see]. And now Unit 2's greeting decodes itself: आप कैसे हैं? (*aap kaise hain?*) is literally “you how are?” with *kaise* in the honorific plural — *kaisee* when asking a woman.

खाना कैसा है?

khaanaa kaisaa hai? [khah-nah keh-sah heh]

How's the food?

चाय कैसी है? — एकदम बढ़िया!

chaay kaisee hai? — ekdam baRhiyaa! [chah-ay keh-see heh — ayk-dum buh-Rhi-yah]

How's the chai? — Absolutely first-rate!

The -saa softener: chhoTaa-saa

Bolt -सा (-saa) [sah] onto an adjective and it softens: “-ish, kind of, a cute little”. It agrees just like -aa adjectives (-saa/-se/-see): छोटा-सा घर (*chhoTaa-saa ghar*) “a cute little house”, प्यारा-सा (*pyaaraa-saa*) [pyah-rah sah] “adorable little”, थोड़ा-सा खाना (*thoRaa-saa khaanaa*) [thoh-Rah sah khah-nah] “just a little food”:

थोड़ी-सी चाय, बस।

thoRee-see chaay, bas. [thoh-Ree see chah-ay, bus]

Just a little chai, that's all. (the polite second-cup surrender)

Colors — a preview

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
लाल	<i>laal</i>	lahl	red — never changes
पीला	<i>peelaa</i>	pee-lah	yellow — marked: peelee, peelee
नीला	<i>neelaa</i>	nee-lah	blue — marked
हरा	<i>haraa</i>	huh-rah	green — marked
काला	<i>kaalaa</i>	kah-lah	black — marked
सफ़ेद	<i>safed</i>	suh-fayd	white — never changes
गुलाबी	<i>gulaabee</i>	gu-lah-bee	pink — never changes (-ee adjectives are invariable)

केले पीले हैं।

kele peelee hain. [kay-lay pee-lay heh(n)]

The bananas are yellow.

मेरी कमीज़ सफ़ेद है।

meree kameez safed hai. [may-ree kuh-meez suh-fayd heh]

My shirt is white. (kameez (f) = shirt; safed stays safed)

NOTE

Impostors on both teams. बढ़िया (*baRhiyaa*) [buh-Rhi-yah] “first-rate” ends in -aa but never changes: *baRhiyaa chaay*, *baRhiyaa samose*. Adjectives ending in -ee, like *gulaabee*, are likewise invariable. The vocab chapters in Book 3 flag every invariable adjective, so you never have to guess.

WATCH OUT

Two agreement slips to avoid. First, feminine nouns with masculine endings: चाय अच्छा है (*chaay achchhaa hai*) is wrong — चाय अच्छी है। (*chaay achchhee hai*.) Second, don't “feminize” unmarked adjectives: there is no *laalee* or *sundaree* — it's लाल साड़ी (*laal saaRee*) and सुंदर लड़की (*sundar laRkee*). Only the -aa team changes clothes.

DELHI STREET NOTE

Delhi's favourite compliments. Forget plain *achchhaa* — the street superlatives are मस्त (*mast*) [must] “awesome”, ज़बरदस्त (*zabardast*) [zuh-bur-dust] “tremendous”, and the intensifier एकदम (*ekdam*) [ayk-dum] “totally”. All conveniently invariable: चाय एकदम मस्त है! (*chaay ekdam mast hai!*) — फ़िल्म ज़बरदस्त है! (*film zabardast hai!*) [film zuh-bur-dust heh] (फ़िल्म film (f) = movie).

CULTURE

Colors carry meaning. *laal* is the color of weddings and good luck — brides traditionally wear red, and a लाल साड़ी (*laal saaRee*) is festive dress, while plain white clothing is traditionally linked with mourning. Complimenting an outfit? बहुत सुंदर! (*bahut sundar!*) [bo-hut sun-dur] works every time. More on festival colors when होली (*holee*) [hoh-lee] — the festival of colors itself — shows up in Book 3.

Exercise 6A — Dress the adjective

Write the correct form of the adjective in brackets. Careful — some never change! Answers: Answer Key, Unit 6.

1. ___ लड़का (*achchhaa + laRkaa*)

2. ___ चाय (*achchhaa + chaay*)

3. ___ घर (*baRaa + ghar*)

4. ___ लड़कियाँ (*achchhaa + laRkiyaan*)

5. ___ कमरे (*chhoTaa + kamre*)

6. ___ साड़ी (*laal + saaRee*)

7. ___ पानी (*ThanDaa + paanee*)

8. ___ गाड़ी (*nayaa + gaaRee*)

9. ___ समोसे (*garam + samose*)

10. ___ मेज़ें (*puraanaa + mezen*)

Exercise 6B — Swap the noun, fix the fit

Rewrite the whole phrase with the new noun in brackets, adjusting the adjective if needed. Answers:
Answer Key, Unit 6.

1. अच्छा लड़का → (लड़की) (*achchhaa laRkaa → laRkee*)

2. बड़ा कमरा → (कमरे) (*baRaa kamraa → kamre*)

3. लंबा लड़का → (लड़की) (*lambaa laRkaa → laRkee*)

4. नया फ़ोन → (गाड़ी) (*nayaa fon → gaaRee*)

5. छोटी किताब → (किताबें) (*chhoTee kitaab → kitaaben*)

6. मोटा कुत्ता → (कुत्ते) (*moTaa kuttaa → kutte*)

7. सफ़ेद कमीज़ → (कमीज़ें) (*safed kameez → kameezen*)

Exercise 6C — Translate into Hindi

Write the Hindi sentence — Devanagari on one line, roman on the other. Item 7 wants both speaker versions. Answers: Answer Key, Unit 6.

1. The chai is hot.

2. The water is cold.

3. This is a good book.

4. My house is small.

5. The boys are tall.

6. How is the food?

7. I am good. (male speaker AND female speaker)

Exercise 6D — Translate into English

Write the English meaning. Answers: Answer Key, Unit 6.

1. चाय बहुत अच्छी है। (*chaay bahut achchhee hai.*)

2. यह कमरा साफ़ नहीं है। (*yeh kamraa saaf naheen hai.*)

3. मेरी गाड़ी नई नहीं है, पुरानी है। (*meree gaaRee nayee naheen hai, puraanee hai.*)

4. ऑटो महंगा है, मेट्रो सस्ती है। (*auTo mehngaa hai, meTro saste hai.*)

5. थोड़ी-सी चाय, बस। (*thoRee-see chaay, bas.*)

6. मेरे ससुर बहुत अच्छे हैं। (*mere sasur bahut achchhe hain.*)

UNIT 7

Postpositions & the Oblique Case

What you'll be able to say: where things and people are (in, on, under, behind...), who something is for, who you're with — and "I have...". This is the hinge unit of the whole book: master it and Units 8–24 open up.

मैं दिल्ली में रहता हूँ।

main dillee mein rehtaa hoon. [meh(n) dil-lee may(n) reh-tah hoo(n)]

I live in Delhi. (lit. I Delhi-in living am)

मेरे पास दो टिकट हैं।

mere paas do TikaT hain. [may-ray pahs doh Ti-kuT heh(n)]

I have two tickets. (lit. my near two tickets are)

यह तोहफ़ा तुम्हारे लिए है।

yeh tohfaa tumhaare liye hai. [yeh toh-fah tum-hah-ray li-yeh heh]

This gift is for you. (lit. this gift your-for is)

Postpositions: little words that come AFTER

English puts its little relation words *before* the noun: *in Delhi, on the table, for you*. Hindi puts them *after* — that's why they're called **post**positions: दिल्ली में (*dillee mein*) [dil-lee may(n)], मेज़ पर (*mez par*) [mayz pur]. First learn the words themselves; then the one big rule about what they do to the noun in front of them.

The simple postpositions

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
में	<i>mein</i>	may(n)	in, inside
पर	<i>par</i>	pur	on, at
से	<i>se</i>	say	from; by (a vehicle/tool); with (a person you talk to)
को	<i>ko</i>	koh	to (a person); "to-me" phrases (star of Unit 10)
तक	<i>tak</i>	tuk	until, up to, as far as
का / के / की	<i>kaa / ke / kee</i>	kah / kay / kee	's (possessive — yes, it's a postposition too!)

The compound postpositions (के+ word)

These are two-word postpositions built on के (*ke*) [kay] — one is built on से (*se*). Learn them as fixed chunks.

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
के लिए	<i>ke liye</i>	kay li-yay	for
के पास	<i>ke paas</i>	kay pahs	near; "have" (see below)
के साथ	<i>ke saath</i>	kay sahth	with, together with
के बाद	<i>ke baad</i>	kay bahd	after
से पहले	<i>se pehle</i>	say peh-lay	before
के सामने	<i>ke saamne</i>	kay sahm-nay	in front of, opposite
के पीछे	<i>ke peechhe</i>	kay pee-chhay	behind
के ऊपर	<i>ke oopar</i>	kay oo-pur	above, on top of
के नीचे	<i>ke neeche</i>	kay nee-chay	under, below
के अंदर	<i>ke andar</i>	kay un-dur	inside
के बाहर	<i>ke baahar</i>	kay bah-hur	outside

NOTE

पर (*par*) [pur] = *on* (touching): किताब मेज़ पर है (*kitaab mez par hai*) [ki-tahb mayz pur heh] — the book is on the table. के ऊपर (*ke oopar*) = *above* (in the air over it): मेज़ के ऊपर पंखा है (*mez ke oopar pankhaa hai*) [mayz kay oo-pur pun-khah heh] — above the table there's a fan.

The oblique case: nouns change before a postposition

Here is the big rule. **Before any postposition, the noun switches from its normal (direct) form to its oblique form.** The changes are small and regular:

NOUN TYPE	DIRECT SG	OBLIQUE SG	DIRECT PL	OBLIQUE PL
m ending in -aa	लड़का <i>laRkaa</i>	लड़के <i>laRke</i>	लड़के <i>laRke</i>	लड़कों <i>laRkon</i>
m, other endings	घर <i>ghar</i>	घर <i>ghar</i>	घर <i>ghar</i>	घरों <i>gharon</i>

NOUN TYPE	DIRECT SG	OBLIQUE SG	DIRECT PL	OBLIQUE PL
m ending in -ee	आदमी <i>aadmee</i>	आदमी <i>aadmee</i>	आदमी <i>aadmee</i>	आदमियों <i>aadmiyon</i>
f ending in -ee	लड़की <i>laRkee</i>	लड़की <i>laRkee</i>	लड़कियाँ <i>laRkiyaan</i>	लड़कियों <i>laRkiyon</i>
f, other endings	किताब <i>kitaab</i>	किताब <i>kitaab</i>	किताबें <i>kitaaben</i>	किताबों <i>kitaabon</i>

In words: masculine -aa becomes -e in the singular (लड़का → लड़के को *laRke ko* [luhR-kay koh]); every plural of every gender ends in -े(-on) [oh(n)] before a postposition (लड़कों को *laRkon ko* [luhR-koh(n) koh], घरों में *gharon mein* [ghuh-roh(n) may(n)], लड़कियों को *laRkiyon ko* [luhR-ki-yoh(n) koh]). Feminine singulars never change. Masculine nouns not in -aa (घर, दोस्त *dost* [dohst]) don't change in the singular either.

NOTE

Yes — oblique singular लड़के looks exactly like direct plural लड़के ("boys"). The postposition is your clue: लड़के अच्छे हैं (*laRke achchhe hain*) [luhR-kay uch-chhay heh(n)] "the boys are good" (plural, no postposition) vs. लड़के का नाम (*laRke kaa naam*) [luhR-kay kah nahm] "the boy's name" (singular + postposition). This is also why Unit 5's possessive phrases already used लड़के का — का is a postposition, so the noun before it went oblique all along.

Adjectives (and मेरा, यह, वह) go oblique too

Everything hanging on the noun matches it. An -aa adjective becomes -e before an oblique masculine noun — singular *and* plural. Feminine adjectives in -ee stay put. यह/वह have their own oblique forms: इस (*is*) [is] and उस (*us*) [us]; plural ये → इन (*in*), वे → उन (*un*).

DIRECT PHRASE	OBLIQUE (BEFORE POSTPOSITION)
अच्छा लड़का <i>achchhaa laRkaa</i>	अच्छे लड़के को <i>achchhe laRke ko</i>
अच्छे लड़के <i>achchhe laRke</i> (pl)	अच्छे लड़कों को <i>achchhe laRkon ko</i>
बड़ा कमरा <i>baRaa kamraa</i>	बड़े कमरे में <i>baRe kamre mein</i>
अच्छी लड़की <i>achchhee laRkee</i>	अच्छी लड़की को <i>achchhee laRkee ko</i> (no change)
मेरा घर <i>meraa ghar</i>	मेरे घर में <i>mere ghar mein</i>
यह लड़का <i>yeh laRkaa</i>	इस लड़के को <i>is laRke ko</i>

DIRECT PHRASE	OBLIQUE (BEFORE POSTPOSITION)
वह घर <i>voh ghar</i>	उस घर में <i>us ghar mein</i>
ये लड़के <i>ye laRke</i>	इन लड़कों के साथ <i>in laRkon ke saath</i>

WATCH OUT

Two errors to hunt down in your own speech. (1) Putting the little word first, English-style: **X** में दिल्ली — it's always दिल्ली में (*dillee mein*). (2) Forgetting the oblique: **X** मेरा घर में, **X** अच्छा लड़के को. Once the postposition appears, the whole phrase bends: मेरे घर में (*mere ghar mein*) [may-ray ghur may(n)], अच्छे लड़के को. Say the phrase as one unit and the -e endings start coming automatically.

Pronouns + postpositions

Pronouns have special oblique stems, and with को most of them fuse into a one-word short form — the short forms are what people actually say. In writing, से/को/का attach to the pronoun (मुझसे); पर is usually written separately (मुझ पर *mujh par* [mujh pur]); "in it/this" is इसमें *ismein* [is-may(n)], "in that" उसमें *usmein* [us-may(n)].

PRONOUN	+ को → SHORT FORM	+ से	POSSESSIVE	के लिए
मैं main	मुझको → मुझे <i>mujhko → mujhe</i>	मुझसे <i>mujhse</i>	मेरा <i>meraa</i>	मेरे लिए <i>mere liye</i>
तू tu	तुझको → तुझे <i>tujhko → tujhe</i>	तुझसे <i>tujhse</i>	तेरा <i>teraa</i>	तेरे लिए <i>tere liye</i>
यह yeh	इसको → इसे <i>isko → ise</i>	इससे <i>isse</i>	इसका <i>iskaa</i>	इसके लिए <i>iske liye</i>
वह voh	उसको → उसे <i>usko → use</i>	उससे <i>usse</i>	उसका <i>uskaa</i>	उसके लिए <i>uske liye</i>
हम ham	हमको → हमें <i>hamko → hamen</i>	हमसे <i>hamse</i>	हमारा <i>hamaaraa</i>	हमारे लिए <i>hamaare liye</i>
तुम tum	तुमको → तुम्हें <i>tumko → tumhen</i>	तुमसे <i>tumse</i>	तुम्हारा <i>tumhaaraa</i>	तुम्हारे लिए <i>tumhaare liye</i>
आप aap	आपको <i>aapko</i>	आपसे <i>aapse</i>	आपका <i>aapkaa</i>	आपके लिए <i>aapke liye</i>

PRONOUN	+ को → SHORT FORM	+ से	POSSESSIVE	के लिए
ये ye	इनको → इन्हें <i>inko → inhen</i>	इनसे <i>inse</i>	इनका <i>inkaa</i>	इनके लिए <i>inke liye</i>
वे voh log	उनको → उन्हें <i>unko → unhen</i>	उनसे <i>unse</i>	उनका <i>unkaa</i>	उनके लिए <i>unke liye</i>

Say the short forms until they're reflexes: मुझे [mu-jhay], तुझे [tu-jhay], इसे [i-say], उसे [u-say], हमें [huh-may(n)], तुम्हें [tum-hay(n)], इन्हें [in-hay(n)], उन्हें [un-hay(n)]. Unit 10 runs on them.

DELHI STREET NOTE

On the street, पर (*par*) shrinks to पे (*pe*) [pay]: घर पे (*ghar pe*), छत पे (*chhat pe*) [chhut pay] "on the roof". And Delhiites constantly say मेरे को (*mere ko*) [may-ray koh] and तेरे को (*tere ko*) for मुझे/तुझे — pure Dilli style. Understand it, enjoy it, but say मुझे yourself, especially with the in-laws; मेरे को is very casual and technically "wrong".

के पास = have

Hindi has no verb "to have". For things you own or carry, park them near yourself: **X के पास Y है** — "near X there is Y".

मेरे पास नया फ़ोन है।

mere paas nayaa fon hai. [may-ray pahs nuh-yah fohn heh]

I have a new phone. (lit. my near new phone is)

क्या तुम्हारे पास टाइम है?

kyaa tumhaare paas Taim hai? [kyah tum-hah-ray pahs Taym heh]

Do you have time?

उसके पास गाड़ी नहीं है।

uske paas gaaRee naheen hai. [us-kay pahs gah-Ree nuh-hee(n) heh]

He/she doesn't have a car.

WATCH OUT

के पास is for things, money, time — not for people in your family. Relatives use plain possessives from Unit 5: मेरे दो भाई हैं (*mere do bhaaee hain*) [may-ray doh bhah-ee heh(n)] "I have two brothers", मेरी एक बहन है (*meri ek behen hai*) [may-ree ayk beh-hen heh]. Saying **X मेरे पास दो भाई हैं** sounds like you keep two brothers in your pocket.

के पास also keeps its literal meaning "near": घर के पास एक पार्क है (*ghar ke paas ek paark hai*) [ghur kay pahs ayk pahrk heh] — there's a park near the house.

Saying where things are

किताब मेज़ पर है।

kitaab mez par hai. [ki-tahb mayz pur heh]

The book is on the table.

दूध फ्रिज में है।

doodh frij mein hai. [doodh frij may(n) heh]

The milk is in the fridge.

बच्चे कमरे के अंदर हैं।

bachche kamre ke andar hain. [buch-chay kum-ray kay un-dur heh(n)]

The children are inside the room.

गाड़ी घर के बाहर है।

gaaRee ghar ke baahar hai. [gah-Ree ghur kay bah-hur heh]

The car is outside the house.

बैंक होटल के सामने है।

baank hoTal ke saamne hai. [behnk hoh-Tul kay sahm-nay heh]

The bank is in front of the hotel.

मंदिर के पीछे एक छोटा बाज़ार है।

mandir ke peechhe ek chhoTaa baazaar hai. [mun-dir kay pee-chhay ayk chhoh-Tah bah-zahr heh]

Behind the temple there's a small market.

मेरा फ़ोन तकिये के नीचे है।

meraa fon takiye ke neeche hai. [may-rah fohn tuh-ki-yay kay nee-chay heh]

My phone is under the pillow. (takiyaa (m) → oblique takiye)

दुकान सुबह से शाम तक खुली है।

dukaan subah se shaam tak khulee hai. [du-kahn su-beh say shahm tuk khu-lee heh]

The shop is open from morning till evening.

क्लास से पहले मैं घर पर हूँ।

klaas se pehle main ghar par hoon. [klaahs say peh-lay meh(n) ghur pur hoo(n)]

Before class I'm at home. (ghar par = at home — idiom, not "on the house"!)

खाने के बाद चाय ज़रूरी है।

khaane ke baad chaay zarooree hai. [khah-nay kay bahd chah-ay zuh-roo-ree heh]

After food, chai is essential. (khaanaa (m) → oblique khaane)

जैकब अपने दोस्तों के साथ बाज़ार में है।

jaikab apne doston ke saath baazaar mein hai. [jeh-kub up-nay dohs-toh(n) kay sahth bah-zahr may(n) heh]

Jacob is at the market with his friends. (dost → pl. oblique doston)

लड़कों के पास नई किताबें हैं।

laRkon ke paas naee kitaaben hain. [luhR-koh(n) kay pahs nuh-ee ki-tah-bay(n) heh(n)]

The boys have new books.

मैं मेट्रो से ऑफिस जाता हूँ।

main meTro se ofis jaataa hoon. [meh(n) may-Troh say aw-fis jah-tah hoo(n)]

I go to the office by metro. (se = by; jaataa hoon "I go" — full pattern in Unit 8)

यह चाय आपके लिए है, और वह मेरे लिए।

yeh chaay aapke liye hai, aur voh mere liye. [yeh chah-ay ahp-kay li-yeh heh, awr voh may-ray li-yeh]

This chai is for you, and that one's for me.

CULTURE

Delhi life happens on the छत (*chhat* (*f*)) [chhut] — the flat rooftop. Winter sun, pigeons, kite-flying, evening chai: छत पर चाय (*chhat par chaay*) [chhut pur chah-ay]. If your in-laws say चलो, छत पे बैठते हैं (*chalo, chhat pe baiThte hain*) [chuh-loh, chhut pay behTh-tay heh(n)] "come, let's sit on the roof", that's an invitation into the family's living room.

Exercise 7A — Fill in the postposition

Write the postposition that fits: में, पर, से, तक, or the right part of a compound (लिए, पास, साथ, बाद, पहले, सामने, बाहर...). Answers: Answer Key, Unit 7.

1. दूध फ्रिज ____ है। (*doodh frij ____ hai.*)

2. किताबें मेज़ ___ हैं। (*kitaaben mez ___ hain.*)

3. यह चाय आपके ___ है। (*yeh chaay aapke ___ hai.*)

4. मेरे ___ दो टिकट हैं। (*mere ___ do TikaT hain.*)

5. दुकान सुबह ___ शाम ___ खुली है। (*dukaan subah ___ shaam ___ khulee hai.*)

6. जैकब अपने दोस्तों के ___ है। (*jaikab apne doston ke ___ hai.*)

7. खाने के ___ चाय ज़रूरी है। (*khaane ke ___ chaay zarooree hai.*)

8. क्लास से ___ मैं घर पर हूँ। (*klaas se ___ main ghar par hoon.*)

9. बैंक होटल के ___ है। (*baink hoTal ke ___ hai.*)

10. गाड़ी घर के ___ है। (*gaaRee ghar ke ___ hai.*)

Exercise 7B — Make it oblique

Combine the noun phrase with the postposition, changing everything that must change. Example:

लड़का + को → लड़के को.

1. लड़का + को (*laRkaa + ko*)

2. लड़के (pl) + को (*laRke pl + ko*)

3. कमरा + में (*kamraa + mein*)

4. घर (pl) + में (*ghar pl + mein*)

5. लड़की + को (*laRkee + ko*)

6. लड़कियाँ + को (*laRkiyaan + ko*)

7. अच्छा लड़का + के साथ (*achchhaa laRkaa + ke saath*)

8. मेरा भाई + के लिए (*meraa bhaaee + ke liye*)

Exercise 7C — Translate into Hindi

Write the Hindi in Devanagari (roman too if you like). Watch the obliques!

1. The book is on the table.

2. I have two brothers. (careful!)

3. I have a new phone.

4. The children are in the room.

5. This gift is for my sister.

6. The bank is in front of the hotel.

7. Jacob is with his friends.

Exercise 7D — Translate into English

Write natural English.

1. मेरा फोन तकिये के नीचे है। (*meraa fon takiye ke neeche hai.*)

2. दुकान सुबह से शाम तक खुली है। (*dukaan subah se shaam tak khulee hai.*)

3. क्या तुम्हारे पास टाइम है? (*kyaa tumhaare paas Taim hai?*)

4. मंदिर के पीछे एक छोटा बाज़ार है। (*mandir ke peechhe ek chhoTaa baazaar hai.*)

5. उसके पास गाड़ी नहीं है। (*uske paas gaaRee naheen hai.*)

6. खाने के बाद चाय ज़रूरी है। (*khaane ke baad chaay zarooree hai.*)

UNIT 8

The Present Habitual

What you'll be able to say: what you do every day — where you live and work, what you eat and drink, when you get up and sleep — and ask the same about anyone else.

मैं रोज़ सुबह छह बजे उठता हूँ।

main roz subah chheh baje uThtaa hoon. [meh(n) roh-z su-beh chheh buh-jay uTh-tah hoo(n)]

I get up at six every morning.

वह ऑफिस में काम करती है।

voh ofis mein kaam kartee hai. [voh aw-fis may(n) kahm kur-tee heh]

She works in an office.

हम रात को हिन्दी सीखते हैं।

ham raat ko hindee seekhte hain. [hum raht koh hin-dee seekh-tay heh(n)]

We study Hindi at night.

The pattern: stem + -ता/-ते/-ती + present of होना

The habitual describes what happens regularly or generally — English "I go", "she drinks". Build it in two pieces:

1. The stem. Chop -ना (-naa) off any infinitive: करना (*karnaa*) [kur-nah] → कर (*kar*).

2. The endings. Add -ता (-taa) for masculine singular, -ते (-te) for masculine plural, -ती (-tee) for feminine — the same -aa/-e/-ee music as adjectives in Unit 6 — then close the sentence with the matching present form of होना (हूँ / हो / है / हैं).

SUBJECT	MALE SPEAKER/SUBJECT	FEMALE SPEAKER/SUBJECT
मैं main	करता हूँ <i>kartaa hoon</i>	करती हूँ <i>kartee hoon</i>
तू tu	करता है <i>kartaa hai</i>	करती है <i>kartee hai</i>
यह / वह yeh / voh	करता है <i>kartaa hai</i>	करती है <i>kartee hai</i>
तुम tum	करते हो <i>karte ho</i>	करती हो <i>kartee ho</i>
आप aap	करते हैं <i>karte hain</i>	करती हैं <i>kartee hain</i>
हम ham	करते हैं <i>karte hain</i>	करती हैं <i>kartee hain</i>
ये / वे लोग ye / voh log	करते हैं <i>karte hain</i>	करती हैं <i>kartee hain</i>

Say the two backbones aloud until they're automatic: करता हूँ [kur-tah hoo(n)], करते हो [kur-tay hoh], करते हैं [kur-tay heh(n)]; करती हूँ [kur-tee hoo(n)], करती हो [kur-tee hoh], करती हैं [kur-tee heh(n)]. Jacob uses the -ता column; his partner uses -ती. One respected person (आप, or a parent-in-law) gets the plural verb.

Stems you'll use daily

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
उठना → उठ	<i>uThnaa → uTh</i>	uTh-nah	to get up
जाना → जा	<i>jaanaa → jaa</i>	jah-nah	to go
खाना → खा	<i>khaanaa → khaa</i>	khah-nah	to eat
पीना → पी	<i>peenaa → pee</i>	pee-nah	to drink
करना → कर	<i>karnaa → kar</i>	kur-nah	to do
रहना → रह	<i>rehnaa → reh</i>	reh-nah	to live, stay
देखना → देख	<i>dekhnaa → dekh</i>	daykh-nah	to see, watch
पढ़ना → पढ़	<i>paRhnaa → paRh</i>	puRh-nah	to read, study
सोना → सो	<i>sonaa → so</i>	soh-nah	to sleep
सीखना → सीख	<i>seekhnaa → seekh</i>	seekh-nah	to learn
नहाना → नहा	<i>nahaanaa → nahaa</i>	nuh-hah-nah	to bathe, shower
बात करना	<i>baat karnaa</i> (baat f)	baht kur-nah	to talk, chat (talk to someone = person + से + baat karnaa)

NOTE

Destination needs no postposition with जाना: मैं दिल्ली जाता हूँ (*main dillee jaataa hoon*) [meh(n) dil-lee jah-tah hoo(n)] "I go to Delhi" — no में, no को. The set phrase for "to work" is काम पर (*kaam par*) [kahm pur]: मैं काम पर जाता हूँ.

A Delhi day

जैकब सुबह जल्दी उठता है।

jaikab subah jaldee uThtaa hai. [jeh-kub su-beh jul-dee uTh-tah heh]

Jacob gets up early in the morning.

वह रोज़ योग करती है।

voh roz yog kartee hai. [voh rohz yohg kur-tee heh]

She does yoga every day. (yog (m))

मैं मेट्रो से काम पर जाता हूँ।

main meTro se kaam par jaataa hoon. [meh(n) may-Troh say kahm pur jah-tah hoo(n)]

I go to work by metro.

हम शाम को चाय पीते हैं।

ham shaam ko chaay peete hain. [hum shahm koh chah-ay pee-tay heh(n)]

We drink chai in the evening.

मेरी पत्नी ऑफ़िस में काम करती है।

merree patnee ofis mein kaam kartee hai. [may-ree put-nee aw-fis may(n) kahm kur-tee heh]

My wife works in an office. (patnee (f))

आप कहाँ रहते हैं? — मैं करोल बाग़ में रहता हूँ।

aap kahaan rehte hain? — main karol baag mein rehtaa hoon. [ahp kuh-hah(n) reh-tay heh(n) — meh(n) kuh-rohl bahg may(n) reh-tah hoo(n)]

Where do you live? — I live in Karol Bagh.

तुम कितने बजे सोते हो?

tum kitne baje sote ho? [tum kit-nay buh-jay soh-tay hoh]

What time do you go to sleep?

दिल्ली में लोग देर से सोते हैं।

dillee mein log der se sote hain. [dil-lee may(n) lohng dayr say soh-tay heh(n)]

In Delhi people go to bed late. (der (f) = lateness; der se = late)

वे लोग हर हफ़्ते फ़िल्म देखते हैं।

voh log har hafte film dekhte hain. [voh lohng hur huf-tay film daykh-tay heh(n)]

They watch a film every week. (haftaa (m) → oblique hafte after har — Unit 7 at work)

वह कभी-कभी अपनी माँ से फ़ोन पर बात करती है।

voh kabhee-kabhee apnee maan se fon par baat kartee hai. [voh kuh-bhee kuh-bhee up-nee mah(n) say fohn pur baht kur-tee heh]

She sometimes talks to her mother on the phone.

मैं आम तौर पर घर पर खाना खाता हूँ।

main aam taur par ghar par khaanaa khaataa hoon. [meh(n) ahm tawr pur ghur pur khah-nah khah-tah hoo(n)]

I usually eat at home. (khaanaa (m) = food)

क्या तुम रोज़ नहाते हो?

kyaa tum roz nahaate ho? [kyah tum rohz nuh-hah-tay hoh]

Do you shower every day? (a fair question between partners)

How often?

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
रोज़ / हर दिन	<i>roz / har din</i> (din m)	rohz / hur din	every day
अक्सर	<i>aksar</i>	uk-sur	often
आम तौर पर	<i>aam taur par</i>	ahm tawr pur	usually, generally
हमेशा	<i>hameshaa</i>	huh-may-shah	always
कभी-कभी	<i>kabhee-kabhee</i>	kuh-bhee kuh-bhee	sometimes
कभी नहीं	<i>kabhee naheen</i>	kuh-bhee nuh-hee(n)	never (verb stays negative too)
हर हफ़्ते	<i>har hafte</i> (haftaa m)	hur huf-tay	every week
सुबह / शाम को / रात को	<i>subah (f) / shaam (f) ko / raat (f) ko</i>	su-beh / shahm koh / raht koh	in the morning / evening / at night

Saying "don't": the habitual negative

Put नहीं (*naheen*) before the verb — and here's the twist: **in the negative, the हूँ/है/हैं is usually dropped.**

मैं गोश्त नहीं खाता।

main gosht naheen khaataa. [meh(n) gohsht nuh-hee(n) khah-tah]

I don't eat meat. (gosht (m)) (no hoon — dropped after naheen)

वह ज़्यादा टीवी नहीं देखती।

voh zyaadaa TeeVee naheen dekhtee. [voh zyah-dah Tee-Vee nuh-hee(n) daykh-tee]

She doesn't watch much TV.

NOTE

Keeping the auxiliary (मैं गोश्त नहीं खाता हूँ) isn't wrong — just heavier. One real subtlety: when the auxiliary drops, a feminine *plural* verb takes the nasal itself: वे लोग नहीं जातीं (*voh log naheen jaateen*) [voh lohɡ nuh-hee(n) jah-tee(n)] "they (women) don't go". Recognize it; with the auxiliary it's plain जाती हैं.

Asking about habits

Yes/no questions: hang क्या on the front, voice rises at the end. Question words (कब, कहाँ, कितने बजे...) sit just before the verb phrase.

क्या आप गोश्त खाते हैं? — जी नहीं, मैं गोश्त नहीं खाता।

kyaa aap gosht khaate hain? — jee naheen, main gosht naheen khaataa. [kyah ahp gohsht khah-tay heh(n) — jee nuh-hee(n), meh(n) gohsht nuh-hee(n) khah-tah]

Do you eat meat? — No (politely), I don't eat meat.

तुम कब उठते हो?

tum kab uThte ho? [tum kub uTh-tay hoh]

When do you get up?

WATCH OUT

English speakers love to drop the auxiliary everywhere: ✗ मैं रोज़ जाता. In the *affirmative* the auxiliary is compulsory: मैं रोज़ जाता हूँ (*main roz jaataa hoon*). It disappears only in the negative (मैं नहीं जाता). And keep your gender on: Jacob says जाता हूँ, his partner says जाती हूँ — one mixed-up ending and the whole family will (lovingly) correct you.

DELHI STREET NOTE

Real Delhi habitual speech is half English nouns: मैं जिम जाता हूँ (*main jim jaataa hoon*) [meh(n) jim jah-tah hoo(n)], वह ऑफिस में काम करती है, वीकेंड पे मूवी देखते हैं (*veekenD pe moovee dekhte hain*) [vee-kenD pay moo-vee daykh-tay heh(n)]. And Delhiites seal statements with न? (*na?*) [nah]: तुम चाय पीते हो न? — "you drink chai, right?"

CULTURE

Morning-walk culture: every Delhi park at 6 a.m. is full of uncles and aunties on their सैर (*sair (f)*) [sehr] — brisk walking, louder gossip. मेरे ससुर रोज़ पार्क में सैर करते हैं (*mere sasur roz paark mein sair karte hain*) [may-ray suh-sur rohz pahrk may(n) sehr kur-tay heh(n)] "my father-in-law walks in the park daily" — note the respectful plural verb for one respected person; a respected lady gets करती हैं (*kartee hain*).

Exercise 8A — Fill in the habitual form

Put the bracketed verb into the correct habitual form (watch gender and number). Answers: Answer Key, Unit 8.

1. मैं रोज़ चाय ____ (पीना)। — Jacob speaking (*main roz chaay ____ .*)

2. प्रिया ऑफिस में काम ____ (करना)। (*priyaa ofis mein kaam ____ .*)

3. हम शाम को हिन्दी ____ (सीखना)। (*ham shaam ko hindee ____ .*)

4. तुम कितने बजे ____ (उठना)? — asking a man (*tum kitne baje ____ ?*)

5. आप कहाँ ____ (रहना)? — asking your father-in-law (*aap kahaan ____ ?*)

6. मेरी बहन स्कूल में ____ (पढ़ना)। (*meree behen skool mein ____ .*)

7. वे लोग हर हफ़्ते फ़िल्म ____ (देखना)। (*voh log har hafte film ____ .*)

8. जैकब गोश्त नहीं ___ (खाना)। (*jaikab gosht naheen ___*.)

9. मेरे ससुर रोज़ पार्क में सैर ___ (करना)। (*mere sasur roz paark mein sair ___*.)

Exercise 8B — Change the subject

Rewrite the sentence for the new subject in brackets; change every ending that must change.

1. मैं चाय पीता हूँ। (वह — a woman) (*main chaay peetaa hoon. → voh ...*)

2. तुम कब सोते हो? (आप — a man) (*tum kab sote ho? → aap ...*)

3. मैं दिल्ली में रहता हूँ। (हम — men) (*main dillee mein rehtaa hoon. → ham ...*)

4. वह फ़िल्म देखती है। (वे लोग — men) (*voh film dekhtee hai. → voh log ...*)

5. मैं सुबह जल्दी उठता हूँ। (मेरी पत्नी) (*main subah jaldee uThtaa hoon. → meree patnee ...*)

6. वह टीवी नहीं देखता। (वह — a woman) (*voh TeeVee naheen dekhtaa. → voh ...*)

7. तुम रोज़ नहाते हो। (→ make it a question with क्या) (*tum roz nahaate ho. → ?*)

Exercise 8C — Translate into Hindi

You (Jacob) are male; use masculine forms for "I" unless told otherwise.

1. I drink chai every day.

2. She lives in Delhi.

3. We eat at home in the evening.

4. Do you (तुम, to a man) watch films?

5. I don't eat meat.

6. My wife works in an office.

7. What time do you (आप) get up?

Exercise 8D — Translate into English

Write natural English.

1. दिल्ली में लोग देर से सोते हैं। (*dillee mein log der se sote hain.*)

2. वह कभी-कभी अपनी माँ से फ़ोन पर बात करती है। (*voh kabhee-kabhee apnee maan se fon par baat kartee hai.*)

3. मैं आम तौर पर मेट्रो से ऑफ़िस जाता हूँ। (*main aam taur par meTro se ofis jaataa hoon.*)

4. क्या आप गोश्त खाते हैं? (*kyaa aap gosht khaate hain?*)

5. मेरे ससुर रोज़ पार्क में सैर करते हैं। (*mere sasur roz paark mein sair karte hain.*)

6. वह ज़्यादा टीवी नहीं देखती । (*voh zyaadaa TeeVee naheen dekhtee.*)

UNIT 9

The Present Continuous

What you'll be able to say: what's happening right now — what you're doing, what's cooking, who's sleeping — and hold the world's most common Hindi phone conversation.

मैं अभी खाना बना रहा हूँ।

main abhee khaanaa banaa rahaa hoon. [meh(n) uh-bhee khah-nah buh-nah ruh-hah hoo(n)]

I'm cooking right now.

क्या कर रहे हो?

kyaa kar rahe ho? [kyah kur ruh-hay hoh]

What are you doing? (THE phone-opener)

बारिश हो रही है।

baarish ho rahee hai. [bah-rish hoh ruh-hee heh]

It's raining. (baarish (f) (lit. rain happening is))

The pattern: stem + रहा/रहे/रही + present of होना

For actions in progress, Hindi slips रहा between the stem and the auxiliary. रहा agrees in gender and number exactly like an -aa adjective: रहा (*rahaa*) [ruh-hah] m sg, रहे (*rahe*) [ruh-hay] m pl, रही (*rahee*) [ruh-hee] f. The auxiliary is the same हूँ/हो/है/हैं you already own.

SUBJECT	MALE	FEMALE
मैं main	कर रहा हूँ <i>kar rahaa hoon</i>	कर रही हूँ <i>kar rahee hoon</i>
तू tu	कर रहा है <i>kar rahaa hai</i>	कर रही है <i>kar rahee hai</i>
यह / वह yeh / voh	कर रहा है <i>kar rahaa hai</i>	कर रही है <i>kar rahee hai</i>
तुम tum	कर रहे हो <i>kar rahe ho</i>	कर रही हो <i>kar rahee ho</i>
आप aap	कर रहे हैं <i>kar rahe hain</i>	कर रही हैं <i>kar rahee hain</i>
हम ham	कर रहे हैं <i>kar rahe hain</i>	कर रही हैं <i>kar rahee hain</i>
ये / वे लोग ye / voh log	कर रहे हैं <i>kar rahe hain</i>	कर रही हैं <i>kar rahee hain</i>

Habit vs. right now

English "I drink chai" vs. "I'm drinking chai" — Hindi makes exactly the same cut:

मैं चाय पीता हूँ।

main chaay peetaa hoon. [meh(n) chah-ay pee-tah hoo(n)]

I drink chai. (in general — it's my habit)

मैं चाय पी रहा हूँ।

main chaay pee rahaa hoon. [meh(n) chah-ay pee ruh-hah hoo(n)]

I'm drinking chai. (right now, cup in hand)

वह दिल्ली में रहती है। / वह आजकल दिल्ली में रह रही है।

voh dillee mein rehtee hai. / voh aajkal dillee mein reh rahee hai. [voh dil-lee may(n) reh-tee
heh / voh ahj-kul dil-lee may(n) reh ruh-hee heh]

She lives in Delhi. / She's staying in Delhi these days (temporarily).

Right-now words

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
अभी	<i>abhee</i>	uh-bhee	right now
इस वक़्त	<i>is vaqt</i> (vaqt m)	is vukt	at this moment
इस समय	<i>is samay</i> (samay m)	is suh-may	at this time (slightly formal)
आजकल	<i>aajkal</i>	ahj-kul	these days — for the stretched-out present
फ़िलहाल	<i>filhaal</i>	fil-hahl	for now, at present

NOTE

आजकल (*aajkal*) [ahj-kul] "these days" loves the continuous for temporary situations: आजकल मैं हिन्दी सीख रहा हूँ (*aajkal main hindee seekh rahaa hoon*) — the learning is ongoing this season of life, not this minute. With a true permanent habit, आजकल takes the habitual instead.

Examples: Delhi in motion

मैं हिन्दी सीख रहा हूँ।

main hindee seekh rahaa hoon. [meh(n) hin-dee seekh ruh-hah hoo(n)]

I am learning Hindi.

चाय बन रही है।

chaay ban rahee hai. [chah-ay bun ruh-hee heh]

The chai is brewing. (bannaa = to get made — things "make themselves" in Hindi kitchens)

वह अभी नहा रही है।

voh abhee nahaa rahee hai. [voh uh-bhee nuh-hah ruh-hee heh]

She's showering right now.

बच्चे सो रहे हैं।

bachche so rahe hain. [buch-chay soh ruh-hay heh(n)]

The children are sleeping.

पापा अखबार पढ़ रहे हैं।

paapaa akhbaar paRh rahe hain. [pah-pah ukh-bahr puRh ruh-hay heh(n)]

Papa is reading the newspaper. (akhbaar (m)) (one respected man → plural रहे हैं)

माँ खाना बना रही हैं।

maan khaanaa banaa rahee hain. [mah(n) khah-nah buh-nah ruh-hee heh(n)]

Mom is cooking. (respected woman: rahee stays feminine, auxiliary goes plural — banaa rahee HAIN)

हम अभी मेट्रो से आ रहे हैं।

ham abhee meTro se aa rahe hain. [hum uh-bhee may-Troh say ah ruh-hay heh(n)]

We're on our way by metro right now.

वे लोग आजकल गुड़गाँव में रह रहे हैं।

voh log aajkal guRgaanv mein reh rahe hain. [voh lohg ahj-kul guR-gah(n)v may(n) reh ruh-hay heh(n)]

They're living in Gurgaon these days.

क्या तुम सुन रहे हो?

kyaa tum sun rahe ho? [kyah tum sun ruh-hay hoh]

Are you listening?

मैं नहीं सुन रहा।

main naheen sun rahaa. [meh(n) nuh-hee(n) sun ruh-hah]

I'm not listening. (as in Unit 8, the auxiliary often drops after naheen)

मेरी सास मंदिर जा रही हैं।

meree saas mandir jaa rahee hain. [may-ree sahs mun-dir jah ruh-hee heh(n)]

My mother-in-law is going to the temple. (saas (f))

On the phone

The continuous is the engine of every Hindi phone call. A typical exchange between Jacob and his wife:

हैलो? क्या कर रहे हो?

hailo? kya kar rahe ho? [heh-loh — kyah kur ruh-hay hoh]

Hello? What are you doing?

कुछ नहीं, टीवी देख रहा हूँ। तुम कहाँ हो?

kuchh naheen, TeeVee dekh rahaa hoon. tum kahaan ho? [kuchh nuh-hee(n), Tee-Vee daykh ruh-hah hoo(n) — tum kuh-hah(n) hoh]

Nothing much, I'm watching TV. Where are you?

मैं आ रही हूँ, बस पाँच मिनट!

main aa rahee hoon, bas paanch minaT! [meh(n) ah ruh-hee hoo(n), bus pah(n)ch mi-nuT]

I'm coming — just five minutes! (minaT (m))

अच्छा, मैं बाद में फ़ोन करता हूँ।

achchhaa, main baad mein fon kartaa hoon. [uch-chhah, meh(n) bahd may(n) fohn kur-tah hoo(n)]

Okay, I'll call (you) later. (lit. I call later — habitual used for an immediate plan; more in Unit 12)

WATCH OUT

Don't let English's plain present fool you into the wrong direction: for something happening *now*, habitual is wrong — ✗ मैं अभी चाय पीता हूँ → ✓ मैं अभी चाय पी रहा हूँ (*main abhee chaay pee rahaa hoon*). And रहा carries your gender: Jacob says पी रहा हूँ, his wife says पी रही हूँ — रहे/रही slips are the number-one giveaway of a beginner.

DELHI STREET NOTE

Three Delhi essentials. (1) क्या चल रहा है? (*kyaa chal rahaa hai?*) [kyah chul ruh-hah heh] — "what's going on?", the standard what's-up. (2) बस पहुँच रहा हूँ (*bas pahunch rahaa hoon*) [bus puh-hu(n)ch ruh-hah hoo(n)] — "almost there!" Official meaning: arriving. Delhi meaning: has just left home. (3) In June: गर्मी पड़ रही है यार (*garmee paR rahee hai yaar*) [gur-mee puR ruh-hee heh yahr] — "it's roasting, yaar" (set phrase — learn it whole).

NOTE

States don't like the continuous, same as English "I am knowing" is off. Being, knowing, liking use other patterns: मुझे पता है (*mujhe pataa hai*) [mu-jhay puh-tah heh] "I know" — that's Unit 10's machinery, coming next.

Exercise 9A — Fill in the continuous form

Put the bracketed verb into the present continuous. Watch gender, number, and respect. Answers: Answer Key, Unit 9.

1. मैं अभी खाना ___ (खाना)। — Jacob speaking (*main abhee khaanaa ___ .*)

2. वह ___ (नहाना)। — a woman (*voh ___ .*)

3. हम मेट्रो से ___ (आना)। — men (*ham meTro se ___ .*)

4. बच्चे ___ (सोना)। (*bachche ___ .*)

5. क्या तुम ___ (सुनना)? — to a man (*kyaa tum ___ ?*)

6. माँ खाना ___ (बनाना)। — respectful (*maan khaanaa ___ .*)

7. पापा अखबार ___ (पढ़ना)। — respectful (*paapaa akhbaar ___ .*)

8. बारिश ___ (होना)। (*baarish ___ .*)

9. प्रिया आजकल हिन्दी ___ (सीखना)। (*priyaa aajkal hindee ___ .*)

Exercise 9B — Habit → happening now

Convert each habitual sentence to the present continuous (add अभी if it helps).

1. मैं चाय पीता हूँ। (main chaay peetaa hoon.)

2. वह टीवी देखती है। (voh TeeVee dekhtee hai.)

3. हम हिन्दी सीखते हैं। (ham hindee seekhte hain.)

4. तुम क्या करते हो? (tum kyaa karte ho?)

5. वे लोग खाना खाते हैं। (voh log khaanaa khaate hain.)

6. मेरी पत्नी योग करती है। (meree patnee yog kartee hai.)

7. आप कहाँ जाते हैं? (aap kahaan jaate hain?)

Exercise 9C — Translate into Hindi

Use the continuous where English has -ing.

1. These days I am learning Hindi.

2. What are you (तुम, to a man) doing?

3. It's raining.

4. Mom is cooking. (respectful)

5. The children are sleeping.

6. She is showering right now.

7. We (men) are coming by metro.

Exercise 9D — Translate into English

Write natural English.

1. चाय बन रही है। (*chaay ban rahee hai.*)

2. पापा अखबार पढ़ रहे हैं। (*paapaa akhbaar paRh rahe hain.*)

3. वे लोग आजकल गुडगाँव में रह रहे हैं। (*voh log aajkal guRgaanv mein reh rahe hain.*)

4. मैं बस पहुँच रहा हूँ। (*main bas pahunch rahaa hoon.*)

5. क्या तुम सुन रहे हो? (*kyaa tum sun rahe ho?*)

6. मेरी सास मंदिर जा रही हैं। (*meree saas mandir jaa rahee hain.*)

UNIT 10

ko-Constructions: Liking, Wanting, Feeling, Knowing

What you'll be able to say: I like it, I want it, I'm hungry, I'm cold, I know, my head hurts, I can speak Hindi — the everyday inner life, which Hindi frames as things happening *to* you.

मुझे मोमोज़ पसंद हैं।

mujhe momos pasand hain. [mu-jhay moh-mohz puh-sund heh(n)]

I like momos. (lit. to-me momos pleasing are)

मुझे भूख लगी है।

mujhe bhookh lagee hai. [mu-jhay bhookh luh-gee heh]

I'm hungry. (lit. to-me hunger has stuck)

मुझे हिन्दी आती है!

mujhe hindee aatee hai! [mu-jhay hin-dee ah-tee heh]

I know Hindi! (lit. to-me Hindi comes)

The "to-me" idea

English says *I like chai* — "I" is the subject. Hindi flips the camera: चाय मुझे पसंद है — "chai is pleasing *to me*". The person feeling gets को (usually as the short forms from Unit 7: मुझे, तुम्हें, उसे...), and **the thing liked/wanted/known is the grammatical subject** — **so the verb agrees with IT, not with you**. That one sentence is the whole unit; everything below is practice.

FEELER (+ को)	ROMAN	SAY IT
मुझे (मैं)	<i>mujhe</i>	mu-jhay
तुझे (तू)	<i>tujhe</i>	tu-jhay
तुम्हें (तुम)	<i>tumhen</i>	tum-hay(n)
आपको (आप)	<i>aapko</i>	ahp-koh
इसे / उसे (यह / वह)	<i>ise / use</i>	i-say / u-say
हमें (हम)	<i>hamen</i>	huh-may(n)
इन्हें / उन्हें (ये / वे)	<i>inhen / unhen</i>	in-hay(n) / un-hay(n)

FEELER (+ को)	ROMAN	SAY IT
जैकब को / माँ को (names, nouns)	<i>jaikab ko / maan ko</i>	jeh-kub koh / mah(n) koh

पसंद है — liking

मुझे चाय पसंद है।

mujhe chaay pasand hai. [mu-jhay chah-ay puh-sund heh]

I like chai. (chaay f sg → hai)

मुझे मोमोज़ पसंद हैं, समोसे भी पसंद हैं।

mujhe momos pasand hain, samose bhee pasand hain. [mu-jhay moh-mohz puh-sund heh(n), suh-moh-say bhee puh-sund heh(n)]

I like momos, and samosas too. (plural things → hain!) (samosaa (m))

क्या तुम्हें दिल्ली पसंद है? — हाँ, बहुत पसंद है।

kyaa tumhen dillee pasand hai? — haan, bahut pasand hai. [kyah tum-hay(n) dil-lee puh-sund heh — hah(n), bo-hut puh-sund heh]

Do you like Delhi? — Yes, I like it a lot.

उसे यह गाना पसंद है, मुझे यह रंग पसंद नहीं।

use yeh gaanaa pasand hai, mujhe yeh rang pasand naheen. [u-say yeh gah-nah puh-sund heh, mu-jhay yeh rung puh-sund nuh-hee(n)]

She likes this song; I don't like this colour. (gaanaa (m), rang (m))

WATCH OUT

The classic beginner sentence: ✗ मैं मोमोज़ पसंद हूँ — "I am pleasing to momos." The feeler is never मैं here. Say मुझे मोमोज़ पसंद हैं (*mujhe momos pasand hain*) — and note हैं, because the momos (plural) are the subject. One liked thing → है; several → हैं. पसंद itself never changes.

चाहिए — want / need

चाहिए (*chaahiye*) [chah-hi-yay] means "is wanted/needed (by me)". No हूँ/है after it in the present — चाहिए stands alone.

मुझे पानी चाहिए।

mujhe paanee chaahiye. [mu-jhay pah-nee chah-hi-yay]

I want/need water.

आपको क्या चाहिए?

aapko kyaa chaahiye? [ahp-koh kyah chah-hi-yay]

What would you like? (what every shopkeeper asks you)

हमें दो कमरे चाहिए।

hamen do kamre chaahiye. [huh-may(n) doh kum-ray chah-hi-yay]

We need two rooms.

मुझे कुछ नहीं चाहिए, बस चाय।

mujhe kuchh naheen chaahiye, bas chaay. [mu-jhay kuchh nuh-hee(n) chah-hi-yay, bus chah-ay]

I don't need anything — just chai.

NOTE

With plurals some speakers say चाहिएँ (*chaahiye(n)*) [chah-hi-yay(n)] (हमें दो कमरे चाहिएँ).

Invariable चाहिए is what you'll mostly hear in Delhi and is always safe. चाहिए also does

polite requests better than "I want": मुझे एक किलो टमाटर चाहिए (*mujhe ek kilo TamaaTar*

chaahiye) [mu-jhay ayk ki-loh Tuh-mah-Tur chah-hi-yay] — "I'd like a kilo of tomatoes." (TamaaTar

(m))

लगना — feelings that "strike" you

Hunger, thirst, heat, cold, fear, sleepiness: in Hindi these *attach themselves to you* with the verb लगना (*lagnaa*) [lug-nah]. The feeling-noun is the subject, so the verb takes its gender:

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
भूख	<i>bhookh</i> (f)	bhookh	hunger
प्यास	<i>pyaas</i> (f)	pyaas	thirst
ठंड	<i>ThanD</i> (f)	ThunD	cold
गर्मी	<i>garmee</i> (f)	gur-mee	heat
नींद	<i>neend</i> (f)	neend	sleep(iness) — uses आना
डर	<i>Dar</i> (m)	Dur	fear (डर से = of sth.)

मुझे भूख लगी है। — मुझे भी प्यास लगी है।

mujhe bhookh lagee hai. — mujhe bhee pyaas lagee hai. [mu-jhay bhookh luh-gee heh — mu-jhay bhee pyaas luh-gee heh]

I'm hungry. — And I'm thirsty.

मुझे ठंड लग रही है, और उसे गर्मी लग रही है।

mujhe ThanD lag rahee hai, aur use garmee lag rahee hai. [mu-jhay ThunD lug ruh-hee heh, awr u-say gur-mee lug ruh-hee heh]

I'm feeling cold, and she's feeling hot. (continuous: the feeling is happening now)

मुझे नींद आ रही है।

mujhe neend aa rahee hai. [mu-jhay neend ah ruh-hee heh]

I'm getting sleepy. (lit. sleep is coming to me)

उसे कुत्तों से डर लगता है।

use kutton se Dar lagtaa hai. [u-say kut-toh(n) say Dur lug-tah heh]

He's afraid of dogs. (kuttaa (m) → oblique pl. kutton)

लगना also gives opinions — "it seems/feels to me":

मुझे यह गाना अच्छा लगता है।

mujhe yeh gaanaa achchhaa lagtaa hai. [mu-jhay yeh gah-nah uch-chhah lug-tah heh]

I like this song. (lit. this song strikes me as good — gaanaa m → achchhaa lagtaa)

मुझे दिल्ली अच्छी लगती है।

mujhe dillee achchhee lagtee hai. [mu-jhay dil-lee uch-chhee lug-tee heh]

I like Delhi. (dillee f → achchhee lagtee — the adjective and verb both follow Delhi, not you)

पहले यह खाना अजीब लगा, अब पसंद है।

pehle yeh khaanaa ajeeb lagaa, ab pasand hai. [peh-lay yeh khah-nah uh-jeeb luh-gah, ub puh-sund heh]

At first this food seemed strange; now I like it. (lagaa = past "it struck me" — a set form for now; the full past comes in Unit 14)

पता है / मालूम है — knowing

मुझे पता है।

mujhe pataa hai. [mu-jhay puh-tah heh]

I know.

मुझे नहीं पता।

mujhe naheen pataa. [mu-jhay nuh-hee(n) puh-tah]

I don't know. (note the order: naheen before pataa; "pataa naheen" also heard)

क्या आपको मालूम है?

kyaa aapko maaloom hai? [kyah ahp-koh mah-loom heh]

Do you know? (maaloom = pataa; pataa is the everyday Delhi choice)

दर्द — aches and pains

मेरे सिर में दर्द है।

mere sir mein dard hai. [may-ray sir may(n) durd heh]

My head aches. (lit. in my head pain is) (sir (m), dard (m))

मुझे सिरदर्द है।

mujhe sirdard hai. [mu-jhay sir-durd heh]

I have a headache. (same thing, ko-style)

उसके पेट में दर्द है।

uske peT mein dard hai. [us-kay payT may(n) durd heh]

His/her stomach hurts. (peT (m))

आना — skills: what you "know how to"

Skills *come to* you in Hindi. The skill is the subject; the verb agrees with it.

मुझे थोड़ी-थोड़ी हिन्दी आती है।

mujhe thoRee-thoRee hindee aatee hai. [mu-jhay thoh-Ree thoh-Ree hin-dee ah-tee heh]

I know a little Hindi. (hindee f → thoRee, aatee — your most charming sentence; use it everywhere)

क्या आपको अंग्रेज़ी आती है?

kyaa aapko angrezee aatee hai? [kyah ahp-koh un-gray-zee ah-tee heh]

Do you know English? (angrezee (f))

मुझे खाना बनाना आता है।

mujhe khaanaa banaanaa aataa hai. [mu-jhay khah-nah buh-nah-nah ah-tah heh]

I know how to cook. (a whole infinitive phrase counts as masculine singular → aataa)

उसे गाड़ी चलाना आता है।

use gaaRee chalaanaa aataa hai. [u-say gah-Ree chuh-lah-nah ah-tah heh]

She knows how to drive. (chalaanaa = to drive/operate)

WATCH OUT

"I'm cold" is not about what you *are*: ✗ मैं ठंडा हूँ describes your body temperature — alarming news for the family. Feelings happen TO you: मुझे ठंड लग रही है (*mujhe ThanD lag rahee hai*). Same trap with hunger: ✗ मैं भूखा हूँ is grammatical but blunt; the natural line is मुझे भूख लगी है.

DELHI STREET NOTE

Delhi's dative is मेरे को (*mere ko*) [may-ray koh]: मेरे को मोमोज़ फ़ुल पसंद हैं (*mere ko momos full pasand hain*) — with English "full" as an intensifier, very Dilli. You'll also hear the softener न (*na*) mid-sentence: मुझे न, बहुत भूख लगी है (*mujhe na, bahut bhookh lagee hai*) "so listen, I'm really hungry." Stick to मुझे in your own speech — but understand मेरे को instantly.

CULTURE

भूख लगी है? (*bhookh lagee hai?*) is how Indian homes say "I love you". Expect it within minutes of arriving at your in-laws'. Protocol: refuse lightly once — बस, ठीक है (*bas, Theek hai*) — the food arrives anyway, and that's the point. A flat "no" to food reads colder in Delhi than it does in America.

Exercise 10A — Agreement drill

Fill the blank with the right form: है/हैं, लगा/लगी, लगता/लगती, रही, चाहिए, में. The verb agrees with the thing, not the person! Answers: Answer Key, Unit 10.

1. मुझे चाय पसंद ____। (*mujhe chaay pasand ____*.)

2. मुझे मोमोज़ पसंद ____। (*mujhe momos pasand ____*.)

3. उसे यह गाना पसंद ____। (*use yeh gaanaa pasand ____*.)

4. क्या आपको हिन्दी आती ____? (*kyaa aapko hindee aatee ____*?)

5. मुझे भूख ____ है। (*mujhe bhookh ____ hai*.)

6. मुझे ठंड लग ___ है। (*mujhe ThanD lag ___ hai.*)

7. हमें दो कमरे ___। (*hamen do kamre ___ .*)

8. मुझे दिल्ली अच्छी ___ है। (*mujhe dillee achchhee ___ hai.*)

9. मुझे यह शहर अच्छा ___ है। (*mujhe yeh shehar achchhaa ___ hai.*)

10. मेरे सिर ___ दर्द है। (*mere sir ___ dard hai.*)

Exercise 10B — Change the feeler

Rewrite for the new experiencer in brackets; keep everything else agreeing correctly.

1. मुझे चाय पसंद है। (आप — as a question) (*mujhe chaay pasand hai. → aap?*)

2. मुझे पानी चाहिए। (हम) (*mujhe paanee chaahiye. → ham*)

3. उसे ठंड लग रही है। (मैं) (*use ThanD lag rahee hai. → main*)

4. मुझे हिन्दी आती है। (मेरी पत्नी) (*mujhe hindee aatee hai. → meree patnee*)

5. मुझे पता है। (वे लोग — negative) (*mujhe pataa hai. → voh log, negative*)

6. मुझे मोमोज़ पसंद हैं। (जैकब) (*mujhe momos pasand hain. → jaikab*)

7. मुझे सिरदर्द है। (वह) (*mujhe sirdard hai. → voh*)

Exercise 10C — Translate into Hindi

Think "to-me" first, then check what the verb must agree with.

1. I like chai.

2. I like momos. (watch the verb!)

3. I'm hungry.

4. I'm feeling cold.

5. We need two rooms.

6. I have a headache.

7. Do you (आप) know Hindi?

8. I don't know.

Exercise 10D — Translate into English

Write natural English — not the literal "to-me" version.

1. मुझे नींद आ रही है। (*mujhe neend aa rahee hai.*)

2. क्या तुम्हें यह गाना पसंद है? (*kyaa tumhen yeh gaanaa pasand hai?*)

3. उसे कुत्तों से डर लगता है। (*use kutton se Dar lagtaa hai.*)

4. पहले यह खाना अजीब लगा, अब पसंद है। (*pehle yeh khaanaa ajeeb lagaa, ab pasand hai.*)

5. आपको क्या चाहिए? (*aapko kyaa chaahiye?*)

6. मुझे थोड़ी-थोड़ी हिन्दी आती है। (*mujhe thoRee-thoRee hindee aatee hai.*)

UNIT 11

The Past with था — and Past Habits & Ongoing Past

What you'll be able to say: how things were — where you were yesterday, what there used to be, what you did as a kid, and what was happening when the phone rang.

कल मौसम अच्छा था।

kal mausam achchhaa thaa. [kul maw-sum uch-chhah thah]

Yesterday the weather was nice. (mausam (m))

जब मैं छोटा था, मैं बहुत क्रिकेट खेलता था।

jab main chhoTaa thaa, main bahut krikeT kheltaa thaa. [jub meh(n) chhoh-Tah thah, meh(n) bo-hut kri-kayT khayl-tah thah]

When I was little, I played a lot of cricket. (krikeT (m))

रात को बारिश हो रही थी।

raat ko baarish ho rahee thee. [raht koh bah-rish hoh ruh-hee thee]

It was raining at night.

था / थी / थे / थीं — "was" and "were"

The past of होना has exactly four forms, and they agree like adjectives — by gender and number, not by person:

SUBJECT	MALE	FEMALE
मैं main	था <i>thaa</i>	थी <i>thee</i>
तू tu	था <i>thaa</i>	थी <i>thee</i>
यह / वह yeh / voh	था <i>thaa</i>	थी <i>thee</i>
तुम tum	थे <i>the</i>	थीं <i>theen</i>
आप aap	थे <i>the</i>	थीं <i>theen</i>
हम ham	थे <i>the</i>	थीं <i>theen</i>
ये / वे लोग ye / voh log	थे <i>the</i>	थीं <i>theen</i>

Say them: था [thah], थी [thee], थे [thay], थीं [thee(n)] — dental t plus a puff of air. थीं is the feminine plural (and feminine respect) form; in fast speech you may hear plain थी for तुम, but थीं is the standard.

कल मैं घर पर था।

kal main ghar par thaa. [kul meh(n) ghur pur thah]

Yesterday I was at home. (kal = yesterday here; the past verb tells you so — see Unit 12)

वह बहुत खुश थी।

voh bahut khush thee. [voh bo-hut khush thee]

She was very happy.

तुम कल शाम को कहाँ थे?

tum kal shaam ko kahaan the? [tum kul shahm koh kuh-hah(n) thay]

Where were you yesterday evening?

"There was / there were"

कमरे में एक पलंग था।

kamre mein ek palang thaa. [kum-ray may(n) ayk puh-lung thah]

There was a bed in the room. (palang (m))

घर के सामने एक पेड़ था।

ghar ke saamne ek peR thaa. [ghur kay sahm-nay ayk payR thah]

There was a tree in front of the house. (peR (m))

वहाँ बहुत लोग थे।

vahaan bahut log the. [vuh-hah(n) bo-hut lohg thay]

There were a lot of people there.

कल रात बिजली नहीं थी।

kal raat bijlee naheen thee. [kul raht bij-lee nuh-hee(n) thee]

There was no electricity last night. (bijlee (f)) (a very Delhi sentence in June)

मेरी दादी बहुत अच्छी थीं।

merie daadee bahut achchhee theen. [may-ree dah-dee bo-hut uch-chhee thee(n)]

My grandmother was very kind. (daadee (f)) (one respected lady → theen)

Past habits: -ता था "used to"

Take the Unit 8 habitual and swap the present auxiliary for the past one. Both parts agree: जाता था, जाते थे, जाती थी, जाती थीं (*jaataa thaa, jaate the, jaatee thee, jaatee theen*) [jah-tah thah, jah-tay thay, jah-tee thee, jah-tee thee(n)].

जब मैं छोटा था, हम शिकागो में रहते थे।

jab main chhoTaa thaa, ham shikaago mein rehte the. [jub meh(n) chhoh-Tah thah, hum shi-kah-goh may(n) reh-tay thay]

When I was little, we lived in Chicago. (jab = when — starts the clause)

जब मेरी पत्नी छोटी थी, वह पुरानी दिल्ली में रहती थी।

jab meree patnee chhoTee thee, voh puraanee dillee mein rehte thee. [jub may-ree put-nee chhoh-Tee thee, voh pu-rah-nee dil-lee may(n) reh-tee thee]

When my wife was little, she lived in Old Delhi.

वह बहुत चाय पीती थी।

voh bahut chaay peetee thee. [voh bo-hut chah-ay pee-tee thee]

She used to drink a lot of chai.

मेरे दादा जी रोज़ सैर करते थे।

mere daadaa jee roz sair karte the. [may-ray dah-dah jee rohz sehr kur-tay thay]

My grandfather used to take a walk every day. (daadaa (m))

पहले मैं हिन्दी नहीं समझता था।

pehle main hindee naheen samajhtaa thaa. [peh-lay meh(n) hin-dee nuh-hee(n) suh-mujh-tah thah]

Earlier I didn't understand Hindi. (note: thaa is NOT dropped after naheen)

Ongoing past: रहा था "was ...-ing"

Same trick with Unit 9: कर रहा हूँ → कर रहा था. What was in mid-flow when something else happened:

मैं सो रहा था।

main so rahaa thaa. [meh(n) soh ruh-hah thah]

I was sleeping.

तुम क्या कर रहे थे?

tum kyaa kar rahe the? [tum kyah kur ruh-hay thay]

What were you doing?

वह खाना बना रही थी।

voh khaanaa banaa rahee thee. [voh khah-nah buh-nah ruh-hee thee]

She was cooking.

कल रात तुम कहाँ थे? मैं फ़ोन कर रही थी!

kal raat tum kahaan the? main fon kar rahee thee! [kul raht tum kuh-hah(n) thay — meh(n) fohn kur ruh-hee thee]

Where were you last night? I was calling (you)! (she speaking — kar rahee thee)

हम टीवी देख रहे थे।

ham TeeVee dekh rahe the. [hum Tee-Vee daykh ruh-hay thay]

We were watching TV.

Time words for the past

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
कल	<i>kal</i>	kul	yesterday (and tomorrow! — Unit 12)
परसों	<i>parson</i>	pur-soh(n)	day before yesterday (and day after tomorrow)
पहले	<i>pehle</i>	peh-lay	earlier, in the past
पिछले हफ़्ते	<i>pichhle hafte</i> (haftaa m)	pichh-lay huf-tay	last week
पिछले महीने	<i>pichhle maheene</i> (maheena m)	pichh-lay muh-hee-nay	last month
पिछले साल	<i>pichhle saal</i> (saal m)	pichh-lay sahl	last year
उस वक़्त / उस समय	<i>us vaqt</i> (m) / <i>us samay</i> (m)	us vukt / us suh-may	at that time
बचपन में	<i>bachpan</i> (m) <i>mein</i>	buch-pun may(n)	in childhood

Notice पिछले (*pichhle*): पिछला bends to -e before हफ़्ते/महीने/साल because a time expression like this sits in the oblique — Unit 7 quietly at work again.

WATCH OUT

In the present you learned to drop the auxiliary after नहीं (मैं नहीं जाता). **Never drop था:** past negatives keep it — मैं नहीं जाता था (*main naheen jaataa thaa*), बिजली नहीं थी. Without था the sentence snaps back to the present. And keep the four-way agreement honest: दादी थीं (respect), दादा जी थे, बहनें थीं (*behnen theen*) [beh-nay(n) thee(n)] "the sisters were".

DELHI STREET NOTE

Every Delhi uncle has this speech ready: पहले यहाँ कुछ नहीं था (*pehle yahaan kuchh naheen thaa*) [peh-lay yuh-hah(n) kuchh nuh-hee(n) thah] "there used to be nothing here" — followed by अब मॉल है (*ab mol hai*) [ub mawl hei] "now there's a mall." The in-law version opens with हमारे ज़माने में... (*hamaare zamaane mein*) [huh-mah-ray zuh-mah-nay may(n)] "in our day..." (*zamaanaa (m)*). Nod along; it's a love language.

CULTURE

पुरानी दिल्ली (*puraanee dillee*) [pu-rah-nee dil-lee] — Old Delhi — is the walled Mughal city: Chandni Chowk चाँदनी चौक (*chaandnee chawk*) [chahnd-nee chawk], parathas, wedding-lehenga lanes. If the family has roots there, asking आप पहले कहाँ रहते थे? (*aap pehle kahaan rehte the?*) "where did you live before?" opens an evening of stories.

Exercise 11A — था, थी, थे or थीं?

Fill in the right past form of होना. Answers: Answer Key, Unit 11.

1. कल मैं घर पर ____। — Jacob speaking (*kal main ghar par ____*.)

2. वह बहुत खुश ____। — a woman (*voh bahut khush ____*.)

3. वहाँ बहुत लोग ____। (*vahaan bahut log ____*.)

4. पानी नहीं ____। (*paanee naheen ____*.)

5. कल रात बिजली नहीं ____। (*kal raat bijlee naheen ____*.)

6. मेरी दादी बहुत अच्छी ____। (*meree daadee bahut achchhee ____*.)

7. कमरे में दो पलंग ____। (*kamre mein do palang ____*.)

8. तुम कहाँ ____? — to a man (*tum kahaan ____*?)

9. आप कहाँ ____? — to your mother-in-law (*aap kahaan ____*?)

10. शादी से पहले हम पड़ोसी ____। (*shaadee se pehle ham paRosee ____*.)

Exercise 11B — Push it into the past

Rewrite each present sentence in the past (habitual → used to; continuous → was ...-ing).

1. मैं दिल्ली में रहता हूँ। (*main dillee mein rehtaa hoon.*)

2. वह चाय पीती है। (*voh chaay peetee hai.*)

3. हम साथ पढ़ते हैं। (*ham saath paRhate hain.*)

4. मैं सो रहा हूँ। (*main so rahaa hoon.*)

5. वह खाना बना रही है। (*voh khaanaa banaa rahee hai.*)

6. तुम क्या कर रहे हो? (*tum kyaa kar rahe ho?*)

7. मेरे दादा जी रोज़ सैर करते हैं। (*mere daadaa jee roz sair karte hain.*)

Exercise 11C — Translate into Hindi

Watch gender agreement on था — and remember नहीं keeps था.

1. Yesterday the weather was nice.

2. There was no electricity last night.

3. When I was little, we lived in Chicago.

4. She used to drink a lot of chai.

5. I was sleeping.

6. What were you (तुम, to a man) doing?

7. It was raining at night.

Exercise 11D — Translate into English

Write natural English.

1. शादी से पहले हम पड़ोसी थे। (shaadee se pehle ham paRosee the.)

2. पहले मैं हिन्दी नहीं समझता था। (*pehle main hindee naheen samajhtaa thaa.*)

3. मेरी दादी रोज़ मंदिर जाती थीं। (*merree daadee roz mandir jaatee theen.*)

4. कल रात तुम कहाँ थे? मैं फ़ोन कर रही थी! (*kal raat tum kahaan the? main fon kar rahee thee!*)

5. पहले यहाँ कुछ नहीं था, अब मॉल है। (*pehle yahaan kuchh naheen thaa, ab mol hai.*)

6. बचपन में वह बहुत क्रिकेट खेलता था। (*bachpan mein voh bahut krikeT kheltaa thaa.*)

UNIT 12

The Future Tense

What you'll be able to say: plans and promises — I'll call you, we'll meet tomorrow, she won't come, there will be a lot of people — plus the famous double life of कल.

मैं कल तुम्हें फ़ोन करूँगा।

main kal tumhen fon karoongaa. [meh(n) kul tum-hay(n) fohn kuh-roo(n)-gah]

I'll call you tomorrow.

हम अगले हफ़्ते आगरा जाएँगे।

ham agle hafte aagraa jaaenge. [hum ug-lay huf-tay ahg-rah jah-ay(n)-gay]

Next week we'll go to Agra. (aglaa "next" → oblique agle)

आप क्या लेंगे? — मैं चाय लूँगा।

aap kyaa lenge? — main chaay loongaa. [ahp kyah lay(n)-gay — meh(n) chah-ay loo(n)-gah]

What will you have? — I'll have chai. (the politest offer in any Delhi home)

The pattern: stem + person ending + गा/गे/गी

The future is two agreements stacked. First a person ending on the stem: **-ऊँ (-oon)** for मैं, **-ए (-e)** for तू/यह/वह, **-ओ (-o)** for तुम, **-एँ (-en)** for आप/हम/plurals. Then a gender tail that agrees like an adjective: **गा (gaa)** m sg, **गे (ge)** m pl, **गी (gee)** f. No auxiliary at all.

SUBJECT	MALE	FEMALE
मैं main	करूँगा <i>karoongaa</i>	करूँगी <i>karoongee</i>
तू tu	करेगा <i>karegaa</i>	करेगी <i>karegee</i>
यह / वह yeh / voh	करेगा <i>karegaa</i>	करेगी <i>karegee</i>
तुम tum	करोगे <i>karoge</i>	करोगी <i>karogee</i>
आप aap	करेंगे <i>karenge</i>	करेंगी <i>kareengee</i>
हम ham	करेंगे <i>karenge</i>	करेंगी <i>kareengee</i>
ये / वे लोग ye / voh log	करेंगे <i>karenge</i>	करेंगी <i>kareengee</i>

Sound check: करूँगा [kuh-roo(n)-gah], करेगा [kuh-ray-gah], करोगे [kuh-roh-gay], करेंगे [kuh-ray(n)-gay], करूँगी [kuh-roo(n)-gee], करेंगी [kuh-ray(n)-gee].

होना in the future

होना follows the same pattern on the stem हो: मैं हूँगा/हूँगी (*hoongaa/hoongee*) [hoo(n)-gah / hoo(n)-gee] · वह होगा/होगी (*hogaa/hogee*) [hoh-gah / hoh-gee] · तुम होंगे/होगी (*hoge/hogee*) [hoh-gay] · आप/हम/वे होंगे/होगी (*honge/hongee*) [hoh(n)-gay / hoh(n)-gee].

NOTE

होगा also does educated guessing — the "presumptive": वह घर पर होगा (*voh ghar par hogaa*) [voh ghur pur hoh-gah] can mean "he'll be home" or "he's probably home (right now)". Delhi runs on this: फ़ोन बंद है? मेट्रो में होगा। (*fon band hai? meTro mein hogaa.*) [fohn bund heh — may-Troh may(n) hoh-gah] "Phone off? He must be on the metro."

Vowel-ending stems: जा, आ, ले, दे

Stems ending in a vowel take a glue-letter before some endings. Learn these four as a set (feminine: swap final गा/गे for गी):

VERB	मैं	तू / वह	तुम	आप / हम / वे
जाना jaanaa	जाऊँगा <i>jaaongaa</i>	जाएगा <i>jaaegaa</i>	जाओगे <i>jaaoge</i>	जाएँगे <i>jaaenge</i>
आना aanaa	आऊँगा <i>aaongaa</i>	आएगा <i>aaegaa</i>	आओगे <i>aaoge</i>	आएँगे <i>aaenge</i>
लेना lenaa	लूँगा <i>loongaa</i>	लेगा <i>legaa</i>	लोगे <i>loge</i>	लेंगे <i>lenge</i>
देना denaa	दूँगा <i>doongaa</i>	देगा <i>degaa</i>	दोगे <i>doge</i>	देंगे <i>denge</i>

Say them: जाऊँगा [jah-oo(n)-gah], जाएगा [jah-ay-gah], जाएँगे [jah-ay(n)-gay], लूँगा [loo(n)-gah], देंगे [day(n)-gay].

कल is two-faced (so is परसों)

कल (*kal*) [kul] means **yesterday AND tomorrow** — one day away from today, in either direction. परसों (*parson*) [pur-soh(n)] is two days away, both directions. The *verb* settles which one:

कल मैं दिल्ली में था।

kal main dillee mein thaa. [kul meh(n) dil-lee may(n) thah]

Yesterday I was in Delhi. (thaa = past → kal means yesterday)

कल मैं दिल्ली जाऊँगा।

kal main dillee jaaongaa. [kul meh(n) dil-lee jah-oo(n)-gah]

Tomorrow I'll go to Delhi. (jaaongaa = future → kal means tomorrow)

परसों छुट्टी होगी।

parson chhuTTee hogee. [pur-soh(n) chhuT-Tee hoh-gee]

The day after tomorrow is a holiday. (chhuTTee (f))

Plans and promises

वह नहीं आएगी।

voh naheen aaegee. [voh nuh-hee(n) ah-ay-gee]

She won't come.

तुम कब आओगे?

tum kab aaoge? [tum kub ah-oh-gay]

When will you come?

मैं देर से नहीं आऊँगा, वादा!

main der se naheen aaoongaa, vaadaa! [meh(n) dayr say nuh-hee(n) ah-oo(n)-gah, vah-dah]

I won't be late — promise! (vaadaa (m))

शादी में बहुत लोग होंगे।

shaadee mein bahut log honge. [shah-dee may(n) bo-hut loh-g hoh(n)-gay]

There will be a lot of people at the wedding.

पार्टी कल रात को होगी।

paarTee kal raat ko hogee. [pahr-Tee kul raht koh hoh-gee]

The party will be tomorrow night. (paarTee (f))

मैं तुम्हारे लिए मोमोज़ लाऊँगा।

main tumhaare liye momos laaoongaa. [meh(n) tum-hah-ray li-yay moh-mohz lah-oo(n)-gah]

I'll bring momos for you. (laanaa = to bring — the fastest route to anyone's heart)

अगले साल हम अमेरिका जाएँगे।

agle saal ham amreekaa jaaenge. [ug-lay sahl hum um-ree-kah jah-ay(n)-gay]

Next year we'll go to America.

ठीक है, मैं आपको बताऊँगा।

Theek hai, main aapko bataaoongaa. [Theek heh, meh(n) ahp-koh buh-tah-oo(n)-gah]

Okay, I'll let you know.

मिलते हैं vs. मिलेंगे

Two ways to say "see you", and the difference is warmth vs. commitment. The habitual फिर मिलते हैं (*phir milte hain*) [phir mil-tay heh(n)] — literally "so, we meet again" — is the breezy sign-off, like "catch you later". The future कल मिलेंगे (*kal milenge*) [kul mi-lay(n)-gay] pins an actual plan: we WILL meet tomorrow.

चलो, फिर मिलते हैं!

chalo, phir milte hain! [chuh-loh, phir mil-tay heh(n)]

Okay then, see you around!

कल शाम को मिलेंगे, पक्का।

kal shaam ko milenge, pakkaa. [kul shahm koh mi-lay(n)-gay, puk-kah]

We'll meet tomorrow evening — for sure. (pakkaa = fixed, confirmed; Delhi's favourite seal)

WATCH OUT

The future carries your gender in its tail. Jacob: मैं करूँगा, जाऊँगा; his wife: मैं करूँगी, जाऊँगी. Read the गा/गी off your own gender, not your listener's. And ✗ मैं करेंगे mixes "I" with the हम ending — "I" is always करूँगा/करूँगी; करेंगे belongs to हम/आप/वे. A mixed or all-male "we" says करेंगे; an all-female "we" says करेंगी.

DELHI STREET NOTE

The most Delhi verb form of all: हो जाएगा (*ho jaaegaa*) [hoh jah-ay-gah] — "it'll get done." The electrician says it, the tailor says it, the ministry clerk says it. कल आना, हो जाएगा (*kal aanaa, ho jaaegaa*) "come tomorrow, it'll be done" — in which कल is gloriously elastic. Its cousin देखेंगे (*dekhenge*) [day-khay(n)-gay] "we'll see" usually means "probably not, but let's not fight about it."

CULTURE

Delhi's wedding season runs November to February, on dates astrologers approve — so some nights the whole city is a बारात (*baaraat (f)*) [bah-raht], the groom's procession, brass band and all. दिसंबर में हर वीकेंड शादी होगी (*disambar mein har veekenD shaadee hogee*) [di-sum-bur may(n) hur vee-kenD shah-dee hoh-gee] "in December there'll be a wedding every weekend" — and you WILL be invited.

Exercise 12A — Fill in the future form

Put the bracketed verb into the future. Watch person and gender. Answers: Answer Key, Unit 12.

1. मैं कल फ़ोन ___ (करना)। — Jacob speaking (*main kal fon ___ .*)

2. वह कल नहीं ___ (आना)। — a woman (*voh kal naheen ___ .*)

3. हम शाम को ___ (मिलना)। (*ham shaam ko ___ .*)

4. तुम कब ___ (आना)? — to a man (*tum kab ___ ?*)

5. आप क्या ___ (लेना)? (*aap kyaa ___ ?*)

6. मैं चाय ___ (लेना)। — Jacob speaking (*main chaay ___ .*)

7. शादी में बहुत लोग ___ (होना)। (*shaadee mein bahut log ___ .*)

8. पार्टी कल रात को ___ (होना)। (*paarTee kal raat ko ___ .*)

9. अगले साल हम अमेरिका ___ (जाना)। (*agle saal ham amreekaa ___ .*)

10. प्रिया तुम्हें कल ___ (बताना)। (*priyaa tumhen kal ___ .*)

Exercise 12B — Habit today, plan tomorrow

Rewrite each habitual sentence in the future (add कल or अगले हफ़्ते if it helps).

1. मैं तुम्हें फ़ोन करता हूँ। (*main tumhen fon kartaa hoon.*)

2. वह घर पर खाना खाती है। (*voh ghar par khaanaa khaatee hai.*)

3. हम मेट्रो से जाते हैं। (*ham meTro se jaate hain.*)

4. तुम कितने बजे उठते हो? (*tum kitne baje uThte ho?*)

5. आप कहाँ रहते हैं? (*aap kahaan rehte hain?*)

6. वे लोग फ़िल्म देखते हैं। (*voh log film dekhte hain.*)

7. मैं गोश्त नहीं खाता। (*main gosht naheen khaataa.*)

Exercise 12C — Translate into Hindi

You (Jacob) are male. Mind कल's two faces — the verb must carry the tense.

1. I'll call you (तुम) tomorrow.

2. Yesterday I was at home. Tomorrow I will be in the office.

3. She won't come.

4. What will you (आप) have? — I'll have chai.

5. We'll meet in the evening.

6. There will be a lot of people at the wedding.

7. Next week we'll go to Agra.

Exercise 12D — Translate into English

First decide: is कल yesterday or tomorrow here?

1. कल मैं दिल्ली में था। (*kal main dillee mein thaa.*)

2. कल मैं दिल्ली जाऊँगा। (*kal main dillee jaaongaa.*)

3. मैं देर से नहीं आऊँगा, वादा! (*main der se naheen aaoongaa, vaadaa!*)

4. वह घर पर होगा। (*voh ghar par hogaa.*)

5. परसों छुट्टी होगी। (*parson chhuTTee hogee.*)

6. चलो, फिर मिलते हैं! (*chalo, phir milte hain!*)

UNIT 13

Imperatives & Requests

What you'll be able to say: ask people to do things at exactly the right level of politeness — from a blunt कर *kar* [kur] with your closest people to a gracious कीजिए *keekiye* [kee-ji-yay] with your in-laws — and soften any request so it sounds warm, not bossy.

ज़रा सुनिए।

zaraa suniye. [zuh-rah su-ni-yay]

Excuse me — could you listen a moment? (lit. a-little listen)

यहाँ बैठो न।

yahaan baiTho na. [yuh-hah(n) beh-Thoh nuh]

Sit here, won't you?

चलिए, चाय पीते हैं।

chaliye, chaay peete hain. [chuh-li-yay, chah-ay pee-tay heh(n)]

Come, let's have chai.

One command, three levels

You already know Hindi has three words for "you": तू *tu* [too] (intimate), तुम *tum* [tum] (familiar), आप *aap* [ahp] (respectful). Commands come in the same three levels, and they're wonderfully regular. Take the verb stem (infinitive minus *-naa*) and:

LEVEL	FORM	SOUNDS LIKE	USE WITH
तू <i>tu</i>	bare stem: बोल <i>bol</i>	bohl	very close people only — intimate or blunt
तुम <i>tum</i>	stem + -ओ -o: बोलो <i>bolo</i>	boh-loh	partner, friends, kids
आप <i>aap</i>	stem + -इए -iye: बोलिए <i>boliye</i>	boh-li-yay	elders, in-laws, strangers

The endings are easy to hear: -o [oh] for *tum*, -iye [i-yay] for *aap*. Regular verbs:

INFINITIVE	तू <i>TU</i>	तुम <i>TUM</i>	आप <i>AAP</i>
बोलना <i>bolnaa</i> speak	बोल <i>bol</i>	बोलो <i>bolo</i>	बोलिए <i>boliye</i>

INFINITIVE	तू TU	तुम TUM	आप AAP
सुनना <i>sunnaa</i> listen	सुन <i>sun</i>	सुनो <i>suno</i>	सुनिए <i>suniye</i>
बैठना <i>baiThnaa</i> sit	बैठ <i>baiTh</i>	बैठो <i>baiTho</i>	बैठिए <i>baiThiye</i>
लिखना <i>likhnaa</i> write	लिख <i>likh</i>	लिखो <i>likho</i>	लिखिए <i>likhiye</i>
खोलना <i>kholnaa</i> open	खोल <i>khol</i>	खोलो <i>kholo</i>	खोलिए <i>kholiye</i>
रुकना <i>ruknaa</i> stop, wait	रुक <i>ruk</i>	रुको <i>ruko</i>	रुकिए <i>rukiye</i>
चलना <i>chalnaa</i> move, go	चल <i>chal</i>	चलो <i>chalo</i>	चलिए <i>chaliye</i>

The famous irregulars

Five very common verbs replace their vowel in the *aap*-form with a long *ee* + *-jiye* [jee-ji-yay pattern]; पीना *peenaa* also changes its *tum*-form. Learn these as words:

INFINITIVE	तू TU	तुम TUM	आप AAP
करना <i>karnaa</i> do	कर <i>kar</i>	करो <i>karo</i>	कीजिए <i>keejiye</i>
देना <i>denaa</i> give	दे <i>de</i>	दो <i>do</i>	दीजिए <i>deejaye</i>
लेना <i>lena</i> take	ले <i>le</i>	लो <i>lo</i>	लीजिए <i>leejiye</i>
पीना <i>peenaa</i> drink	पी <i>pee</i>	पियो <i>piyo</i>	पीजिए <i>peejiye</i>
आना <i>aanaa</i> come	आ <i>aa</i>	आओ <i>aao</i>	आइए <i>aaiye</i>
जाना <i>jaanaa</i> go	जा <i>jaa</i>	जाओ <i>jaao</i>	जाइए <i>jaaiye</i>
कहना <i>kehnaa</i> say	कह <i>keh</i>	कहो <i>kaho</i>	कहिए <i>kahiye</i>

Say them: *keejiye* [kee-ji-yay], *deejaye* [dee-ji-yay], *leejiye* [lee-ji-yay], *peejiye* [pee-ji-yay], *aaiye* [ah-i-yay], *jaaiye* [jah-i-yay], *piyo* [pi-yoh], *kahiye* [kuh-hi-yay].

NOTE

About तू *tu*: the bare-stem command (*kar*, *jaa*, *de*) is for lovers, small children, God — and fights. Delhiites even have a word for rude *tu*-talk: तू-तड़ाक *tu-taRaak* [too-tuh-Rahk]. Your partner may use it with you affectionately; never use it with anyone else until they use it with you first. When in doubt, *tum*-forms with friends, *aap*-forms with everyone older.

WATCH OUT

Keep the pronoun and the verb form at the SAME level. Learners love to mix: आप बैठो *aap baiTho* or तुम बैठिए *tum baiThiye*. Match them: तुम बैठो *tum baiTho* · आप बैठिए *aap baiThiye*. (Delhiites themselves sometimes say *aap baiTho* in relaxed speech — but from a learner it just sounds like an error. Stay matched.)

The gentle instruction: infinitive as command

Hindi has a fourth, very handy level: use the bare infinitive (*-naa* form) as a soft instruction for something to be done later. It feels like "do make sure you..." between equals — friendlier than *karo*, less formal than *keekiye*.

कल मुझे फ़ोन करना।

kal mujhe fon karnaa. [kul mu-jhay fohn kur-nah]

Call me tomorrow, okay?

यहाँ अपना नाम लिखना।

yahaan apnaa naam likhnaa. [yuh-hah(n) up-nah nahm likh-nah]

Write your name here.

भैया, दो चाय देना।

bhaiyaa, do chaay denaa. [bheh-yah, doh chah-ay day-nah]

Bhaiya, give (us) two chais. (the classic chai-stall order)

Saying "don't": मत *mat* and न *na*

मत *mat* [mut] is the strong "don't" — it goes right before the verb, with *tu-*, *tum-* and infinitive commands. न *na* [nuh] is the gentler "don't", preferred with *aap*-forms.

देर मत करो।

der mat karo. [dayr mut kuh-roh]

Don't be late. (lit. don't do lateness)

चिंता न कीजिए।

chintaa na keekiye. [chin-tah nuh kee-ji-yay]

Please don't worry.

अभी मत जाओ।

abhee mat jaaō. [uh-bhee mut jah-oh]

Don't go yet.

In relaxed Delhi speech you'll also hear *mat* with *aap*-forms (मत कीजिए *mat keejiye*) — fine to understand, but *na keejiye* is the polished choice.

Softeners: how not to sound bossy

A bare command is fine in Hindi between equals — पानी दो *paanee do* is normal, not rude. But these little words add warmth:

SOFTENER	SAY IT	EFFECT
ज़रा <i>zaraa</i>	zuh-rah	"just / a moment" — the all-purpose politener: ज़रा सुनिए <i>zaraa suniye</i>
थोड़ा <i>thoRaa</i>	thoh-Rah	"a little": थोड़ा धीरे बोलिए <i>thoRaa dheere boliye</i>
न <i>na</i> (tagged after)	nuh	coaxing "won't you": आओ न <i>aao na</i>
प्लीज़ <i>pleez</i>	pleez	English "please", totally at home in Delhi: प्लीज़ रुको <i>pleez ruko</i>
जी <i>jee</i>	jee	respect particle: जी, बैठिए <i>jee, baiThiye</i>

NOTE

You may see कृपया *kripayaa* [kri-puh-yah] ("please") on signs and metro announcements. In conversation it sounds like an announcement — use *zaraa*, *pleez* or simply the *-iye* form instead.

चलो *chalo*, चलिए *chaliye*, चलें *chalen*

The little family of "let's":

चलो <i>chalo</i> chuh-loh	"come on / let's go / fine then" — with friends, and as an all-purpose "okay, moving on"
चलिए <i>chaliye</i> chuh-li-yay	polite "let's go / after you / very well"

चलें? <i>chalen?</i> chuh-lay(n)	"shall we go?" — a polite proposal (this is the subjunctive; full grammar in Unit 18)
----------------------------------	---

चलो, देर हो रही है।

chalo, der ho rahee hai. [chuh-loh, dayr hoh ruh-hee heh]

Come on, it's getting late.

Asking, not ordering

For real requests to strangers and elders, stack politeness: attention-getter + *-iye* form. And here's a preview of the pattern you'll master in Unit 16 — "can you...":

माफ़ कीजिए, ज़रा सुनिए।

maaf keejiye, zaraa suniye. [mahf kee-ji-yay, zuh-rah su-ni-yay]

Excuse me — could I have a moment?

क्या आप धीरे बोल सकते हैं?

kyaa aap dheere bol sakte hain? [kyah ahp dheeray bohl suk-tay heh(n)]

Can you speak slowly? (preview of *saknaa*, Unit 16)

एक मिनट रुकिए।

ek minaT rukiye. [ayk mi-nuT ru-ki-yay]

Please wait one minute.

More examples, Delhi-real

दरवाज़ा खोलो।

darvaazaa kholo. [dur-vah-zah khoh-loh]

Open the door.

खिड़की बंद करो, बाहर शोर है।

khiRkee band karo, baahar shor hai. [khiR-kee bund kuh-roh, bah-hur shohr heh]

Close the window, it's noisy outside.

अंदर आइए, बैठिए।

andar aaiye, baiThiye. [un-dur ah-i-yay, beh-Thi-yay]

Come in, please sit. (the standard welcome)

यह लीजिए।

yeh leejiye. [yeh lee-ji-yeh]

Here you are. (lit. take this — said when handing anything over)

थोड़ा और लीजिए न।

thoRaa aur leejiye na. [thoh-Rah awr lee-ji-yay nuh]

Do take a little more. (what your saas will say at dinner)

मुझे बताओ, क्या बनाऊँ?

mujhe bataao, kyaa banaaon? [mu-jhay buh-tah-oh, kyah buh-nah-oo(n)]

Tell me — what should I make? (banaaon = "should I make", Unit 18)

DELHI STREET NOTE

Delhi tags न *na* and यार *yaar* [yahr] onto everything: चल न यार *chal na yaar* [chul nuh yahr] "come oon, man". Stress-management, Delhi style: टेंशन मत लो *Tenshan mat lo* [Ten-shun mut loh] "don't take tension" and रहने दो *rehne do* [reh-nay doh] "let it be". You'll hear *aap* mixed with *tum*-forms (*aap aa jaa*) constantly — understand it, don't copy it yet.

CULTURE

At your in-laws', the *-iye* forms plus जी *jee* are your uniform: बैठिए जी, खाना लीजिए. Meanwhile your elders will call you बेटा *beTaa* [bay-Tah] ("son") and command you with *tum*- or even *tu*-forms — बैठो बेटा. That's affection and seniority, not rudeness; you still answer with *aap*. Refusing seconds? Say बस, बहुत है *bas, bahut hai* [bus, bo-hut heh] — and expect to be served anyway.

New words in this unit

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
दरवाज़ा	<i>darvaazaa</i> (m)	dur-vah-zah	door
खिड़की	<i>khiRkee</i> (f)	khiR-kee	window
बत्ती	<i>battee</i> (f)	but-tee	light, lamp
शोर	<i>shor</i> (m)	shohr	noise
चिंता	<i>chintaa</i> (f)	chin-tah	worry
देर	<i>der</i> (f)	dayr	delay, lateness

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
मिनट	<i>minaT</i> (m)	mi-nuT	minute
धीरे	<i>dheere</i>	dhee-ray	slowly, softly
ज़ोर से	<i>zor se</i>	zohr say	loudly
खोलना	<i>kholnaa</i>	khohl-nah	to open
बंद करना	<i>band karnaa</i>	bund kur-nah	to close, turn off
रुकना	<i>ruknaa</i>	ruk-nah	to stop, to wait
माफ़ करना	<i>maaf karnaa</i>	mahf kur-nah	to forgive, excuse

Exercise 13A — Make the command

Write the correct command form of the verb in brackets, at the level shown. Answers: Answer Key, Unit 13.

1. धीरे ____। (*dheere* ____.) (बोलना bolnaa → आप)

2. यहाँ ____। (*yahaan* ____.) (बैठना baiThnaa → तुम)

3. दरवाज़ा ____। (*darvaazaa* ____.) (खोलना kholnaa → तुम)

4. ज़रा ____। (*zaraa* ____.) (सुनना sunnaa → आप)

5. चाय ____। (*chaay* ____.) (लेना lenaa → आप)

6. मुझे पानी ____। (*mujhe paanee* ____.) (देना denaa → तुम)

7. अंदर ____। (*andar* ____.) (आना aanaa → आप)

8. जल्दी ____। (*jaldee* ____.) (करना karnaa → तुम)

9. मेरे साथ ____। (*mere saath ____*.) (चलना *chalnaa* → आप)

10. बत्ती बंद ____। (*battee band ____*.) (करना *karnaa* → आप)

Exercise 13B — Make it polite

Rewrite each *tum*-command as an *aap*-command. In 7-8, keep it negative (use न *na*). Answers: Answer Key, Unit 13.

1. यहाँ बैठो। (*yahaan baiTho.*)

2. धीरे बोलो। (*dheere bolo.*)

3. यह लो। (*yeh lo.*)

4. मुझे बताओ। (*mujhe bataao.*)

5. खिड़की खोलो। (*khiRkee kholo.*)

6. चाय पियो। (*chaay piyo.*)

7. यहाँ मत बैठो। (*yahaan mat baiTho.*)

8. देर मत करो। (*der mat karo.*)

Exercise 13C — Translate into Hindi

Write each request in Hindi at the level shown — Roman on the first line, Devanagari on the second if you can. Answers: Answer Key, Unit 13.

1. Please sit here. (aap)

2. Give me water. (tum)

3. Don't go yet. (tum)

4. Please come inside. (aap)

5. Please speak a little slowly. (aap)

6. Close the window. (tum)

7. Call me tomorrow. (gentle infinitive form)

8. Please don't worry. (aap)

Exercise 13D — Translate into English

Give a natural English version. Answers: Answer Key, Unit 13.

1. ज़रा सुनिए। (zaraa suniye.)

2. चिंता मत करो। (chintaa mat karo.)

3. कल ज़रूर आना। (kal zaroor aanaa.)

4. थोड़ा और लीजिए न। (thoRaa aur leejiye na.)

5. चलो, देर हो रही है। (chalo, der ho rahee hai.)

6. माफ़ कीजिए, एक मिनट रुकिए। (maaf keejiye, ek minaT rukiye.)

UNIT 14

Simple Past & the Ergative ने ne

What you'll be able to say: what happened — I went, she came, we ate, who did it. This unit contains the single most famous rule in Hindi grammar, the little word ने *ne* [nay]. Take it slowly; we'll build it in three small steps.

मैं कल बाज़ार गया।

main kal baazaar gayaa. [meh(n) kul bah-zahr guh-yah]

I went to the market yesterday.

मैंने चाय पी।

maine chaay pee. [meh(n)-nay chah-ay pee]

I drank tea. (lit. I-ne tea drank-f — wait for Step 3!)

तुमने क्या खाया?

tumne kyaa khaayaa? [tum-nay kyah khah-yah]

What did you eat?

Step 1 — The shape of the past: the perfective participle

The simple past ("did/went/ate" — done, over) uses the *perfective participle*: verb stem + an ending that changes for gender and number, exactly like the adjective endings you know from *achchhaa* / *achchhe* / *achchhee*:

	M SG	M PL	F SG	F PL
ending	-आ -aa	-ए -e	-ई -ee	-ई -een
बैठना <i>baiThnaa</i> sit	बैठा <i>baiThaa</i>	बैठे <i>baiThe</i>	बैठी <i>baiThee</i>	बैठीं <i>baiTheen</i>
उठना <i>uThnaa</i> get up	उठा <i>uThaa</i>	उठे <i>uThe</i>	उठी <i>uThee</i>	उठीं <i>uTheen</i>
आना <i>aanaa</i> come	आया <i>aayaa</i>	आए <i>aae</i>	आई <i>aaee</i>	आईं <i>aaeen</i>
सोना <i>sonaa</i> sleep	सोया <i>soyaa</i>	सोए <i>soe</i>	सोई <i>soee</i>	सोईं <i>soeen</i>

Say the endings: -aa [ah], -e [ay], -ee [ee], -een [ee(n)]. Note the glide: stems ending in a vowel (aa-, so-) slip in a y before -aa: *aayaa* [ah-yah], *soyaa* [soh-yah] — but not in the feminine: *aaee* [ah-ee], *soee* [soh-ee].

Step 2 — Movement & change verbs: NO ne, agree with the subject

With intransitive verbs (vi) — going, coming, arriving, sitting, sleeping, happening — the past is beautifully simple: **subject + participle, and the participle agrees with the subject.** No *ne* anywhere.

मेरी बहन कल दिल्ली गई।

merree behen kal dillee gae. [may-ree beh-hen kul dil-lee guh-ee]

My sister went to Delhi yesterday. (gae f, matching behen)

हम शाम को घर आए।

ham shaam ko ghar aae. [hum shahm koh ghur ah-ay]

We came home in the evening.

आप कब पहुँचे?

aap kab pahunche? [ahp kub puh-hun-chay]

When did you arrive? (to a woman: आप कब पहुँची? aap kab pahuncheen? [ahp kub puh-hun-chee(n)])

वह देर से उठी।

voh der se uThee. [voh dayr say u-Thee]

She got up late.

क्या हुआ?

kyaa huaa? [kyah hu-ah]

What happened? (huaa = past of honaa)

Note the two star irregulars here: जाना *jaanaa* becomes गया *gayaa* [guh-yah] (not *jaayaa), and होना *honaa* becomes हुआ *huaa* [hu-ah]. Full forms below in Step 3's table.

Step 3 — Doing-verbs: subject + ने ne, verb agrees with the OBJECT

Now the famous part. With transitive verbs (vt) — verbs that act on something: eat, drink, read, see, make — the past works differently:

NOTE

The ne rule. 1) Mark the doer with ने *ne*. 2) The verb then ignores the doer completely and **agrees with the object** in gender and number. 3) This happens ONLY in perfective (did/have done/had done) tenses — never in present, continuous or future.

मैंने चाय पी।

maine chaay pee. [meh(n)-nay chah-ay pee]

I drank tea. (chaay is f — so pee, even though Jacob is m)

मैंने खाना खाया।

maine khaanaa khaayaa. [meh(n)-nay khah-nah khah-yah]

I ate food. (khaanaa m → khaayaa)

उसने किताब पढ़ी।

usne kitaab paRhee. [us-nay ki-tahb puh-Rhee]

He/she read a book. (kitaab f → paRhee)

हमने समोसे खाए।

hamne samose khaae. [hum-nay suh-moh-say khah-ay]

We ate samosas. (samose m pl → khaae)

उन्होंने दो रोटियाँ खाईं।

unhonne do roTiyaan khaaen. [un-hoh(n)-nay doh roh-Ti-yah(n) khah-ee(n)]

They ate two rotis. (roTiyaan f pl → khaaen)

Whether the doer is a man, a woman, or a crowd, the verb doesn't budge — it's locked onto the object. राज ने चाय पी। दीपा ने चाय पी। *raaj ne chaay pee. deepaa ne chaay pee.* [rahj nay chah-ay pee · dee-pah nay chah-ay pee] Both *pee*.

The ne-forms of the pronouns

Pronouns fuse with *ne* into single words; nouns just add *ne* separately (राज ने *raaj ne*).

PRONOUN	+ NE	SAY IT	PRONOUN	+ NE	SAY IT
मैं <i>main</i>	मैंने <i>maine</i>	meh(n)-nay	हम <i>ham</i>	हमने <i>hamne</i>	hum-nay
तू <i>tu</i>	तूने <i>tune</i>	too-nay	तुम <i>tum</i>	तुमने <i>tumne</i>	tum-nay
यह <i>yeh</i>	इसने <i>isne</i>	is-nay	आप <i>aap</i>	आपने <i>aapne</i>	ahp-nay
वह <i>voh</i>	उसने <i>usne</i>	us-nay	वे / वो लोग <i>voh log</i>	उन्होंने <i>unhonne</i>	un-hoh(n)-nay
कौन <i>kaun</i>	किसने <i>kisne</i>	kis-nay			

The irregular participles — learn these six cold

VERB	M SG	M PL	F SG	F PL
करना <i>karnaa</i> (vt) do	किया <i>kiyaa</i>	किए <i>kiye</i>	की <i>kee</i>	कीं <i>keen</i>
देना <i>denaa</i> (vt) give	दिया <i>diyaa</i>	दिए <i>diye</i>	दी <i>dee</i>	दीं <i>deen</i>
लेना <i>lenaa</i> (vt) take	लिया <i>liyaa</i>	लिए <i>liye</i>	ली <i>lee</i>	लीं <i>leen</i>
पीना <i>peenaa</i> (vt) drink	पिया <i>piyaa</i>	पिए <i>piye</i>	पी <i>pee</i>	पीं <i>peen</i>
जाना <i>jaanaa</i> (vi — no ne) go	गया <i>gayaa</i>	गए <i>gae</i>	गई <i>gaee</i>	गईं <i>gaeen</i>
होना <i>hona</i> (vi — no ne) happen, be	हुआ <i>huua</i>	हुए <i>hue</i>	हुई <i>huee</i>	हुईं <i>hueen</i>

Say them: *kiyaa* [ki-yah], *kee* [kee], *diyaa* [di-yah], *liyaa* [li-yah], *piyaa* [pi-yah], *gae* [guh-ay], *gaeen* [guh-ee(n)], *hue* [hu-ay], *huee* [hu-ee].

When the object has को ko: verb goes to default (m sg)

If the object carries को *ko* — as person-objects and definite objects do — the verb can't agree with it anymore. It falls back to the default form: masculine singular.

मैंने अपनी बहन को देखा।

maine apnee behen ko dekhaa. [meh(n)-nay up-nee beh-hen koh day-khah]

I saw my sister. (behen f, but behen KO → dekhaa, default m sg)

उसने मुझे नहीं देखा।

usne mujhe naheen dekhaa. [us-nay mu-jhay nuh-hee(n) day-khah]

He/she didn't see me. (mujhe = mujh + ko in disguise)

हमने बच्चों को बुलाया।

hamne bachchon ko bulaayaa. [hum-nay buch-choh(n) koh bu-lah-yah]

We called the kids (over).

Compare: मैंने किताब पढ़ी *maine kitaab paRhee* (no *ko* → agree with *kitaab*) vs मैंने इस किताब को पढ़ा *maine is kitaab ko paRhaa* [meh(n)-nay is ki-tahb koh puh-Rhah] (with *ko* → default). Both correct; the first is more common for things.

Two rebels: लाना *laanaa* and बोलना *bolnaa*

NOTE

Two everyday verbs look transitive but take **no ne**: लाना *laanaa* "bring" and बोलना *bolnaa* "speak". मैं मिठाई लाया। *main miThaaee laayaa*. [meh(n) mi-Thah-ee lah-yah] "I brought sweets" — verb agrees with the (male) speaker; a woman says मैं मिठाई लाई। *main miThaaee laaee*. Likewise वह बोला / वह बोली *voh bolaa / voh bolee* "he said / she said".

Negatives and questions

Nothing new to learn: नहीं *naheen* before the verb, question words in place.

मैंने कुछ नहीं किया।

maine kuchh naheen kiya. [meh(n)-nay kuchh nuh-hee(n) ki-yah]

I didn't do anything.

किसने दरवाज़ा खोला?

kisne darvaazaa kholaa? [kis-nay dur-vah-zah khoh-lah]

Who opened the door?

तुमने क्या कहा?

tumne kyaa kahaa? [tum-nay kyah kuh-hah]

What did you say?

आपने बहुत अच्छा खाना बनाया।

aapne bahut achchhaa khaanaa banaayaa. [ahp-nay bo-hut uch-chhah khah-nah buh-nah-yah]

You made really good food. (say this to your saas; watch the smile)

शादी में बहुत मज़ा आया।

shaadee mein bahut mazaa aayaa. [shah-dee may(n) bo-hut muh-zah ah-yah]

The wedding was great fun. (lit. much fun came — mazaa m, aanaa: no ne)

WATCH OUT**The three classic ne disasters — and their fixes:**

1. Putting *ne* on go/come/be verbs: *मैंने गया **maine gayaa* and *मैं गया ने **main gayaa ne* are both impossible. Going verbs never see *ne*: मैं गया। *main gayaa*.
2. Letting the verb agree with the doer: *मैंने चाय पिया **maine chaay piyaa*. With *ne*, the doer is invisible to the verb — *chaay* is feminine, so: मैंने चाय पी। *maine chaay pee*.
3. Using *ne* outside the perfective: *मैंने चाय पीता हूँ **maine chaay peetaa hoon*. Present, continuous and future keep the plain subject: मैं चाय पीता हूँ। *main chaay peetaa hoon*.

DELHI STREET NOTE

The all-purpose Delhi catch-up opener: और बताओ, कल क्या किया? *aur bataao, kal kyaa kiyaa?* [awr buh-tah-oh, kul kyah ki-yah] "So tell me, what did you do yesterday?" You'll also constantly hear हो गया? *ho gayaa?* [hoh guh-yah] "done?" (that two-verb trick is Unit 19). And Delhiites often say मैंने बोला *maine bolaa* for "I said" even though the standard is *main bolaa* — understand it; in your own speech, मैंने कहा *maine kahaa* is always safe.

New words in this unit

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
समोसा	<i>samosaa</i> (m)	suh-moh-sah	samosa
रोटी	<i>roTee</i> (f)	roh-Tee	roti, flatbread
अंडा	<i>anDaa</i> (m)	un-Dah	egg
मिठाई	<i>miThaaee</i> (f)	mi-Thah-ee	sweets
मज़ा	<i>mazaa</i> (m)	muh-zah	fun, enjoyment
गाना	<i>gaanaa</i> (m)	gah-nah	song
फ़िल्म	<i>film</i> (f)	film	film, movie
रात	<i>raat</i> (f)	raht	night
शादी	<i>shaadee</i> (f)	shah-dee	wedding, marriage
ख़रीदना	<i>khareednaa</i> (vt)	khuh-reed-nah	to buy
बुलाना	<i>bulaanaa</i> (vt)	bu-lah-nah	to call, invite

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
लाना	<i>laanaa</i> (vt, no ne)	lah-nah	to bring
पहुँचना	<i>pahunchnaa</i> (vi)	puh-hunch-nah	to arrive

Exercise 14A — ne or no ne?

Fill the blank: items 1-2, 4, 8 need the right past form of the verb in brackets; items 3, 5, 9 need the right subject form (with or without ne); the rest need both thinking steps. Answers: Answer Key, Unit 14.

1. मैं कल बाज़ार ____। (*main kal baazaar ____.*) (जाना *jaanaa*; Jacob speaking)

2. मेरी बहन कल दिल्ली ____। (*meree behen kal dillee ____.*) (जाना *jaanaa*)

3. ____ चाय पी। (*____ chaay pee.*) (मैं *main*)

4. हम शाम को घर ____। (*ham shaam ko ghar ____.*) (आना *aanaa*)

5. ____ यह किताब पढ़ी। (*____ yeh kitaab paRhee.*) (वह *voh*)

6. मैंने दो समोसे ____। (*maine do samose ____.*) (खाना *khaanaa*)

7. तुमने दूध ____? (*tumne doodh ____?*) (पीना *peenaa*)

8. आप कब ____? (*aap kab ____?*) (पहुँचना *pahunchnaa*; asking a man)

9. ____ काम किया। (*____ kaam kiya.*) (वे लोग *voh log*)

10. किसने दरवाज़ा ____? (*kisne darvaazaa ____?*) (खोलना *kholnaa*)

Exercise 14B — Yesterday, not every day

Rewrite each habitual sentence as a simple past with कल kal (yesterday). Keep the same people.

Answers: Answer Key, Unit 14.

1. मैं रोज़ चाय पीता हूँ। (main roz chaay peetaa hoon.)

2. वह रोज़ बाज़ार जाती है। (voh roz baazaar jaatee hai.)

3. हम रोज़ रोटी खाते हैं। (ham roz roTee khaate hain.)

4. तुम रोज़ गाना सुनते हो। (tum roz gaanaa sunte ho.)

5. मैं रोज़ काम करता हूँ। (main roz kaam kartaa hoon.)

6. वे लोग रोज़ जल्दी उठते हैं। (voh log roz jaldee uThte hain.)

7. वह रोज़ किताब पढ़ती है। (voh roz kitaab paRhatee hai.)

8. मैं रोज़ अंडे बनाता हूँ। (main roz anDe banaataa hoon.)

Exercise 14C — Translate into Hindi

Roman on the first line, Devanagari on the second if you can. "I" = Jacob (m). Answers: Answer Key, Unit 14.

1. I drank tea.

2. She went home.

3. What did you (tum) eat?

4. I saw my sister.

5. They made food.

6. Who took my phone?

7. We arrived at night.

Exercise 14D — Translate into English

Give a natural English version. Answers: Answer Key, Unit 14.

1. मैं कल रात देर से सोया। (*main kal raat der se soyaa.*)

2. मैंने आपके लिए चाय बनाई। (*maine aapke liye chaay banaaee.*)

3. उसने मुझे पैसे दिए। (*usne mujhe paise diye.*)

4. क्या आपने यह फ़िल्म देखी? (*kyaa aapne yeh film dekhee?*)

5. वे लोग मेट्रो से आए। (*voh log meTro se aae.*)

6. मैंने कुछ नहीं खरीदा। (*maine kuchh naheen khareedaa.*)

UNIT 15

Perfect Tenses: "has done" & "had done"

What you'll be able to say: the difference between "she went", "she has gone" and "she had gone" — plus the very Delhi habit of using "had gone" for plain old "went". Good news: this unit is Unit 14 plus one small word. All the *ne* and agreement rules carry over unchanged.

वह अभी आया है।

voh abhee aayaa hai. [voh uh-bhee ah-yah heh]

He has just come — he's here now.

मैंने खाना खाया है।

maine khaanaa khaayaa hai. [meh(n)-nay khah-nah khah-yah heh]

I've eaten. (so no need to feed me — the result matters now)

हम पिछले साल दिल्ली गए थे।

ham pichhle saal dillee gae the. [hum pichh-lay sahl dil-lee guh-ay thay]

We went to Delhi last year. (lit. gone were — remote past)

The recipe

Take the perfective participle from Unit 14 and add a form of *honaa* after it:

participle alone	वह गया। <i>voh gayaa.</i>	he went — simple past (Unit 14)
+ है/हैं <i>hai/hain</i>	वह गया है। <i>voh gayaa hai.</i>	he has gone — present perfect : done, and it matters right now
+ था/थी/थे/थीं <i>thaa...</i>	वह गया था। <i>voh gayaa thaa.</i>	he had gone / he went (back then) — past perfect

Everything you sweated over in Unit 14 still applies. No-*ne* verbs (go, come, arrive...): participle *and* auxiliary agree with the subject. *Ne*-verbs: both agree with the *object* — and *ne* stays on the doer.

Present perfect of आना *aanaa* (no *ne*) — both genders

	MALE	FEMALE
मैं <i>main</i>	आया हूँ <i>aayaa hoon</i>	आई हूँ <i>aaye hoon</i>

	MALE	FEMALE
तुम tum	आए हो <i>aae ho</i>	आई हो <i>aaee ho</i>
आप aap	आए हैं <i>aae hain</i>	आई हैं <i>aaee hain</i>
वह voh	आया है <i>aayaa hai</i>	आई है <i>aaee hai</i>
हम ham	आए हैं <i>aae hain</i>	आई हैं <i>aaee hain</i>
वे लोग voh log	आए हैं <i>aae hain</i>	आई हैं <i>aaee hain</i>

For the past perfect, swap in *thaa / the / thee / theen*: आया था, आए थे, आई थी, आई थीं *aayaa thaa, aae the, aaee thee, aaee theen* [ah-yah thah · ah-ay thay · ah-ee thee · ah-ee thee(n)].

NOTE

Where did the nasal go? In Unit 14 the feminine plural was आई *aaeen*: लड़कियाँ आई। *laRkiyaan aaeen*. [luhR-ki-yah(n) ah-ee(n)] When an auxiliary follows, the nasal jumps onto the LAST word only: लड़कियाँ आई हैं। *laRkiyaan aaee hain*. · लड़कियाँ आई थीं। *laRkiyaan aaee theen*. Same with objects: मैंने रोटियाँ खाई *maine roTiyaan khaaen* but मैंने रोटियाँ खाई हैं *maine roTiyaan khaaee hain*.

Present perfect: done — and it matters now

मम्मी आई हैं।

mummy aaee hain. [mum-mee ah-ee heh(n)]

Mom's come (she's here). (respect plural hain for an elder)

मैंने दो किताबें पढ़ी हैं।

maine do kitaaben paRhee hain. [meh(n)-nay doh ki-tah-bay(n) puh-Rhee heh(n)]

I've read two books. (kitaaben f pl → paRhee + hain)

क्या तुमने मेरी चाबी देखी है?

kyaa tumne meree chaabee dekhee hai? [kyah tum-nay may-ree chah-bee day-khee heh]

Have you seen my key? (I need it right now)

मैंने यह फ़िल्म दो बार देखी है।

maine yeh film do baar dekhee hai. [meh(n)-nay yeh film doh bahr day-khee heh]

I've seen this film twice.

क्या आपने कभी दिल्ली की सर्दी देखी है?

kyaa aapne kabhee dillee kee sardee dekhee hai? [kyah ahp-nay kuh-bhee dil-lee kee sur-dee day-khee heh]

Have you ever seen a Delhi winter? (kabhee = ever — loves the present perfect)

वह अभी-अभी गया है।

voh abhee-abhee gayaa hai. [voh uh-bhee uh-bhee guh-yah heh]

He's just this minute left.

Negatives usually drop the *hai* — the plain past does the job, often with अभी तक *abhee tak* [uh-bhee tuk] "yet":

मैंने अभी तक खाना नहीं खाया।

maine abhee tak khaanaa naheen khaayaa. [meh(n)-nay uh-bhee tuk khah-nah nuh-hee(n) khah-yah]

I haven't eaten yet.

Past perfect: before then, or just "back then"

Textbook use: an event completed before another past moment. Delhi use: any event you're placing at a distance — last week, last year, that one time. English says "went"; Delhi very often says "had gone". Both of these are everyday sentences:

मैंने वह फ़िल्म पहले देखी थी।

maine voh film pehle dekhee thee. [meh(n)-nay voh film peh-lay day-khee thee]

I had seen that film before.

हम 2020 में मिले थे।

ham 2020 mein mile the. [hum doh huh-zahr bees may(n) mi-lay thay]

We (first) met in 2020. (milnaa: no ne)

आपने मुझे पैसे दिए थे।

aapne mujhe paise diye the. [ahp-nay mu-jhay peh-say di-yay thay]

You had given me money. (paise m pl → diye + the)

कल मैं सरोजिनी नगर गया था।

kal main sarojinee nagar gayaa thaa. [kul meh(n) suh-roh-ji-nee nuh-gur guh-yah thah]

I went to Sarojini Nagar yesterday. (Delhi-style plain past — see box)

मेरी बहन पिछले हफ्ते आई थी।

meree behen pichhle hafte aaee thee. [may-ree beh-hen pichh-lay huf-tay ah-ee thee]

My sister came last week. (she's gone back now — thee adds that distance)

Which past do I pick?

SITUATION	TENSE	EXAMPLE
Event, plainly reported	simple past	मैंने चाय पी। <i>maine chaay pee.</i>
Done + the result matters this minute	present perfect	मैंने चाय पी है। <i>maine chaay pee hai.</i> (I'm good, thanks)
Before another past event, or held at a distance ("that was then")	past perfect	मैंने चाय पी थी। <i>maine chaay pee thee.</i> (back then / already)

WATCH OUT

English lets you say "I *have seen* it yesterday" — no wait, it doesn't! Hindi has the same allergy. With a stated past time (*kal, pichhle saal, 2020 mein*), don't use ...*hai*: *कल मैंने खाना खाया है **kal maine khaanaa khaayaa hai* sounds off. Say कल मैंने खाना खाया *kal maine khaanaa khaayaa* or, very Delhi, ...खाया था ...*khaayaa thaa*. The *hai*-perfect lives in the present moment: *abhee, aaj, kabhee, abhee tak*.

DELHI STREET NOTE

Delhi keeps *thaa/thee/the* busy. "What did you do on the weekend?" gets answered in past perfect even with zero "before" meaning: हम मूवी देखने गए थे। *ham moovee dekhne gae the*. [hum moo-vee daykh-nay guh-ay thay] "We went to (see) a movie." मैंने तुझे बताया था न! *maine tujhe bataayaa thaa na!* [meh(n)-nay tu-jhay buh-tah-yah thah nuh] "I TOLD you, didn't I!" — the past perfect adds that told-you-so distance. Feel free to copy this one; it's core Delhi.

CULTURE

Walk into any Delhi home and within a minute someone will ask: कुछ खाया है? *kuchh khaayaa hai?* [kuchh khah-yah heh] "Have you eaten anything?" It's care, not curiosity — and "yes" will not stop the snacks. The polite play: जी हाँ, खाया है। *jee haan, khaayaa hai*. — then accept the chai anyway.

New words in this unit

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
साल	<i>saal</i> (m)	sahl	year
हफ्ता	<i>haftaa</i> (m)	huf-tah	week
बार	<i>baar</i> (f)	bahr	time, occasion (do baar = twice)
चाबी	<i>chaabee</i> (f)	chah-bee	key
सर्दी	<i>sardee</i> (f)	sur-dee	winter; cold
पिछला	<i>pichhlaa</i>	pichh-lah	last, previous (agrees like achchhaa)
पहले	<i>pehle</i>	peh-lay	before, earlier
कभी	<i>kabhee</i>	kuh-bhee	ever; sometimes
अभी तक	<i>abhee tak</i>	uh-bhee tuk	yet, so far
अभी-अभी	<i>abhee-abhee</i>	uh-bhee uh-bhee	just now, this minute

Exercise 15A — Pick the auxiliary

Fill the blank with है, हैं, था, थी, थे or थीं. Answers: Answer Key, Unit 15.

1. वह अभी आया ____। (*voh abhee aayaa ____.*)

2. मम्मी अभी बाज़ार गई ____। (*she's out right now; respectful*) (*mummy abhee baazaar gae ____.*)

3. मैंने खाना खाया ____। (*right now, I'm full*) (*maine khaanaa khaayaa ____.*)

4. हम पिछले साल दिल्ली गए ____। (*ham pichhle saal dillee gae ____.*)

5. मैंने वह फ़िल्म पहले देखी ____। (*maine voh film pehle dekhee ____.*)

6. क्या तुमने मेरी चाबी देखी ____? (*kyaa tumne meree chaabee dekhee ____?*)

7. वे लोग अभी आए ____। (*voh log abhee aae ____.*)

8. आपने मुझे पैसे दिए ____। (*aapne mujhe paise diye ____.*)

9. मैंने दो किताबें पढ़ी ____। (*maine do kitaaben paRhee ____.*)

10. लड़कियाँ घर गई ____। (*laRkiyaan ghar gae ____.*)

Exercise 15B — Shift the tense

1-4: rewrite in the present perfect (+ hai/hain). 5-8: rewrite in the past perfect, adding the time word in brackets. Answers: Answer Key, Unit 15.

1. मैंने चाय पी। (*maine chaay pee.*)

2. वह घर गया। (*voh ghar gayaa.*)

3. हमने खाना खाया। (*hamne khaanaa khaayaa.*)

4. मेरी बहन आई। (*meree behen aae.*)

5. मैंने यह फ़िल्म देखी। (+ पहले *pehle*) (*maine yeh film dekhee.*)

6. हम दिल्ली गए। (+ पिछले साल *pichhle saal*) (*ham dillee gae.*)

7. उसने यह काम किया। (+ पहले *pehle*) (*usne yeh kaam kiya.*)

8. तुमने यह गाना सुना। (+ पहले pehle) (*tumne yeh gaanaa sunaa.*)

Exercise 15C — Translate into Hindi

Roman on the first line, Devanagari on the second if you can. "I" = Jacob (m). Answers: Answer Key, Unit 15.

1. I have eaten.

2. She has gone home.

3. Have you (aap) seen this film?

4. We went to Delhi last year. (use the thaa-past)

5. I had read this book before.

6. Mom has just arrived. (respectful)

7. I haven't eaten yet.

8. We had met before.

Exercise 15D — Translate into English

Give a natural English version. Answers: Answer Key, Unit 15.

1. वह अभी-अभी गया है। (*voh abhee-abhee gayaa hai.*)

2. मैंने यह फ़िल्म दो बार देखी है। (*maine yeh film do baar dekhee hai.*)

3. कल मैं सरोजिनी नगर गया था। (*kal main sarojinee nagar gayaa thaa.*)

4. क्या आपने कभी दिल्ली की सड़ी देखी है? (*kyaa aapne kabhee dillee kee sardee dekhee hai?*)

5. मैंने तुझे बताया था न! (*maine tujhe bataayaa thaa na!*)

6. मैंने अभी तक चाय नहीं पी। (*maine abhee tak chaay naheen pee.*)

UNIT 16

Can, Manage, Already Done: सकना · पाना · चुकना

What you'll be able to say: what you can and can't do, ask permission, make polite "can you...?" requests, admit what you didn't manage, and announce that something's already done. All three helpers work the same way: verb STEM + helper, and — mark this now — **never, ever with ने ne.**

मैं हिन्दी बोल सकता हूँ।

main hindee bol saktaa hoon. [meh(n) hin-dee bohI suk-tah hoon]

I can speak Hindi.

क्या मैं अंदर आ सकता हूँ?

kyaa main andar aa saktaa hoon? [kyah meh(n) un-dur ah suk-tah hoon]

May I come in?

मैं खा चुका हूँ।

main khaa chukaa hoon. [meh(n) khah chu-kah hoon]

I've already eaten.

सकना **saknaa** — can, be able

Formula: **bare stem + a conjugated form of saknaa.** The stem never changes; *saknaa* conjugates like any verb and agrees with the *subject*.

	MALE	FEMALE
मैं main	कर सकता हूँ <i>kar saktaa hoon</i>	कर सकती हूँ <i>kar saktee hoon</i>
तुम tum	कर सकते हो <i>kar sakte ho</i>	कर सकती हो <i>kar saktee ho</i>
आप aap	कर सकते हैं <i>kar sakte hain</i>	कर सकती हैं <i>kar saktee hain</i>
वह voh	कर सकता है <i>kar saktaa hai</i>	कर सकती है <i>kar saktee hai</i>
हम / वे लोग ham / voh log	कर सकते हैं <i>kar sakte hain</i>	कर सकती हैं <i>kar saktee hain</i>

Say it: *saktaa* [suk-tah], *sakte* [suk-tay], *saktee* [suk-tee]. Past ("could/couldn't", nearly always negative): सका / सके / सकी *sakaa / sake / sakee* [suh-kah · suh-kay · suh-kee]. Future: सकूँगा / सकेगी / सकेंगे *sakoongaa / sakegee / sakenge* [suh-koo(n)-gah · suh-kay-gee · suh-kay(n)-gay].

वह हिन्दी और अंग्रेज़ी बोल सकती है।

voh hindee aur angrezee bol saktee hai. [voh hin-dee awr un-gray-zee bohl suk-tee heh]

She can speak Hindi and English.

क्या तुम गाड़ी चला सकते हो?

kyaa tum gaaRee chala sakte ho? [kyah tum gah-Ree chuh-lah suk-tay hoh]

Can you drive? (lit. make-the-car-move)

मैं तैर नहीं सकता।

main tair naheen saktaa. [meh(n) tehr nuh-hee(n) suk-tah]

I can't swim. (naheen likes to sit inside the cluster: tair naheen saktaa)

कल मैं नहीं सो सका।

kal main naheen so sakaa. [kul meh(n) nuh-hee(n) soh suh-kah]

I couldn't sleep last night.

Permission and polite requests

Ask permission with *kyaa main ... saktaa hoon?*; make requests with *kyaa aap ... kar sakte hain?* — the polished version of Unit 13's commands. Expect warm answers: हाँ, बिल्कुल। *haan, bilkul.* [hah(n), bil-kul] · ज़रूर। *zaroor.* [zuh-roor]

क्या आप मेरी मदद कर सकते हैं?

kyaa aap merree madad kar sakte hain? [kyah ahp may-ree muh-dud kur suk-tay heh(n)]

Can you help me?

क्या मैं आपसे एक सवाल पूछ सकता हूँ?

kyaa main aapse ek savaal poochh saktaa hoon? [kyah meh(n) ahp-say ayk suh-vahl poochh suk-tah hoon]

May I ask you a question?

पाना **paanaa** — manage to, get to

पाना *paanaa* [pah-nah] as a helper means "manage to / get the chance to". It lives mostly in negatives and apologies — where *saknaa* states inability, *paanaa* sighs "it just didn't work out":

मैं कल नहीं आ पाया।

main kal naheen aa paayaa. [meh(n) kul nuh-hee(n) ah pah-yah]

I couldn't make it yesterday.

वह रात को सो नहीं पाई।

voh raat ko so naheen paaee. [voh raht koh soh nuh-hee(n) pah-ee]

She couldn't get to sleep at night.

माफ़ कीजिए, मैं कल नहीं आ पाऊँगा।

maaf keejiye, main kal naheen aa paaongaa. [mahf kee-ji-yay, meh(n) kul nuh-hee(n) ah pah-oo(n)-gah]

Sorry, I won't be able to come tomorrow. (the standard polite decline)

मैं जवाब नहीं दे पाया।

main javaab naheen de paayaa. [meh(n) juh-vahb nuh-hee(n) day pah-yah]

I couldn't (manage to) answer.

NOTE

On its own, *paanaa* is a normal transitive verb meaning "get, obtain" (and that one does take *ne* in the past). As a helper after a stem — *aa paayaa, kar paayaa* — it never does.

चुकना *chuknaa* — already done

चुकना *chuknaa* [chuk-nah] after a stem means the action is finished — "already". It usually appears in the perfect: stem + *chukaa/chuke/chukee* + *hoon/ho/hai/hain*.

मैं खाना खा चुका हूँ।

main khaanaa khaa chukaa hoon. [meh(n) khah-nah khah chu-kah hoon]

I've already eaten. (note: main, not maine — see the box!)

वे लोग जा चुके हैं।

voh log jaa chuke hain. [voh loh jah chu-kay heh(n)]

They've already left.

चाय बन चुकी है।

chaay ban chukee hai. [chah-ay bun chu-kee heh]

The tea's already made. (banna vi = to get made)

मैं यह फ़िल्म देख चुका हूँ।

main yeh film dekh chukaa hoon. [meh(n) yeh film daykh chu-kah hoon]

I've already seen this film.

WATCH OUT

The iron rule of this unit: no ne. Ever. Even when the main verb is a ne-verb, the helper wins and *ne* is banned — and the verb goes back to agreeing with the *subject*:

*मैंने यह काम नहीं कर सका **maine yeh kaam naheen kar sakaa* → मैं यह काम नहीं कर सका। *main yeh kaam naheen kar sakaa*.

*मैंने खा चुका हूँ **maine khaa chukaa hoon* → मैं खा चुका हूँ। *main khaa chukaa hoon*.

Watch the agreement flip too: वह चिट्ठी नहीं पढ़ सकी। *voh chiTThee naheen paRh sakee*. [voh chiT-Thee nuh-hee(n) puRh suh-kee] "She couldn't read the letter" — *sakee* agrees with *her*, not the letter. Unit 14's object-agreement applies only when *ne* is present, and *ne* is never present here.

DELHI STREET NOTE

Delhi's favourite maybe: हो सकता है। *ho saktaa hai*. [hoh suk-tah heh] "could be / maybe" — an entire conversation move by itself. Its pessimist twin: नहीं हो पाएगा यार। *naheen ho paaegaa yaar*. [nuh-hee(n) hoh pah-ay-gah yahr] "it's not going to happen, yaar." And for "already done", street Delhi usually reaches for हो गया *ho gayaa* / कर लिया *kar liyaa* (Unit 19) — *chuknaa* reads a touch neutral-formal, which makes it perfect for the in-laws.

CULTURE

The guest's magic sentence at your in-laws': क्या मैं कुछ मदद कर सकता हूँ? *kyaa main kuchh madad kar saktaa hoon?* [kyah meh(n) kuchh muh-dud kur suk-tah hoon] "Can I help with anything?" The answer will be a scandalized नहीं-नहीं, आप बैठिए! *naheen-naheen, aap baiThiye!* — guests don't work. Offer anyway, every time; the offering is the point. After a meal, deploy बस, मैं खा चुका हूँ। *bas, main khaa chukaa hoon*. — it may buy you mercy from the third helping.

New words in this unit

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
गाड़ी	<i>gaaRee</i> (f)	gah-Ree	car, vehicle
चलाना	<i>chalaanaa</i> (vt)	chuh-lah-nah	to drive, operate
तैरना	<i>tairnaa</i> (vi)	tehr-nah	to swim
मदद	<i>madad</i> (f)	muh-dud	help

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
सवाल	<i>savaal</i> (m)	suh-vahl	question
जवाब	<i>javaab</i> (m)	juh-vahb	answer
चिट्ठी	<i>chiTThee</i> (f)	chiT-Thee	letter, note
बनना	<i>bannaa</i> (vi)	bun-nah	to get made, become
अंग्रेज़ी	<i>angrezee</i> (f)	un-gray-zee	English (language)

Exercise 16A — Fill in the helper

Write the correct form of सकना *saknaa* (with tense and gender to match). Answers: Answer Key, Unit 16.

1. मैं हिन्दी बोल ___ हूँ। (Jacob) (*main hindee bol ___ hoon.*)

2. क्या आप मेरी मदद कर ___ हैं? (to a man) (*kyaa aap meree madad kar ___ hain?*)

3. वह गाड़ी चला ___ है। (she) (*voh gaaRee chala ___ hai.*)

4. हम कल नहीं आ ___। (past; group of men) (*ham kal naheen aa ___.*)

5. क्या मैं अंदर आ ___ हूँ? (Jacob) (*kyaa main andar aa ___ hoon?*)

6. क्या तुम धीरे बोल ___ हो? (to a woman) (*kyaa tum dheere bol ___ ho?*)

7. कल रात मैं नहीं सो ___। (past; Jacob) (*kal raat main naheen so ___.*)

8. वे लोग कल नहीं आ ___। (future) (*voh log kal naheen aa ___.*)

9. मेरी बहन तैर ___ है। (*meree behen tair ___ hai.*)

10. आप यहाँ बैठ ____ हैं। (to a woman) (*aap yahaan baiTh ____ hain.*)

Exercise 16B — Build it with a helper

1–4: rewrite with सकना *saknaa* ("does" → "can do"). 5–6: turn into a polite question. 7–8: rewrite with पाना *paanaa* ("didn't" → "couldn't manage"). Answers: Answer Key, Unit 16.

1. मैं हिन्दी बोलता हूँ। (*main hindee boltaa hoon.*)

2. वह खाना बनाती है। (*voh khaanaa banaatee hai.*)

3. हम आज आते हैं। (*ham aaj aate hain.*)

4. तुम गाड़ी चलाते हो। (*tum gaaRee chalaate ho.*)

5. मैं अंदर आता हूँ। → May I...? (*main andar aataa hoon.*)

6. आप धीरे बोलते हैं। → Can you...? (*aap dheere bolte hain.*)

7. मैं कल नहीं आया। (*main kal naheen aayaa.*)

8. वह रात को नहीं सोई। (*voh raat ko naheen soee.*)

Exercise 16C — Translate into Hindi

Roman on the first line, Devanagari on the second if you can. "I" = Jacob (m). Answers: Answer Key, Unit 16.

1. I can speak a little Hindi.

2. Can you (aap, m) help me?

3. May I come in?

4. I couldn't sleep last night.

5. She can drive.

6. I have already eaten.

7. They have already left.

8. Sorry, I won't be able to come tomorrow.

Exercise 16D — Translate into English

Give a natural English version. Answers: Answer Key, Unit 16.

1. क्या मैं आपसे एक सवाल पूछ सकता हूँ? (*kyaa main aapse ek savaal poochh saktaa hoon?*)

2. चाय बन चुकी है। (*chaay ban chukee hai.*)

3. मैं कल नहीं आ पाया। (*main kal naheen aa paayaa.*)

4. हो सकता है। (*ho saktaa hai.*)

5. क्या तुम मेरे लिए समोसे ला सकते हो? (*kyaa tum mere liye samose laa sakte ho?*)

6. माफ़ कीजिए, मैं कुछ नहीं कर सका। (*maaf keejiye, main kuchh naheen kar sakaa.*)

UNIT 17

Must & Should: Obligation

What you'll be able to say: I should go, I have to work, I had no choice — three strengths of obligation, all built on one frame you already half-know from Unit 10: person + को *ko* + infinitive + a strength word. Plus "I need..." with *zaroorat*.

मुझे अब जाना चाहिए।

mujhe ab jaanaa chaahiye. [mu-jhay ub jah-nah chah-hi-yay]

I should go now.

मुझे कल काम पर जाना है।

mujhe kal kaam par jaanaa hai. [mu-jhay kul kahm pur jah-nah heh]

I have to go to work tomorrow.

कल मुझे जल्दी उठना पड़ेगा।

kal mujhe jaldee uThnaa paRegaa. [kul mu-jhay jul-dee uTh-nah puh-Ray-gah]

Tomorrow I'll have to get up early — no way around it.

The frame: person-को + infinitive + strength word

In obligation sentences the person is not a plain subject — they're marked with *ko*, using the same dative forms as *pasand hai* and *chaahiye* in Unit 10:

PRONOUN	KO-FORM	SAY IT	PRONOUN	KO-FORM	SAY IT
मैं <i>main</i>	मुझे <i>mujhe</i>	mu-jhay	हम <i>ham</i>	हमें <i>hamen</i>	huh-may(n)
तू <i>tu</i>	तुझे <i>tujhe</i>	tu-jhay	तुम <i>tum</i>	तुम्हें <i>tumhen</i>	tum-hay(n)
यह <i>yeh</i>	इसे <i>ise</i>	i-say	आप <i>aap</i>	आपको <i>aapko</i>	ahp-koh
वह <i>voh</i>	उसे <i>use</i>	u-say	वे लोग <i>voh log</i>	उन्हें <i>unhen</i>	un-hay(n)

Strength 1 — चाहिए *chaahiye*: should (advice)

आपको आराम करना चाहिए।

aapko aaraam karnaa chaahiye. [ahp-koh ah-rahm kur-nah chah-hi-yay]

You should rest.

तुम्हें ज़्यादा पानी पीना चाहिए।

tumhen zyaadaa paanee peenaa chaahiye. [tum-hay(n) zyah-dah pah-nee pee-nah chah-hi-yay]

You should drink more water.

Past "should have": add *thaa* — मुझे पहले सोचना चाहिए था। *mujhe pehle sochnaa chaahiye thaa.*

[mu-jhay peh-lay sohch-nah chah-hi-yay thah] "I should have thought earlier."

NOTE

Don't mix this up with Unit 10's *chaahiye*-of-wanting. मुझे चाय चाहिए *mujhe chaay chaahiye* = "I want/need tea" (noun before *chaahiye*). मुझे चाय पीनी चाहिए *mujhe chaay peenee chaahiye* = "I should drink tea" (infinitive before *chaahiye*). Same skeleton, different creature.

Strength 2 — होना *hona*: have to / that's the plan

Infinitive + *hai*: a duty or a firm plan. In Delhi speech it shades into "want to" — मुझे जाना है often just means "I want to go / I'm off".

हमें आज घर जाना है।

hamen aaj ghar jaanaa hai. [huh-may(n) ahj ghur jah-nah heh]

We have to go home today.

मुझे सब्ज़ी खरीदनी है।

mujhe sabzee khareednee hai. [mu-jhay sub-zee khuh-reed-nee heh]

I have to buy vegetables. (khareedNEE — see the agreement rule below!)

Past plan: मुझे कल जाना था। *mujhe kal jaanaa thaa.* "I was supposed to go yesterday." Future: *jaanaa hogaa* "will have to" — close to *paRegaa* but a shade softer.

Strength 3 — पड़ना *paRnaa*: compulsion, no choice

पड़ना *paRnaa* [puR-nah] literally "to fall (on you)". Outside pressure, often with a sigh:

recurring	पड़ता है <i>paRtaa hai</i> puR-tah heh	मुझे रोज़ जल्दी उठना पड़ता है। <i>mujhe roz jaldee uThnaa paRtaa hai.</i> I have to get up early every day.
one-time past	पड़ा <i>paRaa</i> puh-Rah	मुझे कल देर तक काम करना पड़ा। <i>mujhe kal der tak kaam karnaa paRaa.</i> I had to work late yesterday.

future	पड़ेगा <i>paRegaa</i> puh-Ray-gah	मुझे कल ऑफिस जाना पड़ेगा। <i>mujhe kal ofis jaanaa paRegaa.</i> I'll have to go to the office tomorrow.
--------	-----------------------------------	--

The agreement rule: the infinitive watches the object

Here is the part to learn slowly. When the verb has an object, the infinitive — and *hai/thaa/paRaa/paRegaa* after it — agree with that object, just like *ne*-sentences in Unit 14. *chaahiye* itself stays fixed in Delhi speech; the infinitive still agrees.

OBJECT	SENTENCE	WHY
काम <i>kaam</i> (m sg)	मुझे काम करना है। <i>mujhe kaam karnaa hai.</i>	karnaa + hai, m sg
किताब <i>kitaab</i> (f sg)	मुझे किताब पढ़नी है। <i>mujhe kitaab paRhnee hai.</i>	paRhNEE + hai, f sg
किताबें <i>kitaaben</i> (f pl)	मुझे दो किताबें पढ़नी हैं। <i>mujhe do kitaaben paRhnee hain.</i>	paRhnee + HAIN, f pl
कपड़े <i>kapRe</i> (m pl)	मुझे कपड़े धोने हैं। <i>mujhe kapRe dhone hain.</i>	dhoNE + hain, m pl

तुम्हें यह फ़िल्म देखनी चाहिए।

tumhen yeh film dekhnee chaahiye. [tum-hay(n) yeh film daykh-nee chah-hi-yeh]

You should watch this film. (film f → dekhnee)

कल मुझे दवाई लेनी पड़ी।

kal mujhe davaaee lenee paRee. [kul mu-jhay duh-vah-ee lay-nee puh-Ree]

Yesterday I had to take medicine. (davaaee f → lenee paRee, both feminine)

No object, or just a destination? Then there's nothing to agree with and everything stays masculine singular: मुझे घर जाना है। *mujhe ghar jaanaa hai.* — *ghar* is where you're going, not an object.

ज़रूरत *zaroorat* — need

ज़रूरत *zaroorat* (f) [zuh-roo-rut] "need": **person-ko + thing + की ज़रूरत है *kee zaroorat hai.*** The thing goes oblique before *kee* (Unit 7): *paise* → *paison*.

मुझे पैसे की ज़रूरत है।

mujhe paison kee zaroorat hai. [mu-jhay peh-soh(n) kee zuh-roo-rut heh]

I need money.

मुझे आपकी मदद की ज़रूरत है।

mujhe aapkee madad kee zaroorat hai. [mu-jhay ahp-kee muh-dud kee zuh-roo-rut heh]

I need your help.

ज़रूरत नहीं है, शुक्रिया।

zaroorat naheen hai, shukriyaa. [zuh-roo-rut nuh-hee(n) heh, shuk-ri-yah]

No need, thanks.

WATCH OUT

Two traps, one unit:

1. The person must be in the *ko*-form. *मैं जाना चाहिए **main jaanaa chaahiye* is the classic English-speaker sentence — Hindi needs मुझे जाना चाहिए। *mujhe jaanaa chaahiye*. Same for all three strengths: *mujhe ... hai, mujhe ... paRegaa*.
2. Don't freeze the infinitive. *मुझे किताब पढ़ना है **mujhe kitaab paRhnaa hai* misses the agreement: *kitaab* is feminine, so मुझे किताब पढ़नी है। *mujhe kitaab paRhnee hai*. Check the object's gender every time.

DELHI STREET NOTE

In Delhi, मुझे जाना है *mujhe jaanaa hai* is how you announce you *want* to leave, and जाना पड़ेगा *jaanaa paRegaa* comes with a theatrical sigh — duty calls. The all-purpose shrug of the working world: क्या करें, करना पड़ता है। *kyaa karen, karnaa paRtaa hai*. [kyah kuh-ray(n), kur-nah puR-tah heh] "What can you do — it's got to be done." (That *karen* is the subjunctive — next unit.)

CULTURE

Prepare for a steady stream of loving *chaahiye* from elders: बेटा, तुम्हें ज़्यादा खाना चाहिए। *beTaa, tumhen zyaadaa khaanaa chaahiye*. "Son, you should eat more." Advice about food, sweaters and marriage timing is affection, not interference. The correct response is a smiling जी। *jee*. — then do as you like.

New words in this unit

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
दवाई	<i>davaaee</i> (f)	duh-vah-ee	medicine
सब्ज़ी	<i>sabzee</i> (f)	sub-zee	vegetable(s)

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
आराम	<i>aaraam</i> (m)	ah-rahm	rest
छुट्टी	<i>chhuTTee</i> (f)	chhuT-Tee	day off, holiday
ऑफिस	<i>ofis</i> (m)	aw-fis	office
कपड़ा	<i>kapRaa</i> (m)	kup-Rah	cloth; pl. कपड़े clothes
ज़रूरत	<i>zaroorat</i> (f)	zuh-roo-rut	need
धोना	<i>dhonaa</i> (vt)	dhoh-nah	to wash
देर तक	<i>der tak</i>	dayr tuk	till late

Exercise 17A — Fill the frame

Fill each blank with the right form: a ko-pronoun, an agreeing infinitive, a form of पढ़ना *paRnaa*, or की *kee*. Answers: Answer Key, Unit 17.

1. ___ अब जाना चाहिए। (मैं *main*) (___ *ab jaanaa chaahiye*.)

2. मुझे किताब ___ है। (पढ़ना *paRhnaa*) (*mujhe kitaab* ___ *hai*.)

3. आपको आराम ___ चाहिए। (करना *karnaa*) (*aapko aaraam* ___ *chaahiye*.)

4. मुझे दो समोसे ___ हैं। (खरीदना *khareednaa*) (*mujhe do samose* ___ *hain*.)

5. कल मुझे दवाई ___ पड़ी। (लेना *lenaa*) (*kal mujhe davaaee* ___ *paRee*.)

6. ___ आज घर जाना है। (हम *ham*) (___ *aaj ghar jaanaa hai*.)

7. मुझे रोज़ जल्दी उठना ___ है। (पढ़ना, habitual) (*mujhe roz jaldee uThnaa* ___ *hai*.)

8. कल मुझे ऑफिस जाना ___। (पढ़ना, future) (*kal mujhe ofis jaanaa* ___.)

9. मुझे पैसों ____ जरूरत है। (*mujhe paison ____ zaroorat hai.*)

10. तुम्हें यह फ़िल्म ____ चाहिए। (देखना *dekhnaa*) (*tumhen yeh film ____ chaahiye.*)

Exercise 17B — Change the strength

Rewrite as directed. Watch the agreement every time. Answers: Answer Key, Unit 17.

1. मुझे जाना चाहिए। → no-choice future (पड़ेगा) (*mujhe jaanaa chaahiye.*)

2. मुझे सब्ज़ी खरीदनी है। → yesterday, compulsion (पड़ी) (*mujhe sabzee khareednee hai.*)

3. आपको आराम करना चाहिए। → have-to, today (है) (*aapko aaraam karnaa chaahiye.*)

4. मुझे जल्दी उठना पड़ता है। → future (*mujhe jaldee uThnaa paRtaa hai.*)

5. मुझे किताब पढ़नी है। → two books (दो किताबें) (*mujhe kitaab paRhnee hai.*)

6. तुम्हें दवाई लेनी चाहिए। → past compulsion (पड़ी) (*tumhen davaaee lenee chaahiye.*)

7. मुझे पानी चाहिए। → "I should drink water" (पीना + *chaahiye*) (*mujhe paanee chaahiye.*)

8. हमें घर जाना है। → should (*chaahiye*) (*hamen ghar jaanaa hai.*)

Exercise 17C — Translate into Hindi

Roman on the first line, Devanagari on the second if you can. "I" = Jacob (m). Answers: Answer Key, Unit 17.

1. I should go now.

2. I have to buy vegetables.

3. You (aap) should rest.

4. Tomorrow I'll have to get up early.

5. I had to take medicine.

6. We have to go home today.

7. I need money.

8. I have to read two books.

Exercise 17D — Translate into English

Give a natural English version. Answers: Answer Key, Unit 17.

1. मुझे आपकी मदद की ज़रूरत है। (*mujhe aapkee madad kee zaroorat hai.*)

2. तुम्हें ज़्यादा पानी पीना चाहिए। (*tumhen zyaadaa paanee peenaa chaahiye.*)

3. मुझे रोज़ मेट्रो से जाना पड़ता है। (*mujhe roz meTro se jaanaa paRtaa hai.*)

4. मुझे कल छुट्टी चाहिए। (*mujhe kal chhuTTee chaahiye.*)

5. मुझे कपड़े धोने हैं। (*mujhe kapRe dhone hain.*)

6. क्या करें, करना पड़ता है। (*kyaa karen, karnaa paRtaa hai.*)

UNIT 18

If & Maybe: the Subjunctive + अगर...तो agar...to

What you'll be able to say: "shall we...?", "what should I do?", "maybe", "so that", "if... then..." — the gentle, might-happen mood of Hindi. The subjunctive looks scary in grammar books and turns out to be the friendliest form in the language: it's just the future with its tail cut off.

चलें?

chalen? [chuh-lay(n)]

Shall we go?

शायद वह कल आए।

shaayad voh kal aae. [shah-yud voh kul ah-ay]

He might come tomorrow.

अगर बारिश होगी तो हम घर पर रहेंगे।

agar baarish hogee to ham ghar par rahenge. [uh-gur bah-rish hoh-gee toh hum ghur pur ruh-hay(n)-gay]

If it rains, we'll stay home.

Making it: future minus -गा/-गे/-गी

Take the Unit 12 future and delete the *-gaa/-ge/-gee* tail. What's left is the subjunctive — the "may/might/should-I" form. And notice: **no gender at all**. Men and women use identical forms.

	FUTURE (U12)	SUBJUNCTIVE	SAY IT
मैं main	करूँगा <i>karoongaa</i>	करूँ <i>karoon</i>	kuh-roo(n)
तू / वह tu / voh	करेगा <i>karegaa</i>	करे <i>kare</i>	kuh-ray
तुम tum	करोगे <i>karoge</i>	करो <i>karo</i>	kuh-roh
आप / हम / वे लोग aap / ham / voh log	करेंगे <i>karenge</i>	करें <i>karen</i>	kuh-ray(n)

(Yes — the *tum* subjunctive *karo* looks exactly like the *tum* command from Unit 13. Context sorts it out.) The usual suspects with vowel stems:

VERB	मैं MAIN	वह VOH	तुम TUM	आप/हम AAP/HAM
जाना <i>jaanaa</i>	जाऊँ <i>jaaoon</i>	जाए <i>jaae</i>	जाओ <i>jaao</i>	जाएँ <i>jaaen</i>
आना <i>aanaa</i>	आऊँ <i>aaoon</i>	आए <i>aae</i>	आओ <i>aao</i>	आएँ <i>aaen</i>
देना <i>denaa</i>	दूँ <i>doon</i>	दे <i>de</i>	दो <i>do</i>	दें <i>den</i>
लेना <i>lenaa</i>	लूँ <i>loon</i>	ले <i>le</i>	लो <i>lo</i>	लें <i>len</i>
पीना <i>peenaa</i>	पियूँ <i>piyoon</i>	पिए <i>piye</i>	पियो <i>piyo</i>	पिएँ <i>piyen</i>
होना <i>hona</i>	होऊँ <i>hooon</i> (rare)	हो <i>ho</i>	हो <i>ho</i>	हों <i>hon</i>

Say them: *jaaoon* [jah-oo(n)], *jaaen* [jah-ay(n)], *doon* [doo(n)], *den* [day(n)], *piyen* [pi-yay(n)], *hon* [hoh(n)].

Use 1 — Shall we? (suggestions)

The *ham*-form with a question tune is Hindi's "shall we":

बैठें?

baiThen? [beh-Thay(n)]

Shall we sit?

खाना खाएँ?

khaanaa khaaen? [khah-nah khah-ay(n)]

Shall we eat?

हम थोड़ा इंतज़ार करें?

ham thoRaa intazaar karen? [hum thoh-Rah in-tuh-zahr kuh-ray(n)]

Shall we wait a bit?

Use 2 — What should I do? (asking for instructions)

मैं क्या करूँ?

main kyaa karoona? [meh(n) kyah kuh-roo(n)]

What should I do?

यह कहाँ रखूँ?

yeh kahaan rakhoona? [yeh kuh-hah(n) ruh-khoo(n)]

Where should I put this? (ask this in the kitchen and win hearts)

मैं चाय बनाऊँ?

main chaay banaaon? [meh(n) chah-ay buh-nah-oo(n)]

Should I make tea?

Use 3 — शायद *shaayad* + subjunctive: maybe

shaayad + subjunctive = a genuine maybe. (*shaayad* + future = "probably" — noticeably more confident.)

शायद बारिश हो।

shaayad baarish ho. [shah-yud bah-rish hoh]

It might rain.

शायद वे लोग देर से पहुँचें।

shaayad voh log der se pahunchen. [shah-yud voh loh dayr say puh-hun-chay(n)]

They might arrive late.

Use 4 — ताकि *taaki*: so that

धीरे बोलिए ताकि मैं समझ सकूँ।

dheere boliye taaki main samajh sakoon. [dhee-ray boh-li-yay tah-ki meh(n) suh-mujh suh-koo(n)]

Please speak slowly so that I can understand. (*taaki* always takes the subjunctive)

Use 5 — Wishes and blessings

भगवान करे, सब ठीक हो।

bhagvaan kare, sab Theek ho. [bhug-vahn kuh-ray, sub Theek hoh]

God grant that everything be all right.

भगवान करे, तुम्हारा दिन अच्छा हो।

bhagvaan kare, tumhaara din achchhaa ho. [bhug-vahn kuh-ray, tum-hah-rah din uch-chhah hoh]

May your day be good.

अगर...तो *agar...to*: if... then...

Real, likely conditions take *agar* + **future**, then *to* + future. Hindi keeps the *to* even where English drops "then" — treat it as non-negotiable glue.

अगर मौसम अच्छा होगा तो हम बाहर खाएँगे।

agar mausam achchhaa hogaa to ham baahar khaaenge. [uh-gur maw-sum uch-chhah hoh-gah toh hum bah-hur khah-ay(n)-gay]

If the weather's good, we'll eat out.

अगर टाइम होगा तो मैं ज़रूर आऊँगा।

agar Taim hogaa to main zaroor aaoongaa. [uh-gur Tah-im hoh-gah toh meh(n) zuh-roor ah-oo(n)-gah]

If there's time, I'll definitely come.

When the if-part is less certain, put it in the subjunctive — and notice how nicely this stacks with Unit 13's gentle infinitive command:

अगर वह आए तो मुझे बताना।

agar voh aae to mujhe bataanaa. [uh-gur voh ah-ay toh mu-jhay buh-tah-nah]

If he comes (should he come), let me know.

NOTE

Advanced preview — the if-only past. For unreal, contrary-to-fact ifs ("if I were rich..."), Hindi uses the bare *-taa* form in both halves: अगर मैं अमीर होता तो बड़ा घर खरीदता।

agar main ameer hotaa to baRaa ghar khareedtaa. [uh-gur meh(n) uh-meer hoh-tah toh buh-Rah ghur khuh-reed-tah] "If I were rich I'd buy a big house." Just learn to recognize it for now — it gets proper treatment later.

WATCH OUT

English "then" tempts learners into फिर *phir*: *अगर बारिश होगी, फिर हम नहीं जाएँगे **agar baarish hogee, phir ham naheen jaaenge*. Wrong "then"! *phir* means "afterwards / next". The if-partner is always तो *to*: अगर बारिश होगी तो हम नहीं जाएँगे। *agar baarish hogee to ham naheen jaaenge*. You can drop *agar* in speech — but never drop *to*.

DELHI STREET NOTE

Delhi suggestions come in three flavours: subjunctive चलें? *chalen?*, the buddy version चल, चलते हैं *chal, chalte hain* [chul, chul-tay heh(n)] "c'mon, we're going", and full Hinglish: कल का प्लान बनाएँ? *kal kaa plaan banaaen?* [kul kah plahn buh-nah-ay(n)] "shall we make a plan for tomorrow?" You'll also hear *inshaallah* [in-shah-lah] alongside *bhagvaan kare* — Delhi's Urdu side talking; both mean "here's hoping".

CULTURE

Blessings are the subjunctive's home turf. Greet elders respectfully — a *namaste*, or touching their feet at festivals — and blessings come back: खुश रहो। *khush raho*. [khush ruh-hoh] "stay happy", जीते रहो। *jeete raho*. [jee-tay ruh-hoh] "long may you live". And for hopes about the future, the template is exactly what you learned above: भगवान करे... *bhagvaan kare*... + subjunctive.

New words in this unit

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
अगर	<i>agar</i>	uh-gur	if
ताकि	<i>taaki</i>	tah-ki	so that
बारिश	<i>baarish</i> (f)	bah-rish	rain
मौसम	<i>mausam</i> (m)	maw-sum	weather
भगवान	<i>bhagvaan</i> (m)	bhug-vahn	God
टाइम	<i>Taim</i> (m)	Tah-im	time (the Delhi word)
इंतज़ार	<i>intazaar</i> (m)	in-tuh-zahr	wait, waiting (intazaar karnaa = to wait)
रखना	<i>rakhnaa</i> (vt)	rukhnah	to put, keep
खुश	<i>khush</i>	khush	happy
अमीर	<i>ameer</i>	uh-meer	rich

Exercise 18A — Fill in the subjunctive

Write the correct subjunctive form of the verb in brackets. Answers: Answer Key, Unit 18.

1. मैं क्या ___? (*main kyaa* ___?) (करना karnaa)

2. हम कहाँ ___? (*ham kahaan* ___?) (बैठना baiThnaa)

3. शायद वह कल ___। (*shaayad voh kal* ___.) (आना aanaa)

4. चाय ___? (*chaay* ___?) (पीना *peenaa*, "shall we")

5. शायद बारिश ___। (*shaayad baarish* ___.) (होना *hona*)

6. यह किताब कहाँ ___? (*yeh kitaab kahaan* ___?) (रखना *rakhnaa*, "should I")

7. धीरे बोलो ताकि मैं समझ ___। (*dheere bolo taaki main samajh* ___.) (सकना *saknaa*)

8. भगवान ___, सब ठीक हो। (*bhagvaan* ___, *sab Theek ho*.) (करना *karna*)

9. हम घर ___? (*ham ghar* ___?) (जाना *jaanaa*)

10. शायद वे लोग देर से ___। (*shaayad woh log der se* ___.) (पहुँचना *pahunchnaa*)

Exercise 18B — Suggest it, soften it, join it

1-4: turn the statement into a "shall we?" question. 5-6: soften with शायद *shaayad* + subjunctive. 7-8: join the two sentences with अगर...तो *agar...to*. Answers: Answer Key, Unit 18.

1. हम चलते हैं। (*ham chalte hain*.)

2. हम बैठते हैं। (*ham baithte hain*.)

3. हम खाना खाते हैं। (*ham khaanaa khaate hain*.)

4. हम इंतज़ार करते हैं। (*ham intazaar karte hain*.)

5. वह कल आएगा। (*voh kal aaegaa.*)

6. बारिश होगी। (*baarish hogee.*)

7. बारिश होगी। + हम घर पर रहेंगे। (*baarish hogee. + ham ghar par rahenge.*)

8. मौसम अच्छा होगा। + हम बाहर खाएँगे। (*mausam achchhaa hogaa. + ham baahar khaaenge.*)

Exercise 18C — Translate into Hindi

Roman on the first line, Devanagari on the second if you can. Answers: Answer Key, Unit 18.

1. Shall we go?

2. What should I do?

3. Maybe he'll come tomorrow.

4. Shall we drink tea?

5. If it rains, we won't go.

6. If he comes, let me know. (gentle infinitive)

7. Where should I put this?

8. May God grant that everything be all right.

Exercise 18D — Translate into English

Give a natural English version. Answers: Answer Key, Unit 18.

1. हम कल मिलें? (*ham kal milen?*)

2. शायद मैं देर से आऊँ। (*shaayad main der se aaoon.*)

3. अगर टाइम होगा तो मैं ज़रूर आऊँगा। (*agar Taim hogaa to main zaroor aaoongaa.*)

4. धीरे बोलिए ताकि मैं समझ सकूँ। (*dheere boliye taaki main samajh sakoon.*)

5. मैं चाय बनाऊँ? (*main chaay banaaoon?*)

6. भगवान करे, तुम्हारा दिन अच्छा हो। (*bhagvaan kare, tumhaaraa din achchhaa ho.*)

UNIT 19

Compound Verbs — the Flavor System

What you'll be able to say: finish things off the way Delhi actually does — *eat up, hand it over, it's done, it'll get done* — by snapping a second "flavor" verb onto the verbs you already know.

खाना खा लो।

khaanaa khaa lo. [khah-nah khah loh]

Eat up (your food). (lit. food eat take)

मुझे अपना नंबर दे दो।

mujhe apnaa nambar de do. [mu-jhay up-nah num-bur day doh]

Give me your number. (lit. give give — the second "give" is pure flavor)

टेंशन मत लो — हो जाएगा।

Tenshan mat lo — ho jaaegaa. [Ten-shun mut loh — hoh jah-ay-gah]

Don't stress — it'll get done.

1. The big idea: stem + flavor verb

Up to now you have used verbs "bare": मैंने खाया (*maine khaayaa*) [meh(n)-nay khah-yah] — I ate. Grammatical, yes. But real Delhi speech constantly welds *two* verbs together: the **stem** of the main verb (the meaning) plus a fully conjugated **vector verb** (the flavor). The vector loses its dictionary meaning and instead adds a shade: *done and dusted, for me, for you, oops, with force*.

The stem is just the infinitive minus *-naa* — the same stem you already use for *rahaa hai* and for commands:

INFINITIVE	STEM	INFINITIVE	STEM
खाना	<i>khaa</i>	करना	<i>kar</i>
सीखना	<i>seekh</i>	बताना	<i>bataa</i>
देना	<i>de</i>	लेना	<i>le</i>
होना	<i>ho</i>	सोना	<i>so</i>

Only the vector conjugates; the stem never changes. You already know how to conjugate every vector in this unit — *lenaa*, *denaa*, *jaanaa* are old friends. So this unit is not new machinery. It is new *seasoning*.

NOTE

Why bother? Because bare verbs often sound stiff or unfinished to Indian ears — like saying "I did eat" when everyone else says "I ate it up." मैंने खाया (*maine khaayaa*) reports an event; मैंने खा लिया (*maine khaa liyaa*) [meh(n)-nay khah li-yah] says *done, finished, box ticked*. In everyday completed-action sentences, Delhi reaches for the compound almost every time.

2. लेना — doing it for yourself

लेना *lenaa* [lay-nah] "take" as a vector means the action folds back toward the doer: for your own benefit, into your own possession, quietly taking care of your own business.

JOB	हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT
command (tum)	खा लो	<i>khaa lo</i>	khah loh
command (aap)	खा लीजिए	<i>khaa leekiye</i>	khah lee-ji-yay
done (he)	खा लिया	<i>khaa liyaa</i>	khah li-yah
done (she / f object)	खा ली	<i>khaa lee</i>	khah lee
future (I, m/f)	खा लूँगा / खा लूँगी	<i>khaa loongaa / khaa loongee</i>	khah loo(n)-gah / khah loo(n)-gee
let's / shall we	खा लें?	<i>khaa len?</i>	khah lay(n)

मैंने हिन्दी सीख ली।

maine hindee seekh lee. [meh(n)-nay hin-dee seekh lee]

I've learned Hindi (got it under my belt). (hindee is f, so lee)

तुमने चाय पी ली?

tumne chaay pee lee? [tum-nay chah-ay pee lee]

Have you had your tea?

अपनी दवा खा लेना।

apnee davaa khaa lenaa. [up-nee duh-vah khah lay-nah]

(Remember to) take your medicine. (davaa (f) medicine; -naa command = "later, when the time comes")

3. देना — doing it for someone else

देना *denaa* [day-nah] "give" points the action outward, away from the doer — done for someone else's benefit, handed over, passed along. *le* and *de* are mirror twins:

तुम अपना खाना खा लो, बाक़ी मुझे दे दो।

tum apnaa khaanaa khaa lo, baaqee mujhe de do. [tum up-nah khah-nah khah loh, bah-qee mu-jhay day doh]

You eat (up) your food; give me the rest. (baaqee (f) = the remainder)

पापा को बता दो।

paapaa ko bataa do. [pah-pah koh buh-tah doh]

Tell Dad (let him know).

मैंने पैसे दे दिए।

maine paise de diye. [meh(n)-nay peh-say day di-yay]

I handed the money over. (paisaa (m), plural paise → diye)

NOTE

The polite forms: दे दीजिए (*de deejiye*) [day dee-ji-yay], बता दीजिए (*bataa deejiye*) [buh-tah dee-ji-yay]. With in-laws, a request with a vector sounds warmer and more complete than the bare verb — *bataa deejiye* feels like "do please let me know," not "inform me."

4. जाना — completion and change of state

जाना *jaanaa* [jah-nah] "go" is the vector of things tipping over into a new state — finished, changed, arrived, asleep. It pairs mostly with *intransitive* verbs (*honaa*, *aanaa*, *sonaa*, *baiThnaa*), and it is everywhere:

दूध ख़त्म हो गया।

doodh khatam ho gayaa. [doodh khuh-tum hoh guh-yah]

The milk is finished. (doodh (m); khatam ho jaanaa = to run out)

ट्रेन आ गई!

Tren aa gaee! [Trayn ah guh-ee]

The train's here! (Tren (f) → gaee)

बच्चा सो गया।

bachchaa so gayaa. [buch-chah soh guh-yah]

The kid's fallen asleep. (bachchaa (m) child)

आप बैठ जाइए।

aap baiTh jaaiye. [ahp behTh jah-i-yay]

Please sit down. (baiTh jaanaa = to sit down, settle into sitting)

Learn the state-change set as a family: हो गया (*ho gayaa*) it's done · आ गया (*aa gayaa*) arrived · सो गया (*so gayaa*) fell asleep · ठीक हो गया (*Theek ho gayaa*) [Theek hoh guh-yah] it got fixed · देर हो गई (*der ho gaee*) [dayr hoh guh-ee] it got late (der (f)).

DELHI STREET NOTE

हो जाएगा। (*ho jaaegaa.*) [hoh jah-ay-gah] — the great Delhi promise. It will happen, it will get done, somehow, by someone, at some point. Plumber, landlord, cousin with a "contact" — everyone says it. Its siblings run the whole day: हो गया? (*ho gayaa?*) "done?" · चल, हो गया। (*chal, ho gayaa.*) [chul, hoh guh-yah] "right, that's that" · ले लो यार। (*le lo yaar.*) [lay loh yahr] "just take it, yaar." Master these four and you sound local.

5. The strong flavors: डालना, बैठना, उठना

Three more vectors, used less often but with vivid color:

VECTOR	FLAVOR	EXAMPLE	MEANING
डालना <i>Daalnaa</i> Dahl-nah	vigorous, decisive, in one go	पढ़ डाला <i>paRh Daalaa</i> puRh Dah-lah	read it right through
बैठना <i>baiThnaa</i> behTh-nah	regrettable, foolish, "went and did it"	कर बैठा <i>kar baiThaa</i> kur beh-Thah	went and did (something dumb)
उठना <i>uThnaa</i> uTh-nah	sudden, involuntary burst	बोल उठा <i>bol uThaa</i> bohl u-Thah	blurted out

मैंने एक ही रात में पूरी किताब पढ़ डाली।

maine ek hee raat mein pooree kitaab paRh Daalee. [meh(n)-nay ayk hee raht may(n) poo-ree ki-tahb puRh Dah-lee]

I tore through the whole book in a single night. (kitaab (f) → Daalee)

वह गुस्से में सब कुछ कह बैठा।

voh gusse mein sab kuchh keh baiThaa. [voh gus-say may(n) sub kuchh keh beh-Thah]

In anger he went and said everything (and regretted it). (gussaa (m) anger)

बच्चा अचानक हँस उठा।

bachchaa achaanak hans uThaa. [buch-chah uh-chah-nuk huh(n)s u-Thah]

The child suddenly burst out laughing.

NOTE

A cousin of *uThnaa*: sudden bursts also use पड़ना (*paRnaa*) [puR-nah] — वह रो पड़ी (*voh ro paRee*) [voh roh puh-Ree] "she burst into tears." Recognize it; you don't have to produce it yet.

6. The ने rule: follow the vector

Here is the rule that trips everyone up. In perfective (simple past / perfect) sentences, whether you use *ne* depends on the **vector**, not the main verb:

VECTOR	TRANSITIVITY	ने?	EXAMPLE
<i>lenaa, denaa, Daalnaa</i>	transitive (vt)	yes	मैंने खा लिया। <i>maine khaa liyaa.</i>
<i>jaanaa, baiThnaa, uThnaa</i>	intransitive (vi)	no	वह खा गया। <i>voh khaa gayaa.</i> [voh khah guh-yah] he ate it all up / devoured it

So the same main verb flips depending on the flavor: उसने सब मिठाई खा ली (*usne sab miThaaee khaa lee*) [us-nay sub mi-Thah-ee khah lee] — with *ne*; but वह सब मिठाई खा गया (*voh sab miThaaee khaa gayaa*) — no *ne*, and the verb now agrees with *he*, not with the sweets (*miThaaee* (f)). And वह गलती कर बैठा (*voh galtee kar baiThaa*) [voh gul-tee kur beh-Thah] — no *ne*, even though *karnaa* itself is transitive, because *baiThnaa* is not (*galtee* (f) mistake).

WATCH OUT

Don't compute *ne* from the main verb. English speakers see "he ate," remember *khaanaa* is transitive, and produce **X** उसने आ गया (**X** *usne aa gayaa*) or **X** मैंने सो गया (**X** *maine so gayaa*). Wrong: *jaanaa* is intransitive, so वह आ गया (*voh aa gayaa*), मैं सो गया (*main so gayaa*) [meh(n) soh guh-yah]. One glance at the vector settles it every time.

NOTE

Compounds mostly vanish under negation. "I didn't eat" is मैंने नहीं खाया (*maine naheen khaayaa*) — not **X** *maine naheen khaa liyaa*. Flavor belongs to things that actually happened (or that you're telling someone to do).

7. Delhi reps

मैंने नया फ़ोन ले लिया।

maine nayaa fon le liyaa. [meh(n)-nay nuh-yah fohn lay li-yah]

I've bought (gotten myself) a new phone. (fon (m))

रुको, मैं पूछ लेता हूँ।

ruko, main poochh leta hoon. [ru-koh, meh(n) poochh lay-tah hoo(n)]

Hang on, I'll just ask (and find out for us). (habitual + vector = "I'll just...")

ऑटो आ गया — चलो, बैठ जाओ।

auTo aa gayaa — chalo, baiTh jaao. [aw-Toh ah guh-yah — chuh-loh, behTh jah-oh]

The auto's here — come on, get in. (auTo (m))

ले लो यार, अच्छी चीज़ है।

le lo yaar, achchhee cheez hai. [lay loh yahr, uch-chhee cheez heh]

Just take it, yaar — it's good stuff. (cheez (f) thing)

कल तक हो जाएगा, भाई।

kal tak ho jaaegaa, bhaaee. [kul tuk hoh jah-ay-gah, bhah-ee]

It'll be done by tomorrow, bhai. (bhaaee (m) brother — Delhi filler)

देर हो गई, अब सो जाओ।

der ho gaee, ab so jaao. [dayr hoh guh-ee, ub soh jah-oh]

It's gotten late — go to sleep now.

CULTURE

At the in-laws' table, compounds carry the hospitality: थोड़ा और ले लो। (*thoRaa aur le lo.*) [thoh-Rah awr lay loh] "take a little more." Refusing once is polite ritual, not refusal; your plate will be refilled. The graceful out: बस, मैंने बहुत खा लिया। (*bas, maine bahut khaa liyaa.*) [bus, meh(n)-nay buh-hut khah li-yah] "enough — I've eaten plenty." The compound makes it sound final and satisfied, not rude.

Exercise 19A — Pick the vector

Circle the vector that fits the flavor in brackets. Answers: Answer Key, Unit 19.

1. मैंने खाना खा ____। (*maine khaanaa khaa ____.*) [done, for myself: liyaa / diyaa / gayaa]

2. मम्मी को बता ____। (*mummy ko bataa ____.*) [for her benefit: lo / do / jaao]

3. दूध खत्म हो ____। (*doodh khatam ho ____.*) [change of state: liyaa / diyaa / gayaa]

4. वह गलती कर ____। (*voh galtee kar ____.*) [and regretted it: baiThaa / liyaa / diyaa]

5. मैंने पूरी फ़िल्म देख ____। (*maine pooree film dekh ____.*) [in one vigorous go: gae / Daalee / baiThee]

6. आप बैठ ____। (*aap baiTh ____.*) [please settle down: leejiye / jaiye / deejiye]

7. बच्चा अचानक रो ____। (*bachchaa aachanak ro ____.*) [sudden burst: uThaa / liyaa / diyaa]

8. मुझे पैसे दे ____। (*mujhe paise de ____.*) [hand them over to me: lo / do / jaao]

9. ट्रेन आ ____। (*Tren aa ____.*) [arrival, f: gayaa / gae / lee]

10. चिंता मत करो, काम हो ____। (*chintaa mat karo, kaam ho ____.*) [Delhi promise: jaaegaa / legaa / degaa]
-

Exercise 19B — Add the flavor

Rewrite each bare sentence as a compound with the vector shown. Watch ने and agreement.

1. मैंने चाय पी। (*maine chaay pee.*) → [+ lenaa]
-

2. उसने मुझे सब बताया। (*usne mujhe sab bataayaa.*) → [+ denaa]
-

3. वह सोया। (*voh soyaa.*) → [+ jaanaa]
-

4. काम खत्म हुआ। (*kaam khatam huaa.*) → [+ jaanaa]
-

5. मैंने पूरी किताब पढ़ी। (*maine pooree kitaab paRhee.*) → [+ Daalnaa]
-

6. उसने बड़ी गलती की। (*usne baRee galtee kee.*) → [+ baiThnaa — careful with ne!]
-

7. तुम खाना खाओ। (*tum khaanaa khaao.*) → [+ lenaa]
-

8. दादी अचानक बोलीं। (*daadee achaanak boleen.*) → [+ uThnaa]
-

Exercise 19C — Translate into Hindi

Use a compound verb in every answer. Write Devanagari or roman (or both).

1. I've eaten (I'm done eating).
-
-

2. Give me your phone. (tum)

3. The auto has arrived.

4. Please sit down. (aap)

5. Don't worry, it'll get done.

6. She has learned Hindi.

7. Tell Dad. (tum)

Exercise 19D — Translate into English

Catch the flavor, not just the verb.

1. देर हो गई। (*der ho gae.*)

2. मैंने नया फ़ोन ले लिया। (*maine nayaa fon le liyaa.*)

3. वह गुस्से में सब कुछ कह बैठा। (*voh gusse mein sab kuchh keh baiThaa.*)

4. रुको, मैं पूछ लेता हूँ। (*ruko, main poochh leta hoon.*)

5. बच्चा हँस उठा। (*bachchaa hans uThaa.*)

6. चल, हो गया — अब चलें? (*chal, ho gayaa — ab chalen?*)

UNIT 20

Joining Ideas & Reported Speech

What you'll be able to say: sentences with more than one moving part — *I think that..., she said that..., because..., when..., before..., after..., having done X...* — the glue that turns phrases into conversation.

मुझे लगता है कि यह ठीक है।

mujhe lagtaa hai ki yeh Theek hai. [mu-jhay lug-tah heh ki yeh Theek heh]

I think (it seems to me) that this is fine.

उसने कहा कि वह आ रहा है।

usne kahaa ki voh aa rahaa hai. [us-nay kuh-hah ki voh ah ruh-hah heh]

He said (that) he was coming. (lit. ...that he IS coming — see §2!)

खाना खाके सो जाओ।

khaanaa khaake so jao. [khah-nah khah-kay soh jah-oh]

Eat and (then) go to sleep. (lit. food having-eaten sleep-go)

1. कि — the all-purpose "that"

कि *ki* [ki] links a verb of thinking, knowing, saying, or feeling to a full clause. English often drops "that"; Hindi almost never drops *ki*.

OPENER	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
मुझे लगता है कि...	<i>mujhe lagtaa hai ki...</i>	mu-jhay lug-tah heh ki	I think / it seems to me that...
मुझे पता है कि...	<i>mujhe pataa hai ki...</i>	mu-jhay puh-tah heh ki	I know that...
उसने कहा कि...	<i>usne kahaa ki...</i>	us-nay kuh-hah ki	he/she said that...
उसने पूछा कि...	<i>usne poochhaa ki...</i>	us-nay poo-chhah ki	he/she asked (whether/ what)...
अच्छा है कि...	<i>achchhaa hai ki...</i>	uch-chhah heh ki	it's good that...

मुझे पता है कि तुम थके हो।

mujhe pataa hai ki tum thake ho. [mu-jhay puh-tah heh ki tum thuh-kay hoh]

I know (that) you're tired.

मुझे लगता है कि बारिश होगी।

mujhe lagtaa hai ki baarish hogee. [mu-jhay lug-tah heh ki bah-rish hoh-gee]

I think it'll rain. (baarish (f) rain)

NOTE

Spelling alert: कि (*ki*) "that" has the short *i*; की (*kee*) is the possessive "of." One matra apart, totally different words. Your eye will learn to catch it; your ear already can — [ki] is clipped, [kee] is long.

2. Reported speech keeps the original tense

This is the star rule of the unit. English backshifts: "I *am* coming" becomes "he said he *was* coming." Hindi does **not**. You freeze the speaker's words in their original tense, swap the pronouns, and pipe them through *ki*:

THEY SAID...	YOU REPORT...	ENGLISH FEEL
"मैं आ रहा हूँ।" <i>main aa rahaa hoon.</i>	उसने कहा कि वह आ रहा है। <i>usne kahaa ki voh aa rahaa hai.</i>	He said he was coming.
"मैं कल आऊँगा।" <i>main kal aaoongaa.</i> ah-oo(n)-gah	उसने कहा कि वह कल आएगा। <i>usne kahaa ki voh kal aaegaa.</i> ah-ay-gah	He said he'd come tomorrow.
"मुझे भूख लगी है।" <i>mujhe bhookh lagee hai.</i> bhookh luh-gee heh	उसने कहा कि उसे भूख लगी है। <i>usne kahaa ki use bhookh lagee hai.</i> u-say	She said she was hungry.
"तुम कब आओगे?" <i>tum kab aaoge?</i>	उसने पूछा कि तुम कब आओगे। <i>usne poochhaa ki tum kab aaoge.</i>	She asked when you'd come.

WATCH OUT

Resist the English backshift. Learners hear "he said he *was* coming" and produce ✗ उसने कहा कि वह आ रहा था (✗ *usne kahaa ki voh aa rahaa thaa*) — but in Hindi that means he said he was coming *at some earlier time* (and probably isn't anymore). If his words were "I'm coming," report ...*ki voh aa rahaa hai*. Keep the tense the speaker used. Every time.

DELHI STREET NOTE

On the street, "said" is usually *bolnaa*, not *kehnaa* — and colloquially it skips *ne*: वह बोला कि पैसे कल मिलेंगे। (*voh bolaa ki paise kal milenge.*) [voh boh-lah ki peh-say kul mi-lay(n)-gay] "He said (lit. he spoke that) the money will come tomorrow." Feminine: वह बोली कि... (*voh bolee ki...*) [voh boh-lee ki]. You'll hear *main bolaa*, *voh bolaa* all day in Delhi; use *usne kahaa* when you want to sound a touch more careful.

3. Because and therefore: क्योंकि, इसलिए

मैं देर से उठा क्योंकि कल रात देर से सोया।

main der se uThaa kyonki kal raat der se soyaa. [meh(n) dayr say u-Thah kyoh(n)-ki kul raht dayr say soh-yah]

I got up late because I went to sleep late last night. (der (f) lateness; raat (f) night)

बारिश हो रही थी, इसलिए हम घर पर रहे।

baarish ho rahee thee, isliye ham ghar par rahe. [bah-rish hoh ruh-hee thee, is-li-yay hum ghur pur ruh-hay]

It was raining, so (therefore) we stayed home.

kyonki introduces the reason after the fact; *isliye* introduces the result. Same logic as English "because" and "so," and they sit in the same places.

4. When...then: जब...तब / तो

Hindi loves paired connectors. A *jab* ("when") clause is answered by *tab* ("then") or — far more often in speech — plain *to*:

जब मैं दिल्ली आया, तब मुझे हिन्दी नहीं आती थी।

jab main dillee aayaa, tab mujhe hindee naheen aatee thee. [jub meh(n) dil-lee ah-yah, tub mu-jhay hin-dee nuh-hee(n) ah-tee thee]

When I came to Delhi, I didn't know Hindi. (hindee aanaa = to know Hindi, u10 pattern)

जब तुम आओगे, तो हम खाएँगे।

jab tum aaoge, to ham khaaenge. [jub tum ah-oh-gay, toh hum khah-ay(n)-gay]

When you come, (then) we'll eat. (note: future in BOTH halves, unlike English)

Until / as long as uses the pair जब तक...तब तक *jab tak...tab tak* [jub tuk...tub tuk]:

जब तक मैं यहाँ हूँ, तब तक कोई टेंशन नहीं।

jab tak main yahaan hoon, tab tak koe Tenshan naheen. [jub tuk meh(n) yuh-hah(n) hoo(n), tub tuk koh-ee Ten-shun nuh-hee(n)]

As long as I'm here, no tension.

जब तक तुम नहीं आओगे, मैं नहीं खाऊँगा।

jab tak tum naheen aaoge, main naheen khaaongaa. [jub tuk tum nuh-hee(n) ah-oh-gay, meh(n) nuh-hee(n) khah-oo(n)-gah]

Until you come, I won't eat.

NOTE

Spot the odd little *naheen* in the "until" clause: *jab tak tum **naheen** aaoge...* is literally "as long as you will not come." When *jab tak* means "until (something happens)," Hindi puts the clause in the negative. It feels backwards to an English eye; it is completely standard.

5. Before and after: से पहले, के बाद

Take the infinitive, put it in the oblique (*-naa* → *-ne*), and add the postposition — exactly the oblique machinery from Unit 7:

PATTERN	EXAMPLE	MEANING
<i>...ne se pehle</i>	जाने से पहले <i>jaane se pehle</i> jah-nay say peh-lay	before going
<i>...ne ke baad</i>	खाने के बाद <i>khaane ke baad</i> khah-nay kay bahd	after eating

सोने से पहले फ़ोन मत देखो।

sone se pehle fon mat dekho. [soh-nay say peh-lay fohn mut day-khoh]

Don't look at your phone before sleeping.

जाने से पहले मुझे बता देना।

jaane se pehle mujhe bataa denaa. [jah-nay say peh-lay mu-jhay buh-tah day-nah]

Let me know before you leave. (Unit 19 vector riding along)

खाने के बाद हम टीवी देखते हैं।

khaane ke baad ham Teevee dekhte hain. [khah-nay kay bahd hum Tee-vee daykh-tay heh(n)]

After dinner we watch TV. (Teevee (m))

6. Having done X: the -कर / -के chain

To string actions in sequence — "having eaten, he left" — Hindi glues -कर *-kar* [kur] or colloquial -के *-ke* [kay] onto the bare stem. The chained verb never conjugates; only the final verb of the sentence does.

STEM	FORMAL-ISH	DELHI DEFAULT	MEANING
<i>khaa</i>	खाकर <i>khaakar</i> khah-kur	खाके <i>khaake</i> khah-kay	having eaten
<i>le</i>	लेकर <i>lekar</i> lay-kur	लेके <i>leke</i> lay-kay	having taken / with
<i>kar</i>	करके <i>karke</i> kur-kay — never X <i>karkar</i>		having done

वह नहा-धोकर ऑफिस चला गया।

voh nahaa-dhokar ofis chalaa gayaa. [voh nuh-hah-dhoh-kur aw-fis chuh-lah guh-yah]

He bathed-and-washed and went off to the office. (nahaa-dhokar — a set phrase; ofis (m))

मैं मेट्रो में बैठकर किताब पढ़ता हूँ।

main meTro mein baiThkar kitaab paRhtaa hoon. [meh(n) may-Troh may(n) behTh-kur ki-tahb puRh-tah hoo(n)]

I read (a book) sitting in the metro. (meTro (f))

चाय पीके बताओ, कैसी बनी है?

chaay peeke bataao, kaisee banee hai? [chah-ay pee-kay buh-tah-oh, keh-see buh-nee heh]

Drink the chai and tell me — how did it turn out?

7. Quick recap: अगर...तो

From Unit 18, the conditional pair sits in the same family: अगर तुम चाहो, तो हम चलें। (*agar tum chaaho, to ham chalen.*) [uh-gur tum chah-hoh, toh hum chuh-lay(n)] "If you like, let's go." Notice the habit: Hindi marks *both* halves — *agar...to, jab...tab, jab tak...tab tak*. Where English drops "then," Hindi keeps it. Lean on the pairs; they hold the sentence up.

CULTURE

Family phone calls run on reported speech. Expect a nightly relay: मम्मी ने पूछा कि तुम कब आ रहे हो। (*mummy ne poochhaa ki tum kab aa rahe ho.*) [mum-mee nay poo-chhah ki tum kub ah ruh-hay hoh] "Mummy asked when you're coming." Pass a message back with *bataa denaa ki...* — "do tell (them) that..." — and you're an instant favorite.

Exercise 20A — Fill in the connector

Choose from: कि (ki) · क्योंकि (kyonki) · इसलिए (isliye) · जब (jab) · तो (to) · जब तक (jab tak) · के बाद (ke baad) · से पहले (se pehle). Answers: Answer Key, Unit 20.

1. मुझे लगता है ___ वह घर पर है। (mujhe lagtaa hai ___ woh ghar par hai.)

2. मैं नहीं आया ___ मैं बीमार था। (main naheen aayaa ___ main beemaar thaa.)

3. बारिश हो रही थी, ___ मैंने ऑटो ले लिया। (baarish ho rahee thee, ___ maine auTo le liyaa.)

4. ___ तुम आओगे, तो हम चलेंगे। (___ tum aaoge, to ham chalenge.)

5. खाने ___ हम टहलने जाएँगे। (khaane ___ ham Tehalne jaaenge.) [after]

6. सोने ___ दूध पी लो। (sone ___ doodh pee lo.) [before]

7. ___ काम खत्म नहीं होगा, मैं नहीं जाऊँगा। (___ kaam khatam naheen hogaa, main naheen jaaongaa.)

8. उसने पूछा ___ तुम ठीक हो। (usne poochhaa ___ tum Theek ho.)

9. जब मैं छोटा था, ___ मैं शिकागो में रहता था। (jab main chhoTaa thaa, ___ main shikaago mein rehtaa thaa.)

10. अच्छा है ___ तुमने हिन्दी सीख ली। (achchhaa hai ___ tumne hindee seekh lee.)

Exercise 20B — Report it / chain it

1-4: turn the direct quote into reported speech (keep the tense!). 5-8: join the two actions with -के/-कर.

1. राहुल: "मैं आ रहा हूँ।" → राहुल ने कहा कि... (raahul ne kahaa ki...)

2. प्रिया: "मैं कल आऊँगी।" → प्रिया ने कहा कि... (*priyaa ne kahaa ki...*)

3. मम्मी: "मुझे भूख लगी है।" → मम्मी ने कहा कि... (*mummy ne kahaa ki...*)

4. उसने पूछा: "तुम कहाँ हो?" → उसने पूछा कि... (*usne poochhaa ki...*)

5. मैं चाय पीता हूँ + फिर काम करता हूँ → (*main chaay peetaa hoon + phir kaam kartaa hoon*)

6. वह खाना खाता है + फिर सो जाता है → (*voh khaanaa khaataa hai + phir so jaataa hai*)

7. हम मेट्रो में बैठते हैं + बातें करते हैं → (*ham meTro mein baiThte hain + baaten karte hain*)

8. वह नहाता है + ऑफिस जाता है → (*voh nahaataa hai + ofis jaataa hai*)

Exercise 20C — Translate into Hindi

Write Devanagari or roman (or both).

1. I think (that) the food is very good.

2. She said (that) she is coming. [keep Hindi tense!]

3. I stayed home because it was raining.

4. When you come, we'll eat.

5. Call me before leaving. (tum; "phone karnaa")

6. After eating, we'll watch TV.

7. Having drunk chai, he went to the office.

Exercise 20D — Translate into English

Watch the tense in 1 and the negative in 4.

1. उसने कहा कि वह दिल्ली में रहता है। (*usne kahaa ki voh dillee mein rehtaa hai.*)

2. मुझे पता है कि तुम व्यस्त हो। (*mujhe pataa hai ki tum vyast ho.*)

3. जब मैं छोटी थी, तब मैं मुंबई में रहती थी। (*jab main chhoTee thee, tab main mumbaee mein rehtee thee.*)

4. जब तक तुम नहीं बोलोगे, कुछ नहीं होगा। (*jab tak tum naheen bologe, kuchh naheen hogaa.*)

5. वह बोली कि खाना बन गया है। (*voh bolee ki khaanaa ban gayaa hai.*)

6. नहा-धोके तैयार हो जाओ, मेहमान आ रहे हैं। (*nahaa-dhoke taiyaar ho jaao, mehmaan aa rahe hain.*)

UNIT 21

Relative Clauses: जो...वह

What you'll be able to say: point at people, things, and places with a whole clause — *the boy who's standing there, the shop we buy vegetables from, whoever wants some* — using Hindi's paired जो...वह system.

जो लड़का वहाँ खड़ा है, वह मेरा दोस्त है।

jo laRkaa vahaan khaRaa hai, voh meraa dost hai. [joh luhR-kah vuh-hah(n) khuh-Rah heh, voh may-rah dohst heh]

The boy who's standing there is my friend. (lit. which boy there standing is, he my friend is)

जो चाहिए, ले लो।

jo chaahiye, le lo. [joh chah-hi-yay, lay loh]

Take whatever you need.

जो होगा, देखा जाएगा।

jo hogaa, dekhaa jaaegaa. [joh hoh-gah, day-khah jah-ay-gah]

Whatever happens, we'll deal with it then. (the Delhi shrug, in grammar form)

1. The correlative habit: Hindi answers its own clause

English tucks a relative clause *inside* the sentence: "The boy [*who is standing there*] is my friend." Hindi almost never does that. It sets the clause up front with जो *jo* [joh] "which/who," then starts over with वह *voh* to deliver the main sentence:

ENGLISH ORDER	HINDI ORDER
The boy [who is standing there] is my friend.	[जो लड़का वहाँ खड़ा है], वह मेरा दोस्त है।
one interlocking sentence	two matched halves: a <i>jo</i> -half, answered by a <i>voh</i> -half

You have seen this pairing habit before — *agar...to, jab...tab*. It runs on a beautiful three-way system. The *k*- words ask, the *j*- words relate, and the *v*-/*u*- words answer:

QUESTION (K-)	RELATIVE (J-)	ANSWER (V-/U-)
कौन <i>kaun</i> who?	जो <i>jo</i> who/which	वह <i>voh</i> that one
किस <i>kis</i> which? (obl.)	जिस <i>jis</i> jis	उस <i>us</i>

QUESTION (K-)	RELATIVE (J-)	ANSWER (V-/U-)
कहाँ <i>kahaan</i> where?	जहाँ <i>jahaan</i> juh-hah(n)	वहाँ <i>vahaan</i>
कब <i>kab</i> when?	जब <i>jab</i>	तब <i>tab</i>

WATCH OUT

Never build a relative clause with *kaun*. English "who" does double duty (question *and* relative), so learners produce ✗ वह लड़का, कौन वहाँ खड़ा है... (✗ *voh laRkaa, kaun vahaan khaRaa hai...*). In Hindi *kaun* only asks questions. The relative "who/which/that" is always *jo* (oblique *jis/jin*).

2. जो...वह with people and things

जो लड़की गा रही है, वह मेरी बहन है।

jo laRkee gaa rahee hai, voh meree behen hai. [joh luhR-kee gah ruh-hee heh, voh may-ree behen heh]

The girl who's singing is my sister. (behen (f) sister)

जो चाय तुमने बनाई, वह बहुत अच्छी थी।

jo chaay tumne banaaee, voh bahut achchhee thee. [joh chah-ay tum-nay buh-nah-ee, voh buh-hut uch-chhee thee]

The chai you made was really good. (no "who/that" in the English — Hindi still needs *jo*)

जो सब्ज़ी ताज़ी है, वही लेना।

jo sabzee taazee hai, vahee lenaa. [joh sub-zee tah-zee heh, vuh-hee lay-nah]

Buy only the vegetables that are fresh. (vahee = voh + hee "exactly that" — more in Unit 24; sabzee (f))

Word order note: the *jo*-half usually comes first, but speech happily flips it — वह लड़का मेरा दोस्त है जो वहाँ खड़ा है। (*voh laRkaa meraa dost hai jo vahaan khaRaa hai.*) Both are correct; lead with *jo* until the flipped version comes naturally.

3. Oblique: जिस / जिन

The moment a postposition touches the relative word, *jo* obeys the oblique rule you know from Unit 7: singular जिस *jis*, plural जिन *jin* [jin]. Its answering pronoun shifts the same way (*us/un*):

	DIRECT	OBLIQUE (BEFORE A POSTPOSITION)	+ को SHORTCUT
singular	जो <i>jo</i>	जिस <i>jis</i> jis	जिसे <i>jise</i> ji-say (= jisko)
plural	जो <i>jo</i>	जिन <i>jin</i> jin	जिन्हें <i>jinhen</i> jin-hay(n) (= jinko)

जिस आदमी से तुम मिले, वह हमारा पड़ोसी है।

jis aadmee se tum mile, voh hamaaraa paRosee hai. [jis ahd-mee say tum mi-lay, voh huh-mah-rah puh-Roh-see heh]

The man you met is our neighbor. (lit. which man-with you met...; paRosee (m))

जिस दुकान से हम सब्ज़ी लेते हैं, वह आज बंद है।

jis dukaan se ham sabzee lete hain, voh aaj band hai. [jis du-kahn say hum sub-zee lay-tay heh(n), voh ahj bund heh]

The shop we buy vegetables from is closed today. (dukaan (f) shop)

जिन लोगों को तुमने बुलाया, वे लोग आ गए।

jin logon ko tumne bulaayaa, voh log aa gae. [jin loh-goh(n) koh tum-nay bu-lah-yah, voh loh ah guh-ay]

The people you invited have arrived.

जिसे हिन्दी नहीं आती, उसके लिए दिल्ली थोड़ी मुश्किल है।

jise hindee naheen aatee, uske liye dillee thoRee mushkil hai. [ji-say hin-dee nuh-hee(n) ah-tee, us-kay li-yay dil-lee thoh-Ree mush-kil heh]

For someone who doesn't know Hindi, Delhi is a bit tough. (jise ↔ uske: the pair keeps matching in the oblique)

4. जो भी — whoever, whatever

Add *bhee* and the net widens to "any at all":

जो भी चाहिए, बोल दो।

jo bhee chaahiye, bol do. [joh bhee chah-hi-yay, bohl doh]

Whatever you need, just say (it).

जो भी आएगा, उसे चाय मिलेगी।

jo bhee aaegaa, use chaay milegee. [joh bhee ah-ay-gah, u-say chah-ay mi-lay-gee]

Whoever comes will get chai.

5. Places: जहाँ...वहाँ

जहाँ हम रहते हैं, वहाँ बहुत शोर है।

jahaan ham rehte hain, vahaan bahut shor hai. [juh-hah(n) hum reh-tay heh(n), vuh-hah(n) buh-hut shohr heh]

Where we live, there's a lot of noise. (shor (m) noise)

जहाँ अच्छे छोले भटूरे मिलते हैं, वहीं चलते हैं।

jahaan achchhe chhole bhaToore milte hain, vaheen chalte hain. [juh-hah(n) uch-chhay chhoh-lay bhuh-Too-ray mil-tay heh(n), vuh-hee(n) chul-tay heh(n)]

Let's go exactly where the good chhole bhature are. (chhole bhaToore (m pl); vaheen = right there)

DELHI STREET NOTE

Delhi philosophy comes pre-packaged in *jo*-pairs. जो होगा, देखा जाएगा। (*jo hogaa, dekhaa jaaegaa.*) "Whatever happens, we'll see about it then." जो है सो है। (*jo hai so hai.*) [joh heh soh heh] "It is what it is." Traffic, landlords, cricket scores — one of these two covers it.

NOTE

For simple descriptions, Delhi often skips the full relative clause and grabs *vaalaa* instead: लाल वाली कमीज़ (*laal vaalee kameez*) [lahl vah-lee kuh-meez] "the red one (shirt)" rather than "the shirt which is red." You'll get the full *vaalaa* toolkit in Unit 24; *jo...voh* is for when there's a real clause to say.

CULTURE

Introductions at family gatherings run on *jo...voh*: जो अंकल सोफ़े पर बैठे हैं, वे पापा के बड़े भाई हैं। (*jo ankal sofe par baiThe hain, voh paapaa ke baRe bhaaee hain.*) [joh un-kul soh-fay pur beh-Thay heh(n), voh pah-pah kay buh-Ray bhah-ee heh(n)] "The uncle sitting on the sofa is Dad's older brother." Note the respectful plurals (*baiThe hain... hain*) for elders even though he's one person — and yes, every older man is "uncle."

Exercise 21A — jo, jis, jin, jise?

Fill the blank with the right relative word. Answers: Answer Key, Unit 21.

1. ____ लड़का वहाँ खड़ा है, वह मेरा दोस्त है। (____ *laRkaa vahaan khaRaa hai, voh meraa dost hai.*)

2. ___ आदमी से तुम मिले, वह डॉक्टर है। (___ *aadmee se tum mile, voh DaukTar hai.*)

3. ___ किताब तुमने दी, वह बहुत अच्छी है। (___ *kitaab tumne dee, voh bahut achchhee hai.*)

4. ___ लोगों को मैंने बुलाया, वे नहीं आए। (___ *logon ko maine bulaayaa, voh naheen aae.*)

5. ___ घर में हम रहते हैं, वह पुराना है। (___ *ghar mein ham rehte hain, voh puraanaa hai.*)

6. ___ भी आएगा, उसे खाना मिलेगा। (___ *bhee aaegaa, use khaanaa milegaa.*)

7. ___ हिन्दी नहीं आती, उसके लिए यह किताब है। (___ *hindee naheen aatee, uske liye yeh kitaab hai.*)

8. ___ हम कल गए थे, वहाँ की चाय अच्छी थी। (___ *ham kal gae the, vahaan kee chaay achchhee thee.*)

9. ___ ऑटो वाले से मैंने बात की, वह ठीक आदमी था। (___ *auTo vaale se maine baat kee, voh Theek aadmee thaa.*)

10. ___ सब्जी ताज़ी है, वही लो। (___ *sabzee taazee hai, vahee lo.*)

Exercise 21B — Two sentences into one

Join with *jo...voh* (or *jis/jin...us/un*). Model: वह लड़का मेरा दोस्त है + वह वहाँ खड़ा है → जो लड़का वहाँ खड़ा है, वह मेरा दोस्त है।

1. वह लड़की मेरी बहन है + वह गाना गा रही है (*voh laRkee meree behen hai + voh gaanaa gaa rahee hai*)

2. वह फ़िल्म अच्छी थी + हमने वह फ़िल्म कल देखी (*voh film achchhee thee + hamne voh film kal dekhee*)

3. वह दुकान बंद है + उस दुकान से हम दूध लेते हैं (*voh dukaan band hai + us dukaan se ham doodh lete hain*)

4. वह आदमी मेरे ससुर हैं + वह आदमी सोफे पर बैठे हैं (*voh aadmee mere sasur hain + voh aadmee sofe par baithe hain*)

5. वे लोग अच्छे हैं + उन लोगों के साथ हम काम करते हैं (*voh log achchhe hain + un logon ke saath ham kaam karte hain*)

6. वह जगह मुझे पसंद है + वहाँ शांति है (*voh jagah mujhe pasand hai + vahaan shaanti hai*) [use jahaan...voh/vahaan]

Exercise 21C — Translate into Hindi

Lead with the *jo*-half. Write Devanagari or roman (or both).

1. The boy who is standing there is my friend.

2. The chai (that) you made is very good.

3. The man (whom) you met yesterday is my father-in-law. [respectful]

4. Whoever comes will get chai.

5. The house we live in is old.

6. Take whatever you need.

Exercise 21D — Translate into English

Turn the two Hindi halves into one smooth English sentence.

1. जो औरत दरवाज़े पर है, वह मेरी सास हैं। (*jo aurat darvaaze par hai, woh meree saas hain.*)

2. जिस होटल में हम रुके, वह सस्ता था। (*jis hoTal mein ham ruke, woh sastaa thaa.*)

3. जो काम आज हो सकता है, उसे कल पर मत छोड़ो। (*jo kaam aaj ho saktaa hai, use kal par mat chhoRo.*)

4. जो भी बोलोगे, मैं सुनूँगा। (*jo bhee bologe, main sunoongaa.*)

5. जहाँ मेरी पत्नी बड़ी हुई, वहाँ हम अगले साल जाएँगे। (*jahaan meree patnee baRee huee, vahaan ham agle saal jaaenge.*)

UNIT 22

Comparisons & Superlatives

What you'll be able to say: bigger, cheaper, the best in Delhi, the more the merrier — plus the exclamations (*how beautiful!*) that run on the same little words.

दिल्ली मुंबई से पुरानी है।

dillee mumbaee se puraanee hai. [dil-lee mum-buh-ee say pu-rah-nee heh]

Delhi is older than Mumbai. (lit. Delhi Mumbai-than old is)

यह दिल्ली की सबसे अच्छी चाय है।

yeh dillee kee sabse achchhee chaay hai. [yeh dil-lee kee sub-say uch-chhee chah-ay heh]

This is the best chai in Delhi.

कितना सुंदर है!

kitnaa sundar hai! [kit-nah sun-dur heh]

How beautiful (it is)!

1. No "-er" in Hindi: the से pattern

Hindi has no equivalent of "-er/-est." An adjective never changes to make a comparison. Instead you name the loser of the comparison with *se* — literally "compared to" — and keep the plain adjective:

SLOT 1: WINNER	SLOT 2: LOSER + से	SLOT 3: PLAIN ADJECTIVE + VERB
दिल्ली <i>dillee</i>	मुंबई से <i>mumbaee se</i>	पुरानी है। <i>puraanee hai.</i>
मेट्रो <i>meTro</i> (f)	ऑटो से <i>auTo se</i>	तेज़ है। <i>tez hai.</i> tayz heh

The adjective still agrees with the *subject* — the winner: *dillee* (f) → *puraanee*. And "than what?" as a question is *किससे?* (*kisse?*) [kis-say].

यह कमरा उस कमरे से बड़ा है।

yeh kamraa us kamre se baRaa hai. [yeh kum-rah us kum-ray say buh-Rah heh]

This room is bigger than that room. (kamraa (m); note oblique *us kamre* before *se*)

चाय कॉफी से सस्ती है।

chaay kofee se sastee hai. [chah-ay kaw-fee say sus-tee heh]

Chai is cheaper than coffee. (kofee (f))

तुम्हारी हिन्दी मेरी हिन्दी से अच्छी है।

tumhaaree hindee meree hindee se achchhee hai. [tum-hah-ree hin-dee may-ree hin-dee say uch-chhee heh]

Your Hindi is better than my Hindi. (good flattery for the in-laws' house)

WATCH OUT

Don't hang *se* on the wrong noun. ✗ दिल्ली से मुंबई पुरानी है (*X dillee se mumbaee puraanee hai*) says "Mumbai is older than Delhi" — you've flipped the ranking. *se* glues to the one being beaten. Check yourself by reading *X se* as "compared to X": *Delhi, compared-to-Mumbai, is old.*

2. Turning it up and down: ज़्यादा and कम

You can add ज़्यादा *zyaadaa* [zyah-dah] "more" before the adjective — it's optional and doesn't change the meaning, just adds weight. कम *kam* [kum] "less" is its opposite and is *not* optional when you mean "less":

आज कल से ज़्यादा गरमी है।

aaj kal se zyaadaa garmee hai. [ahj kul say zyah-dah gur-mee heh]

It's hotter today than yesterday. (garmee (f) heat; lit. today, compared to yesterday, more heat is)

यह होटल उस होटल से कम महँगा है।

yeh hoTal us hoTal se kam mehngaa hai. [yeh hoh-Tul us hoh-Tul say kum meh(n)-gah heh]

This hotel is less expensive than that one. (hoTal (m))

3. The superlative: सबसे

"Best, biggest, most" = beat *everyone*: सबसे *sabse* [sub-say], literally "than all," parked right before the adjective:

भारत में सबसे बड़ा शहर कौन-सा है?

bhaarat mein sabse baRaa sheher kaun-saa hai? [bhah-rut may(n) sub-say buh-Rah sheh-hur kawn-sah heh]

Which is the biggest city in India? (sheher (m) city)

मेरे लिए परिवार सबसे ज़रूरी है।

mere liye parivaar sabse zarooree hai. [may-ray li-yay puh-ri-vahr sub-say zuh-roo-ree heh]

For me, family is the most important thing. (parivaar (m))

मुझे चाय सबसे ज़्यादा पसंद है।

mujhe chaay sabse zyaadaa pasand hai. [mu-jhay chah-ay sub-say zyah-dah puh-sund heh]

I like chai the most (of all). (sabse zyaadaa works with verbs too)

4. Degree words: the volume knob

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
बहुत	<i>bahut</i>	buh-hut	very
काफ़ी	<i>kaafee</i>	kah-fee	quite, pretty (a lot)
थोड़ा	<i>thoRaa</i>	thoh-Rah	a little
ज़रा	<i>zaraa</i>	zuh-rah	just a touch (softens requests)
इतना	<i>itnaa</i>	it-nah	this much, so
उतना	<i>utnaa</i>	ut-nah	that much
कितना	<i>kitnaa</i>	kit-nah	how much? / how...!

आज इतनी गरमी क्यों है?

aaj itnee garmee kyon hai? [ahj it-nee gur-mee kyoh(n) heh]

Why is it so hot today? (itnaa agrees: garmee (f) → itnee)

खाना काफ़ी अच्छा था, बस थोड़ा तीखा था।

khaanaa kaafee achchhaa thaa, bas thoRaa teekhaa thaa. [khah-nah kah-fee uch-chhah thah, bus thoh-Rah tee-khah thah]

The food was quite good — just a little spicy.

5. The more...the more: जितना...उतना

Meet the correlative family again (Unit 21): question *kitnaa*, relative *jitnaa* [jit-nah], answer *itnaa/utnaa*. Pair *jitnaa...utnaa* for "the X-er, the Y-er" — and remember both agree like adjectives:

जितना गुड़ डालोगे, उतना मीठा होगा।

jitnaa guR Daaloge, utnaa meeThaa hogaa. [jit-nah guR Dah-loh-gay, ut-nah mee-Thah hoh-gah]

The more jaggery you add, the sweeter it'll be. (a real proverb; guR (m) jaggery)

जितनी जल्दी, उतना अच्छा।

jitnee jaldee, utnaa achchhaa. [jit-nee jul-dee, ut-nah uch-chhah]

The sooner, the better. (jaldee (f) → jitnee)

6. Exclamations: कितना...! क्या...!

kitnaa flips from question to exclamation exactly like English "how":

कितनी सुंदर जगह है!

kitnee sundar jagah hai! [kit-nee sun-dur juh-guh heh]

What a beautiful place! (jagah (f) place → kitnee)

यह तो उससे कहीं बेहतर है!

yeh to usse kaheen behtar hai! [yeh toh us-say kuh-hee(n) beh-tur heh]

This is way better than that one! (kaheen behtar = "far better"; behtar = better, straight from Urdu)

DELHI STREET NOTE

Delhi's compliment kit: क्या बात है! (*kyaa baat hai!*) [kyah baht heh] "wow, superb!" (lit. what a thing!) · एक नंबर! (*ek nambar!*) [ayk num-bur] "top class!" · सबसे बढ़िया (*sabse baRhiyaa*) [sub-say buh-Rhi-yah] "the absolute best" — *baRhiyaa* never changes for gender. And Urdu-flavored *behtar* (better) / बेहतरीन *behtareen* [beh-tuh-reen] (finest) will earn you style points at any chai stall.

CULTURE

Comparing is a national sport, and mangoes are the championship. Summer conversation will demand a position: is Delhi's beloved *dasheree* better, or Mumbai's *alfaanso*? A safe, crowd-pleasing answer: मेरे लिए तो दशहरी सबसे अच्छा आम है। (*mere liye to dasheree sabse achchhaa aam hai.*) [may-ray li-yay toh duh-sheh-ree sub-say uch-chhah ahm heh] "For me, dasheri is the best mango." (aam (m) mango.) Bonus points in a Delhi household.

Exercise 22A — Fill the comparison

Fill each blank with one of: से (*se*) · सबसे (*sabse*) · ज्यादा (*zyaadaa*) · कम (*kam*) · जितना/जितनी (*jitnaa/jitnee*) · उतना (*utnaa*) · कितनी (*kitnee*). Answers: Answer Key, Unit 22.

1. दिल्ली मुंबई ____ पुरानी है। (*dillee mumbaee ____ puraanee hai.*)

2. यह ___ अच्छा रेस्टोरेंट है। (yeh ___ achchhaa resTorenT hai.) [best of all]

3. मेट्रो ऑटो से ___ तेज़ है। (meTro auTo se ___ tez hai.) [more]

4. यह कमीज़ उस कमीज़ से ___ महँगी है। (yeh kameez us kameez se ___ mehngai hai.) [less]

5. ___ जल्दी, उतना अच्छा। (___ jaldee, utnaa achchhaa.)

6. जितना पढ़ोगे, ___ सीखोगे। (jitnaa paRhoge, ___ seekhoge.)

7. ___ सुंदर साड़ी है! (___ sundar saaRee hai!) [how...!]

8. मुझे चाय कॉफी ___ ज़्यादा पसंद है। (mujhe chaay kofee ___ zyaadaa pasand hai.)

9. भारत में ___ बड़ा शहर कौन-सा है? (bhaarat mein ___ baRaa sheher kaun-saa hai?)

10. आज कल से ___ गरमी है। (aaj kal se ___ garmee hai.) [more]

Exercise 22B — Build the comparison

1-4: combine the two facts into one X-se-Y sentence (make the FIRST item the winner). 5-7: turn the sentence into a superlative with sabse.

1. यह कमरा बड़ा है। वह कमरा छोटा है। (yeh kamraa baRaa hai. voh kamraa chhoTaa hai.)

2. चाय सस्ती है। कॉफी महँगी है। (chaay sastei hai. kofee mehngai hai.)

3. मेरा फ़ोन पुराना है। तुम्हारा फ़ोन नया है। (*meraa fon puraanaa hai. tumhaaraa fon nayaa hai.*) [start with tumhaaraa fon]

4. दिसंबर ठंडा है। नवंबर कम ठंडा है। (*disambar ThanDaa hai. navambar kam ThanDaa hai.*)

5. यह चाय अच्छी है। → [the best chai in Delhi]

6. वह लड़का लंबा है। → [the tallest boy in the class — class = klaas (f)]

7. यह रास्ता छोटा है। → [the shortest way — raastaa (m)]

Exercise 22C — Translate into Hindi

Write Devanagari or roman (or both).

1. Delhi is bigger than my city.

2. Chai is cheaper than coffee.

3. This is the best food.

4. I like mangoes the most.

5. The sooner, the better.

6. How beautiful this place is!

7. Today is hotter than yesterday.

Exercise 22D — Translate into English

Mind who wins each comparison.

1. मेरी हिन्दी तुम्हारी अंग्रेज़ी से ख़राब है। (*meree hindee tumhaaree angrezee se kharaab hai.*)

2. यह दुकान उस दुकान से सस्ती है। (*yeh dukaan us dukaan se saste hai.*)

3. दशहरी सबसे बढ़िया आम है। (*dasheree sabse baRhiyaa aam hai.*)

4. जितना बोलोगे, उतना सीखोगे। (*jitnaa bologe, utnaa seekhoge.*)

5. कितनी अच्छी ख़बर है! (*kitnee achchhee khabar hai!*)

6. यह वाला उससे कहीं बेहतर है। (*yeh vaalaa usse kaheen behtar hai.*)

UNIT 23

Causatives & Passive (light touch)

What you'll be able to say: the difference between doing, making, and *getting it done* — feed someone, show someone, get your hair cut, have a kurta stitched — plus a first look at the passive you'll see on signs.

मैं हर महीने बाल कटवाता हूँ।

main har maheene baal kaTvaataa hoon. [meh(n) hur muh-hee-nay bahl kuT-vah-tah hoo(n)]

I get my hair cut every month. (lit. I hair cause-to-be-cut; baal (m pl) hair)

मेरी पत्नी मुझे हिन्दी सिखाती है।

merree patnee mujhe hindee sikhaatee hai. [may-ree put-nee mu-jhay hin-dee si-khah-tee heh]

My wife teaches me Hindi. (patnee (f) wife; sikhaanaa = make-learn)

यहाँ हिन्दी बोली जाती है।

yahaan hindee bolee jaatee hai. [yuh-hah(n) hin-dee boh-lee jah-tee heh]

Hindi is spoken here.

1. One root, three sizes

Hindi verbs come in families built on one root. The smallest just *happens* (intransitive), the middle one is *done by you* (transitive), and the biggest means *you make it happen* — usually *through someone else* (causative, with *-aanaa* or *-vaanaa*):

HAPPENS (VI)	YOU DO IT (VT)	YOU GET IT DONE
बनना <i>bannaa</i> (vi) bun-nah get made	बनाना <i>banaanaa</i> (vt) buh-nah-nah make	बनवाना <i>banvaanaa</i> bun-vah-nah have made
—	करना <i>karnaa</i> (vt) do	कराना / करवाना <i>karaanaa</i> / <i>karvaanaa</i> kuh-rah-nah / kur-vah-nah get done
कटना <i>kaTnaa</i> (vi) kuT-nah get cut	काटना <i>kaaTnaa</i> (vt) kahT-nah cut	कटवाना <i>kaTvaanaa</i> kuT-vah-nah have cut
धुलना <i>dhulnaa</i> (vi) dhul-nah get washed	धोना <i>dhonaa</i> (vt) dhoh-nah wash	धुलवाना <i>dhulvaanaa</i> dhul-vah-nah have washed

HAPPENS (VI)	YOU DO IT (VT)	YOU GET IT DONE
सिलना <i>silnaa</i> (vi) sil-nah get stitched	सीना <i>seenaa</i> (vt) see-nah stitch	सिलवाना <i>silvaanaa</i> sil-vah-nah have stitched

You met *bannaa* long ago in खाना बन गया (*khaanaa ban gayaa*) [khah-nah bun guh-yah] "the food is ready (got made)." Now you can climb the whole ladder: *khaanaa banaa* (it got made) → *maine khaanaa banaayaa* (I made it) → *maine khaanaa banvaayaa* (I had it made).

NOTE

Spot the sound pattern in causatives: the root vowel *shortens*. *seekhnaa* → *sikhaanaa*, *dekhnaa* → *dikhaanaa*, *kaaTnaa* → *kaTvaanaa*, *dhonaa* → *dhulvaanaa*. Long vowel in the plain verb, short in the causative — your ear will start predicting it.

2. Feed, show, teach: the -आना causatives

These everyday verbs are "make someone experience X," and the person is marked with *ko*:

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
खिलाना	<i>khilaanaa</i> (vt)	khi-lah-nah	to feed (make eat)
पिलाना	<i>pilaanaa</i> (vt)	pi-lah-nah	to give (someone) a drink
दिखाना	<i>dikhaanaa</i> (vt)	di-khah-nah	to show (make see)
सिखाना	<i>sikhaanaa</i> (vt)	si-khah-nah	to teach (make learn)
सुनाना	<i>sunaanaa</i> (vt)	su-nah-nah	to tell/recite (make hear)

उसने मुझे अपनी नई कार दिखाई।

usne mujhe apnee naee kaar dikhaaee. [us-nay mu-jhay up-nee nuh-ee kahr di-khah-ee]

He showed me his new car. (*kaar* (f) → *dikhaaee*)

पहले बच्चों को खिलाओ, फिर खुद खाओ।

pehle bachchon ko khilaaao, phir khud khaao. [peh-lay buch-choh(n) koh khi-lah-oh, phir khud khah-oh]

Feed the kids first, then eat yourself.

मेहमानों को चाय पिलाओ।

mehmaanon ko chaay pilaaao. [meh-mah-noh(n) koh chah-ay pi-lah-oh]

Give the guests some chai. (*mehmaan* (m) guest)

दादी हमें कहानियाँ सुनाती हैं।

daadee hamen kahaaniyaan sunaatee hain. [dah-dee huh-may(n) kuh-hah-ni-yah(n) su-nah-tee heh(n)]

Grandma tells us stories. (kahaanee (f) story; daadee (f) paternal grandmother)

WATCH OUT

"Teach" is *sikhaanaa*, never *seekhnaa*. Learners map "I'll teach you" onto the verb they already know and say **X** मैं तुम्हें अंग्रेज़ी सीखूँगा (*X main tumhen angrezee seekhoongaa*) — which means "I'll learn English (to your address?)" — nonsense. Say मैं तुम्हें अंग्रेज़ी सिखाऊँगा। (*main tumhen angrezee sikhaaooongaa.*) [meh(n) tum-hay(n) un-gray-zee si-khah-oo(n)-gah] Learn = *seekhnaa*, teach = *sikhaanaa*; the short *i* does the teaching.

3. Getting it done: -वाना and the से agent

The *-vaanaa* forms mean you arranged for it; someone else's hands did it. Name that someone with *se*:

मैंने दर्ज़ी से कुर्ता सिलवाया।

maine darzee se kurtaa silvaayaa. [meh(n)-nay dur-zee say kur-tah sil-vah-yah]

I had a kurta stitched by the tailor. (darzee (m) tailor; kurtaa (m))

हम शादी का खाना हलवाई से बनवाते हैं।

ham shaadee kaa khaanaa halvaaee se banvaate hain. [hum shah-dee kah khah-nah hul-vah-ee say bun-vah-tay heh(n)]

We have the wedding food made by the halvai (caterer). (shaadee (f) wedding; halvaaee (m))

सर्दियों में मैं कपड़े धुलवाता हूँ।

sardiyon mein main kapRe dhulvaataa hoon. [sur-di-yoh(n) may(n) meh(n) kup-Ray dhul-vah-tah hoo(n)]

In winter I get the clothes washed (by someone). (kapRaa (m) cloth/garment; sardee (f) winter)

गाड़ी खराब है — कल ठीक करवाऊँगा।

gaaRee kharaab hai — kal Theek karvaaooongaa. [gah-Ree khuh-rahb heh — kul Theek kur-vah-oo(n)-gah]

The car's broken — I'll get it fixed tomorrow. (gaaRee (f) car/vehicle)

WATCH OUT

Mind the self/other line. मैंने बाल काटे (*maine baal kaaTe*) means you took the scissors and cut your own hair — your barber will be hurt, your partner alarmed. "I got a haircut" is मैंने बाल कटवाए। (*maine baal kaTvaae.*) [meh(n)-nay bahl kuT-vah-ay] Whenever a professional's hands were involved, reach for *-vaanaa*.

DELHI STREET NOTE

Delhi outsources everything, and the sound of errands is *-vaa* plus a Unit-19 vector: गाड़ी धुलवा लो (*gaaRee dhulvaa lo*) [gah-Ree dhul-vah loh] get the car washed · बाल कटवा लो (*baal kaTvaa lo*) get a haircut · इस्त्री करवा लो (*istree karvaa lo*) [ist-ree kur-vah loh] get the ironing done (istree (f) iron/ironing) · and the all-purpose promise करवा लेंगे। (*karvaa lenge.*) [kur-vah lay(n)-gay] "we'll get it sorted" — through a guy someone's cousin knows. That sentence IS Delhi.

4. The passive: participle + जाना

You mostly need to *recognize* the passive — on signs, menus, news. Form: perfective participle + *jaanaa*, both agreeing with the subject:

यह मिठाई दूध से बनाई जाती है।

yeh miThaaee doodh se banaaee jaatee hai. [yeh mi-Thah-ee doodh say buh-nah-ee jah-tee heh]

This sweet is made from milk. (miThaaee (f) → banaaee jaatee)

15 अगस्त को दिल्ली में पतंगें उड़ाई जाती हैं।

pandrah agast ko dillee mein patangen uRaaee jaatee hain. [pund-ruh uh-gust koh dil-lee may(n) puh-tung-ay(n) u-Rah-ee jah-tee heh(n)]

On August 15th, kites are flown in Delhi. (patang (f) kite)

यहाँ ऑटो नहीं मिलते — मेट्रो ली जाती है।

yahaan auTo naheen milte — meTro lee jaatee hai. [yuh-hah(n) aw-Toh nuh-hee(n) mil-tay — may-Troh lee jah-tee heh]

You don't get autos here — one takes the metro. ("is taken" — how things are done around here)

NOTE

Everyday speech often dodges the passive. Where English says "chai is being made," a Delhiite says चाय बन रही है (*chaay ban rahee hai*) [chah-ay bun ruh-hee heh] — the little intransitive family member does the job. Use the *vi* verbs for happenings, save ...*jaataa hai* passives for signs, rules, and "that's how it's done" statements.

CULTURE

Feeding people is the family love language, so *khilaanaa-pilaanaa* carries emotional weight. Your mother-in-law saying मैं तुम्हें अपने हाथ का खाना खिलाऊँगी (*main tumhen apne haath kaa khaanaa khilaaooongee*) [meh(n) tum-hay(n) up-nay haath kah khah-nah khi-lah-oo(n)-gee] "I'll feed you food made by my own hands" is a declaration of affection. And on any good news, someone will demand sweets: मुँह मीठा करवाओ! (*munh meeThaa karvaao!*) [moo(n)h mee-Thah kur-vah-oh] "sweeten our mouths!" — you're buying the mithai.

Exercise 23A — Pick the family member

Choose the right verb from the brackets. Answers: Answer Key, Unit 23.

1. खाना ___ गया — आओ, खा लो। (*khaanaa ___ gayaa — aao, khaa lo.*) [ban / banaa / banvaa]

2. मम्मी रोज़ खाना ___ हैं। (*mummy roz khaanaa ___ hain.*) [bantee / banaatee / banvaatee — she cooks herself]

3. हमने शादी का खाना हलवाई से ___। (*hamne shaadee kaa khaanaa halvaaee se ___.*) [banaayaa / banvaayaa]

4. मैं हर महीने बाल ___ हूँ। (*main har maheene baal ___ hoon.*) [kaaTtaa / kaTvaataa]

5. मेरी पत्नी मुझे हिन्दी ___ है। (*merree patnee mujhe hindee ___ hai.*) [seekhtee / sikhaatee]

6. मैं हिन्दी ___ हूँ। (*main hindee ___ hoon.*) [seekhtaa / sikhaataa]

7. बच्चों को पहले ___। (*bachchon ko pehle ___.*) [khaao / khilao]

8. उसने मुझे फोटो ___। (*usne mujhe foTo* ___.) [dekhaa / dikhaayaa]

9. मैंने दर्जी से सूट ___। (*maine darzee se sooT* ___.) [siyaa / silvaayaa]

10. मेहमानों को पानी ___। (*mehmaanon ko paanee* ___.) [piyo / pilaaao]

Exercise 23B — From doing to getting done

1–5: rewrite so the subject GETS it done (use -vaanaa; add the se-agent where given). 6–7: rewrite as a passive with jaanaa.

1. मैं कपड़े धोता हूँ। (*main kapRe dhotaa hoon.*) → [get them washed]

2. मैंने कुर्ता सिया। (*maine kurtaa siyaa.*) → [by the tailor — darzee se]

3. उसने घर साफ़ किया। (*usne ghar saaf kiyaa.*) → [had it cleaned]

4. मैंने बाल काटे। (*maine baal kaaTe.*) → [got a haircut]

5. हम खाना बनाते हैं। (*ham khaanaa banaate hain.*) → [have it made — kuk se (cook)]

6. लोग यहाँ हिन्दी बोलते हैं। (*log yahaan hindee bolte hain.*) → [passive: Hindi is spoken here]

7. लोग यह मिठाई दूध से बनाते हैं। (*log yeh miThaaee doodh se banaate hain.*) → [passive]

Exercise 23C — Translate into Hindi

Decide each time: do, make, or get done? Write Devanagari or roman (or both).

1. Mummy feeds the kids.

2. Show me your photo. (tum)

3. I get my hair cut every month.

4. She teaches me Hindi.

5. I had a kurta stitched by the tailor.

6. Give Dad some chai. (tum; "make him drink")

7. Hindi is spoken here.

Exercise 23D — Translate into English

Watch who is actually doing the work.

1. दादी बच्चों को खाना खिलाती हैं। (*daadee bachchon ko khaanaa khilaatee hain.*)

2. मैंने अपनी शादी का कुर्ता दर्जी से सिलवाया। (*maine apnee shaadee kaa kurtaa darzee se silvaayaa.*)

3. गाड़ी ठीक करवा लो। (*gaaRee Theek karvaa lo.*)

4. मुझे अपनी नई किताब दिखाओ। (*mujhe apnee naee kitaab dikhaao.*)

5. दिवाली पर मिठाई बाँटी जाती है। (*divaalee par miThaaee baanTee jaatee hai.*) [baanTnaa = distribute]

6. मुँह मीठा करवाओ, खुशखबरी है! (*munh meeThaa karvaao, khushkhabree hai!*)

UNIT 24

The Finishing Touches

What you'll be able to say: the tiny words that make Hindi sound alive — *hee*, *bhee*, *to*, *na*, the mighty *vaalaa*, street flavoring like *yaar* and *arre* — plus a victory lap over everything Book 2 gave you. No new paradigms today; just polish.

मैं तो ठीक हूँ, तुम सुनाओ।

main to Theek hoon, tum sunaao. [meh(n) toh Theek hoo(n), tum su-nah-oh]

Me, I'm fine — what's your news? (lit. you make-me-hear, from Unit 23)

ट्रेन आने वाली है, जल्दी करो!

Tren aane vaalee hai, jaldee karo! [Trayn ah-nay vah-lee heh, jul-dee kuh-roh]

The train's about to come — hurry!

खाना अच्छा है न?

khaanaa achchhaa hai na? [khah-nah uch-chhah heh nah]

The food's good, isn't it?

1. ही — only, exactly, the very one

ही *hee* [hee] sits right after a word and puts a spotlight on it: *this one and no other*.

आज ही करो।

aaj hee karo. [ahj hee kuh-roh]

Do it today — this very day.

यह काम मैं ही करूँगा।

yeh kaam main hee karoongaa. [yeh kahm meh(n) hee kuh-roo(n)-gah]

I'll do this job myself — I and nobody else.

बस एक ही दिक्कत है।

bas ek hee dikkat hai. [bus ayk hee dik-kut heh]

There's just one single problem. (*dikkat* (f) — Delhi's favorite word for "problem")

hee loves to fuse. You already know some of the children: अभी *abhee* [uh-bhee] (ab + *hee*, right now) · यहीं / वहीं *yaheen / vaheen* [yuh-hee(n) / vuh-hee(n)] (right here / right there) · यही / वही *yahee / vahee* [yuh-hee / vuh-hee] (this/that very one) · सभी *sabhee* [suh-bhee] (every single one).

2. भी — also, even

भी *bhee* [bhee] is *hee*'s twin with the opposite job: it *adds* the word to the pile. After a negative or *ek*, it means "even":

मैं भी आऊँगा।

main bhee aaoongaa. [meh(n) bhee ah-oo(n)-gah]

I'll come too.

एक भी ऑटो नहीं मिला।

ek bhee auTo naheen milaa. [ayk bhee aw-Toh nuh-hee(n) mi-lah]

I couldn't find even one auto.

कुछ भी मत बोलो।

kuchh bhee mat bolo. [kuchh bhee mut boh-loh]

Don't say just anything (don't talk nonsense). (*kuchh bhee* = "anything at all" — and, on its own, Delhi for "nonsense!")

WATCH OUT

hee and *bhee* mark the word *directly before* them, so moving them moves the meaning. मैं भी चाय पी रहा हूँ (*main bhee chaay pee rahaa hoon*) = "I too am having chai (like you)." मैं चाय भी पी रहा हूँ (*main chaay bhee pee rahaa hoon*) = "I'm having chai *as well* (on top of something else)." English "also" floats; Hindi *bhee* is glued. Park it right behind the word you mean.

3. तो — as for, mind you

You know *to* as "then" (*agar...to, jab...to*). Its second life is as a topic-and-contrast particle after a word: "as for X..." — often setting up a *lekin*:

गरमी तो बहुत है, लेकिन दिल्ली मज़ेदार है।

garmee to bahut hai, lekin dillee mazedaar hai. [gur-mee toh buh-hut heh, lay-kin dil-lee muh-zay-dahr heh]

The heat, sure, is intense — but Delhi is fun.

तुम तो जानते हो।

tum to jaante ho. [tum toh jahn-tay hoh]

You know how it is (you, of all people, know).

अच्छा, तो चलें?

achchhaa, to chalen? [uch-chhah, toh chuh-lay(n)]

Right — shall we head off, then?

4. The tag न? — "isn't it?"

Hang न *na* [nah] on the end of a statement and it becomes a friendly check. On a request, it becomes a coax:

तुम आओगे न?

tum aaoge na? [tum ah-oh-gay nah]

You'll come, right?

आ जाओ न!

aa jao na! [ah jah-oh nah]

Oh come on, come! (pleading na — hard to refuse)

5. वाला — one word, three jobs

वाला *vaalaa* [vah-lah] agrees like an adjective (*vaalaa* / *vaalee* / *vaale*) and does three jobs

Delhi could not function without:

JOB	PATTERN	EXAMPLE
1. the X-person (occupation)	noun + <i>vaalaa</i>	चाय वाला <i>chaay vaalaa</i> chah-ay vah-lah chai seller · दूध वाला <i>doodh vaalaa</i> milkman · ऑटो वाला <i>auTo vaalaa</i> auto driver
2. the X one (description)	adjective/word + <i>vaalaa</i>	लाल वाली कमीज़ <i>laal vaalee kameez</i> lahl vah-lee kuh-meez the red shirt (kameez (f)) · ऊपर वाला कमरा <i>oopar vaalaa kamraa</i> oo-pur vah-lah kum-rah the upstairs room
3. about to X	oblique infinitive + <i>vaalaa</i> + <i>honaa</i>	आने वाला है <i>aane vaalaa hai</i> ah-nay vah-lah heh is about to come · फ़िल्म शुरू होने वाली है <i>film shuroo hone vaalee hai</i> shu-roo hoh-nay vah-lee heh the film's about to start

सब्ज़ी वाले से धनिया माँग लो — मुफ्त मिलता है।

sabzee vaale se dhaniyaa maang lo — muft miltaa hai. [sub-zee vah-lay say dhuh-ni-yah mah(n)g loh — muft mil-tah heh]

Ask the vegetable-seller for cilantro — it comes free. (dhaniyaa (m); note oblique vaale before se)

छोटा वाला नहीं, बड़ा वाला दो।

chhoTaa vaalaa naheen, baRaa vaalaa do. [chhoh-Tah vah-lah nuh-hee(n), buh-Rah vah-lah doh]

Not the small one — give me the big one. (shopping in five words)

मैं निकलने वाला था कि तुम्हारा फ़ोन आ गया।

main nikalne vaalaa thaa ki tumhaaraa fon aa gayaa. [meh(n) ni-kul-nay vah-lah thah ki tum-hah-rah fohn ah guh-yah]

I was just about to leave when your call came. (female speaker: nikalne vaalee thee)

CULTURE

One *vaalaa* outranks all others: ऊपर वाला (*ooper vaalaa*) [oo-pur vah-lah], "the One upstairs" — God, in everyday Delhi talk. ऊपर वाला सब देखता है। (*ooper vaalaa sab dekhtaa hai.*) "The One above sees everything." Said with a sigh about traffic, landlords, and cricket umpires alike.

6. Street rhythm: अरे, यार, भाई — and "हो गया?"

Delhi sentences come seasoned. अरे *arre* [uh-ray] opens (surprise, protest, hailing); यार *yaar* [yahr] closes (friend-flavor, mild complaint); भाई *bhaaee* [bhah-ee] keeps things brotherly with strangers. And the two-word status check हो गया? (*ho gayaa?*) [hoh guh-yah] asks "done?" about anything — food, homework, haircut, phone call.

अरे यार, फिर से ट्रैफ़िक!

arre yaar, phir se Traifik! [uh-ray yahr, phir say Treh-fik]

Oh man, traffic again! (Traifik (m))

खाना हो गया? — हाँ, हो गया।

khaanaa ho gayaa? — haan, ho gayaa. [khah-nah hoh guh-yah — hah(n), hoh guh-yah]

Eaten? (Is food done?) — Yep, done.

DELHI STREET NOTE

Hear how the particles stack into pure Delhi: चल न यार! (*chal na yaar!*) [chul nah yahr] "come on, yaar!" · वही तो! (*vahee to!*) [vuh-hee toh] "exactly! that's what I'm saying!" · बस हो गया, भाई! (*bas ho gayaa, bhaaee.*) [bus hoh guh-yah, bhah-ee] "that's it, we're done here." · अरे कुछ भी! (*arre kuchh bhee!*) [uh-ray kuchh bhee] "what nonsense!" Four tiny sentences, zero new grammar, one hundred percent Dilli.

7. Numbers doing grammar: दो-दो, सारा

Two quick patterns. Doubling a number distributes it — "X each"; and सारा *saaraa* [sah-rah] "the whole/all" agrees like *baRaa* (saaraa / saaree / saare):

सब बच्चों को दो-दो लड्डू दो।

sab bachchon ko do-do laDDoo do. [sub buch-choh(n) koh doh-doh luD-Doo doh]

Give all the kids two laddus each. (laDDoo (m))

एक-एक करके बोलो।

ek-ek karke bolo. [ayk-ayk kur-kay boh-loh]

Speak one at a time. (karke from Unit 20)

मैंने सारी रात काम किया, सारा दिन सोया।

maine saaree raat kaam kiya, saaraa din soyaa. [meh(n)-nay sah-ree raht kahm ki-yah, sah-rah din soh-yah]

I worked all night and slept all day. (raat (f) → saaree; din (m) → saaraa; and no ne on soyaa!)

Adjectives double too, for fresh-and-intense flavor: गरम-गरम समोसे (*garam-garam samose*) [guh-rum guh-rum suh-moh-say] "piping-hot samosas" (samosaa (m)). And the learner's best friend: हिन्दी? थोड़ी-थोड़ी आती है। (*hindee? thoRee-thoRee aatee hai.*) [hin-dee? thoh-Ree thoh-Ree ah-tee heh] "Hindi? I know a little-little." Say it with a grin; it always lands.

8. You now have the full toolkit

This is the last grammar unit of Book 2 — because you don't need more grammar to speak. Here is what each unit handed you:

UNITS	WHAT THEY GAVE YOU
1-7	The frame: SOV order, pronouns + <i>hona</i> , gender, plurals, <i>kaa/ke/kee</i> + <i>apnaa</i> , adjective agreement, postpositions and the oblique case.

UNITS	WHAT THEY GAVE YOU
8-12	Time: habitual (<i>kartaa hoon</i>), continuous (<i>kar rahaa hoon</i>), <i>ko</i> -constructions (<i>pasand / chaahiye / lagnaa</i>), past <i>hona</i> + past habits, future.
13-15	Action: commands and polite requests, simple past with <i>ne</i> , the perfect tenses.
16-18	Possibility: <i>saknaa / paanaa / chuknaa</i> , obligation (<i>chaahiye, honaa, paRnaa</i>), subjunctive and <i>agar...to</i> .
19-23	Native gear: compound verbs (<i>le lo, ho gayaa</i>), joining ideas + reported speech (<i>ki</i>), relatives (<i>jo...voh</i>), comparisons (<i>se, sabse</i>), causatives (<i>kaTvaanaa</i>) + sign-passives.
24	The shine: <i>hee, bhee, to, na, vaalaa</i> , street rhythm, <i>do-do, saaraa</i> .

From here, Book 3 loads the vocabulary and Book 4 puts you in real Delhi situations — the chai stall, the in-laws' dinner table, the auto negotiation. Every sentence in them is built from tools you now own. तुमने हिन्दी की ग़रामर सीख ली — अब बस बोलना है। (*tumne hindee kee graamar seekh lee — ab bas bolnaa hai.*) [tum-nay hin-dee kee grah-mur seekh lee — ub bus bohl-nah heh] You've learned the grammar — now you just have to speak. हो जाएगा। (*ho jaaegaa.*)

NOTE

These particles are heard far more than written formally, and there's no fine you can pay to skip them — a Hindi sentence without an occasional *to* or *hee* sounds like a textbook. Cheapest fluency upgrade available: add one *na?* per conversation, one *yaar* per complaint.

Exercise 24A — Drop in the particle

Fill each blank with ही (*hee*), भी (*bhee*), तो (*to*), or न (*na*). Answers: Answer Key, Unit 24.

1. मैं ___ ठीक हूँ, तुम बताओ। (*main ___ Theek hoon, tum bataao.*) [as for me]

2. मैं ___ आऊँगा। (*main ___ aaoongaa.*) [me too]

3. आज ___ करो, कल नहीं। (*aaj ___ karo, kal naheen.*) [this very day]

4. तुम आओगे ___? (*tum aaoge ___?*) [right?]

5. एक ___ ऑटो नहीं मिला। (*ek ___ auTo naheen milaa.*) [not even one]

6. चाय ___ अच्छी है, खाना ठंडा है। (*chaay ___ achchhee hai, khaanaa ThanDaa hai.*) [the chai, at least]

7. यह काम मैं ___ करूँगा, तुम आराम करो। (*yeh kaam main ___ karoongaa, tum aaraam karo.*) [I myself]

8. मुझे ___ चाय चाहिए। (*mujhe ___ chaay chaahiye.*) [I want some too]

9. आ जाओ ___! सब इंतज़ार कर रहे हैं। (*aa jaaao ___! sab intazaar kar rahe hain.*) [come on!]

10. अच्छा, ___ चलें? (*achchhaa, ___ chalen?*) [well then]

Exercise 24B — Build it with वाला

Write the *vaalaa*-phrase (mind the gender agreement: *vaalaa/vaalee/vaale*).

1. the chai seller

2. the milkman

3. the red shirt (kameez (f)) — "the red one"

4. the big one (kamraa (m) room)

5. The train is about to come.

6. The film is about to start.

7. I was about to leave. (male speaker)

Exercise 24C — Translate into Hindi

Use the day's small words. Write Devanagari or roman (or both).

1. Me, I'm fine. (main to...)

2. I'll come too.

3. The food is good, isn't it?

4. Not the small one — give me the big one.

5. Give the kids one laddu each.

6. I worked the whole day.

7. Ask the auto driver. (tum; poochhnaa + se)

Exercise 24D — Translate into English

Small words, big meaning — catch the flavor of each.

1. वही तो मैं कह रहा था! (*vahee to main keh rahaa thaa!*)

2. दूध वाला अभी आने वाला है। (*doodh vaalaa abhee aane vaalaa hai.*)

3. मैंने एक भी समोसा नहीं खाया — सच! (*maine ek bhee samosaa naheen khaayaa — sach!*)

4. अरे यार, तुम तो छा गए! (*arre yaar, tum to chhaa gae!*) [chhaa jaanaa = to totally shine, nail it]

5. काम हो गया न? बस, ऊपर वाला बाक़ी सब देख लेगा। (*kaam ho gayaa na? bas, oopar vaalaa baaqee sab dekh legaa.*)

6. हिन्दी? थोड़ी-थोड़ी आती है। (*hinddee? thoRee-thoRee aatee hai.*)

ANSWER KEY**Unit 1****Exercise 1A**

1. (a) मैं जैकब हूँ। (*main Jacob hoon.*) — verb last.
2. (b) यह चाय है। (*yeh chaay hai.*)
3. (a) मैं दिल्ली में रहता हूँ। (*main dillee mein rehtaa hoon.*)
4. (a) क्या यह कॉफी है? (*kyaa yeh kofee hai?*) — *kyaa* goes in front; nothing else moves.
5. (b) बाथरूम कहाँ है? (*baathroom kahaan hai?*) — question word just before the verb.
6. है (*hai*)
7. हूँ (*hoon*)
8. हैं (*hain*)
9. हैं (*hain*)
10. हूँ (*hoon*)

Exercise 1B

1. क्या यह चाय है? (*kyaa yeh chaay hai?*)
2. क्या आप ठीक हैं? (*kyaa aap Theek hain?*)
3. क्या यह पानी है? (*kyaa yeh paanee hai?*)
4. क्या वह राहुल है? (*kyaa voh Rahul hai?*)
5. क्या यह खाना है? (*kyaa yeh khaana hai?*)
6. क्या आप अमेरिका से हैं? (*kyaa aap amerikaa se hain?*)
7. क्या यह कॉफी है? (*kyaa yeh kofee hai?*)

Exercise 1C

1. मैं जैकब हूँ। (*main Jacob hoon.*)
2. यह चाय है। (*yeh chaay hai.*)
3. क्या यह पानी है? (*kyaa yeh paanee hai?*) — a plain यह पानी है? (*yeh paanee hai?*) with a rising tune is also perfect spoken Hindi.
4. यह क्या है? (*yeh kyaa hai?*) — *kyaa* before the verb = “what”.
5. बाथरूम कहाँ है? (*baathroom kahaan hai?*)
6. मैं हिन्दी सीख रहा हूँ। (*main hindee seekh rahaa hoon.*) — a female speaker says मैं हिन्दी सीख रही हूँ। (*main hindee seekh rahee hoon.*)
7. फिर मिलेंगे। (*phir milenge.*)

Exercise 1D

1. Hello! How are you? (asked to a man or a mixed/unknown group)
2. (I'm) fine, thank you. — the “I” is dropped; *hoon* already says it.
3. Is this chai/tea?
4. No, this is coffee.
5. I live in Delhi. (male speaker)
6. Who is that? / Who is he? / Who is she?

ANSWER KEY**Unit 2**

Exercise 2A

1. हूँ (*hoon*)
2. हो (*ho*)
3. हैं (*hain*)
4. है (*hai*)
5. हैं (*hain*)
6. है (*hai*)
7. हैं (*hain*) — respect plural for one respected person.
8. है (*hai*) — tu always pairs with hai.
9. हूँ (*hoon*) — naheen sits before the verb.
10. हैं (*hain*)

Exercise 2B

1. आप कैसे हैं? (*aap kaise hain?*) — to a woman: आप कैसी हैं? (*aap kaisee hain?*)
2. आप कहाँ हैं? (*aap kahaan hain?*)
3. क्या आप ठीक हैं? (*kyaa aap Theek hain?*)
4. आप कौन हैं? (*aap kaun hain?*)
5. क्या आप दिल्ली से हैं? (*kyaa aap dillee se hain?*)
6. आप घर पर हैं? (*aap ghar par hain?*) — with or without *kyaa* in front; the rising tune already asks the question.

Exercise 2C

1. नमस्ते! मैं जैकब हूँ। (*namaste! main Jacob hoon.*)
2. आप कैसी हैं? (*aap kaisee hain?*) — *kaisee*, feminine, because you're asking a woman; and always *aap* with in-laws.
3. मैं ठीक हूँ, और आप? (*main Theek hoon, aur aap?*)
4. वह कौन है? (*voh kaun hai?*)
5. ये शर्मा जी हैं। (*ye Sharma jee hain.*) — plural *hain* out of respect, even for one person.
6. हम अमेरिका से हैं। (*ham amerikaa se hain.*)
7. वह यहाँ नहीं है। (*voh yahaan naheen hai.*)

Exercise 2D

1. How's it going? / How are things? (casual Delhi greeting)
2. All great! / Everything's first-rate!
3. Who are you? (polite)
4. They are from Delhi.
5. Are you okay? (informal — asked with a rising tune to a friend or partner)
6. Pleased to meet you. / Nice meeting you.

ANSWER KEY**Unit 3****Exercise 3A**

1. m — लड़का (*laRkaa*), -aa ending and a male person.
2. f — किताब (*kitaab*), unmarked; memorize the tag.
3. m — पानी (*paanee*), traitor! -ee but masculine.
4. f — कुर्सी (*kursee*), regular -ee feminine.
5. m — घर (*ghar*), unmarked masculine.
6. f — चाय (*chaay*), unmarked feminine.
7. m — समोसा (*samosaa*), regular -aa masculine.
8. f — गाड़ी (*gaaRee*), regular -ee feminine.
9. m — आदमी (*aadmee*), a man, so masculine despite -ee.
10. f — मेज़ (*mez*), unmarked; memorize the tag.

Exercise 3B

1. मेरा घर (*meraa ghar*)
2. मेरी चाय (*merree chaay*)
3. मेरा फ़ोन (*meraa fon*)
4. मेरी किताब (*merree kitaab*)
5. मेरा कमरा (*meraa kamraa*)
6. मेरी गाड़ी (*merree gaaRee*)
7. मेरा दही (*meraa dahee*) — traitor: dahee is masculine.
8. मेरी रोटी (*merree roTee*)

Exercise 3C

1. मेरा नाम जैकब है। (*meraa naam Jacob hai.*) — naam is m.
2. यह मेरी चाय है। (*yeh merree chaay hai.*)
3. पानी ठंडा है। (*paanee ThanDaa hai.*) — ThanDaa, masculine, because paanee is a traitor (m).
4. खाना अच्छा है। (*khaanaa achchhaa hai.*)
5. यह मेरा घर है। (*yeh meraa ghar hai.*)
6. मेरी किताब कहाँ है? (*merree kitaab kahaan hai?*)

Exercise 3D

1. This is my car.
2. The yogurt is cold. (dahee m, so ThanDaa)
3. Where is my chai?
4. This is my friend Rahul.
5. The metro is late.

ANSWER KEY**Unit 4****Exercise 4A**

1. लड़के (*laRke*) — m in -aa: -aa → -e.
2. किताबें (*kitaaben*) — unmarked f: add -en.
3. घर (*ghar*) — unmarked m: no change.
4. कुर्सियाँ (*kursiyaan*) — f in -ee: -ee → -iyaan.
5. समोसे (*samose*)
6. औरतें (*auraten*)
7. आदमी (*aadmee*) — masculine (traitor!), so no change.
8. कमरे (*kamre*)
9. सब्ज़ियाँ (*sabziyaan*)
10. मेज़ें (*mezen*)

Exercise 4B

1. ये लड़के हैं। (*ye laRke hain.*)
2. ये किताबें हैं। (*ye kitaaben hain.*)
3. वो आदमी हैं। (*voh aadmee hain.*) — noun unchanged; the verb shows the plural.
4. ये कुर्सियाँ हैं। (*ye kursiyaan hain.*)
5. ये समोसे गरम हैं। (*ye samose garam hain.*)
6. वो औरतें ठीक हैं। (*voh auraten Theek hain.*)
7. ये मेरी गाड़ियाँ हैं। (*ye merree gaaRiyaan hain.*) — merree stays the same for feminine plural.

Exercise 4C

1. भैया, दो चाय देना। (*bhaiyaa, do chaay denaa.*) — also fine: भैया, दो कप चाय देना। (*bhaiyaa, do kap chaay denaa.*)
2. लड़के यहाँ हैं। (*laRke yahaan hain.*)
3. ये मेरी किताबें हैं। (*ye merree kitaaben hain.*)
4. आदमी वहाँ हैं। (*aadmee vahaan hain.*)
5. पिताजी आ रहे हैं। (*pitaajee aa rahe hain.*) — honorific plural throughout.
6. किताबें मेज़ पर हैं। (*kitaaben mez par hain.*)
7. आप लोग कैसे हैं? (*aap log kaise hain?*)

Exercise 4D

1. These are girls.
2. Two samosas and one chai, bhaiya.
3. Sharma-ji is coming. (one respected man — the plural is honorific, not “they”)
4. They are from America.
5. The men are here. (aadmee is unchanged; hain tells you it's plural)
6. We're (all) fine.

ANSWER KEY**Unit 5****Exercise 5A**

1. की (*kee*) — kitaab is f.
2. का (*kaa*) — ghar is m.
3. का (*kaa*) — fon is m; Neha's gender is irrelevant.
4. की (*kee*) — gaaRee is f.
5. के (*ke*) — beTe is m plural.
6. का (*kaa*) — khaanaa is m, even though saas is a woman.
7. की (*kee*) — kursee is f.
8. का (*kaa*) — fon is m.
9. की (*kee*) — kitaaben is f plural; kee covers f singular and plural.
10. के (*ke*) — joote is m plural.

Exercise 5B

1. मेरी किताब (*meree kitaab*)
2. आपका घर (*aapkaa ghar*)
3. तुम्हारा फ़ोन (*tumhaaraa fon*)
4. हमारी बेटी (*hamaaree beTee*)
5. उसकी गाड़ी (*uskee gaaRee*)
6. मेरे ससुर (*mere sasur*) — honorific plural, never “meraa sasur”.
7. आपकी किताबें (*aapkee kitaaben*)

Exercise 5C

1. मेरा नाम जैकब है। (*meraa naam Jacob hai.*)
2. आपका नाम क्या है? (*aapkaa naam kyaa hai?*)
3. यह मेरी पत्नी है। (*yeh meree patnee hai.*) — many speakers politely say ये मेरी पत्नी हैं। (*ye meree patnee hain.*); both are fine.
4. ये मेरे ससुर हैं। (*ye mere sasur hain.*) — ye + mere + hain: respect plural all the way through.
5. तुम्हारा फ़ोन कहाँ है? (*tumhaaraa fon kahaan hai?*)
6. हमारा घर दिल्ली में है। (*hamaaraa ghar dillee mein hai.*)
7. राहुल की गाड़ी यहाँ है। (*Rahul kee gaaRee yahaan hai.*)

Exercise 5D

1. Where is your house? (respectful “your”)
2. This is my mother-in-law. (hain — honorific plural)
3. My mother-in-law's food is very good.
4. This is not his/her phone.
5. Take care of yourself!
6. Where is your chai? (informal “your” — said to a partner or friend)

ANSWER KEY**Unit 6****Exercise 6A**

1. अच्छा (*achchhaa*) — m singular.
2. अच्छी (*achchhee*) — chaay is f.
3. बड़ा (*baRaa*)
4. अच्छी (*achchhee*) — feminine form serves singular and plural.
5. छोटे (*chhoTe*) — m plural.
6. लाल (*laal*) — unmarked: no change.
7. ठंडा (*ThanDaa*) — paanee is masculine (Unit 3 traitor).
8. नई (*nayee*) — irregular spelling of nayaa's feminine.
9. गरम (*garam*) — unmarked: no change.
10. पुरानी (*puraanee*) — mezen is f plural.

Exercise 6B

1. अच्छी लड़की (*achchhee laRkee*)
2. बड़े कमरे (*baRe kamre*)
3. लंबी लड़की (*lambee laRkee*)
4. नई गाड़ी (*nayee gaaRee*)
5. छोटी किताबें (*chhoTee kitaaben*) — the adjective stays *chhoTee*; only the noun pluralizes.
6. मोटे कुत्ते (*moTe kutte*)
7. सफ़ेद कमीज़ें (*safed kameezen*) — *safed* is unmarked, so only the noun changes.

Exercise 6C

1. चाय गरम है। (*chaay garam hai.*)
2. पानी ठंडा है। (*paanee ThanDaa hai.*)
3. यह अच्छी किताब है। (*yeh achchhee kitaab hai.*)
4. मेरा घर छोटा है। (*meraa ghar chhoTaa hai.*)
5. लड़के लंबे हैं। (*laRke lambe hain.*)
6. खाना कैसा है? (*khaanaa kaisaa hai?*)
7. Male speaker: मैं अच्छा हूँ। (*main achchhaa hoon.*) — Female speaker: मैं अच्छी हूँ। (*main achchhee hoon.*)

Exercise 6D

1. The chai is very good.
2. This room is not clean.
3. My car isn't new, it's old.
4. The auto(-rickshaw) is expensive; the metro is cheap.
5. Just a little chai, that's all. / A tiny bit of chai, enough.
6. My father-in-law is very nice. (honorific plural: mere ... achchhe hain)

ANSWER KEY**Unit 7**

Exercise 7A

1. में (*mein*)
2. पर (*par*)
3. लिए (*liye*)
4. पास (*paas*)
5. से ... तक (*se ... tak*)
6. साथ (*saath*)
7. बाद (*baad*)
8. पहले (*pehle*)
9. सामने (*saamne*)
10. बाहर (*baahar*)

Exercise 7B

1. लड़के को (*laRke ko*)
2. लड़कों को (*laRkon ko*)
3. कमरे में (*kamre mein*)
4. घरों में (*gharon mein*)
5. लड़की को (*laRkee ko*) — feminine singular: no change
6. लड़कियों को (*laRkiyon ko*)
7. अच्छे लड़के के साथ (*achchhe laRke ke saath*) — adjective goes oblique too
8. मेरे भाई के लिए (*mere bhaaee ke liye*)

Exercise 7C

1. किताब मेज़ पर है। (*kitaab mez par hai.*) — The book is on the table.
2. मेरे दो भाई हैं। (*mere do bhaaee hain.*) — Family members take the plain possessive, not के पास.
3. मेरे पास नया फ़ोन है। (*mere paas nayaa fon hai.*)
4. बच्चे कमरे में हैं। (*bachche kamre mein hain.*)
5. यह तोहफ़ा मेरी बहन के लिए है। (*yeh tohfaa meree behen ke liye hai.*)
6. बैंक होटल के सामने है। (*baink hoTal ke saamne hai.*)
7. जैकब अपने दोस्तों के साथ है। (*jaikab apne doston ke saath hai.*) — his own friends → अपने.

Exercise 7D

1. My phone is under the pillow.
2. The shop is open from morning till evening.
3. Do you have time?
4. There's a small market behind the temple.
5. He/she doesn't have a car.
6. After food (eating), chai is essential.

ANSWER KEY**Unit 8**

Exercise 8A

1. पीता हूँ (*peetaa hoon*)
2. करती है (*kartee hai*)
3. सीखते हैं (*seekhte hain*) (all-female "we": सीखती हैं *seekhatee hain*)
4. उठते हो (*uThthe ho*)
5. रहते हैं (*rehte hain*)
6. पढ़ती है (*paRhatee hai*)
7. देखते हैं (*dekhte hain*)
8. खाता (*khaataa*) — auxiliary dropped in the negative (खाता है also accepted)
9. करते हैं (*karte hain*) — respectful plural for father-in-law

Exercise 8B

1. वह चाय पीती है। (*voh chaay peetee hai.*)
2. आप कब सोते हैं? (*aap kab sote hain?*)
3. हम दिल्ली में रहते हैं। (*ham dillee mein rehte hain.*)
4. वे लोग फ़िल्म देखते हैं। (*voh log film dekhte hain.*)
5. मेरी पत्नी सुबह जल्दी उठती है। (*merree patnee subah jaldee uThtee hai.*)
6. वह टीवी नहीं देखती। (*voh TeeVee naheen dekhtee.*)
7. क्या तुम रोज़ नहाते हो? (*kyaa tum roz nahaate ho?*)

Exercise 8C

1. मैं रोज़ चाय पीता हूँ। (*main roz chaay peetaa hoon.*)
2. वह दिल्ली में रहती है। (*voh dillee mein rehte hai.*)
3. हम शाम को घर पर खाना खाते हैं। (*ham shaam ko ghar par khaanaa khaate hain.*) (घर में also fine)
4. क्या तुम फ़िल्में देखते हो? (*kyaa tum filmen dekhte ho?*) (फ़िल्म singular also fine)
5. मैं गोश्त नहीं खाता। (*main gosht naheen khaataa.*)
6. मेरी पत्नी ऑफ़िस में काम करती है। (*merree patnee ofis mein kaam kartee hai.*)
7. आप कितने बजे उठते हैं? (*aap kitne baje uThthe hain?*) (to a woman: उठती हैं *uThtee hain*)

Exercise 8D

1. In Delhi people go to sleep late.
2. She sometimes talks to her mother on the phone.
3. I usually go to the office by metro.
4. Do you eat meat?
5. My father-in-law takes a walk in the park every day.
6. She doesn't watch much TV.

ANSWER KEY**Unit 9**

Exercise 9A

1. खा रहा हूँ (*khaa rahaa hoon*)
2. नहा रही है (*nahaa rahee hai*)
3. आ रहे हैं (*aa rahe hain*)
4. सो रहे हैं (*so rahe hain*)
5. सुन रहे हो (*sun rahe ho*)
6. बना रही हैं (*banaa rahee hain*) — feminine रही + respectful plural हैं
7. पढ़ रहे हैं (*paRh rahe hain*)
8. हो रही है (*ho rahee hai*)
9. सीख रही है (*seekh rahee hai*)

Exercise 9B

1. मैं (अभी) चाय पी रहा हूँ। (*main abhee chaay pee rahaa hoon.*)
2. वह (अभी) टीवी देख रही है। (*voh abhee TeeVee dekh rahee hai.*)
3. हम (अभी) हिन्दी सीख रहे हैं। (*ham abhee hindee seekh rahe hain.*)
4. तुम क्या कर रहे हो? (*tum kyaa kar rahe ho?*)
5. वे लोग (अभी) खाना खा रहे हैं। (*voh log abhee khaanaa khaa rahe hain.*)
6. मेरी पत्नी (अभी) योग कर रही है। (*meree patnee abhee yog kar rahee hai.*)
7. आप कहाँ जा रहे हैं? (*aap kahaan jaa rahe hain?*)

Exercise 9C

1. आजकल मैं हिन्दी सीख रहा हूँ। (*aajkal main hindee seekh rahaa hoon.*)
2. तुम क्या कर रहे हो? (*tum kyaa kar rahe ho?*)
3. बारिश हो रही है। (*baarish ho rahee hai.*)
4. माँ खाना बना रही हैं। (*maan khaanaa banaa rahee hain.*)
5. बच्चे सो रहे हैं। (*bachche so rahe hain.*)
6. वह अभी नहा रही है। (*voh abhee nahaa rahee hai.*)
7. हम मेट्रो से आ रहे हैं। (*ham meTro se aa rahe hain.*)

Exercise 9D

1. The chai is brewing. / The tea is being made.
2. Papa is reading the newspaper.
3. They're living in Gurgaon these days.
4. I'm just about to arrive. / I'm almost there.
5. Are you listening?
6. My mother-in-law is going to the temple.

ANSWER KEY

Unit 10

Exercise 10A

1. है (*hai*) — chaay is f singular
2. हैं (*hain*) — momos is plural
3. है (*hai*)
4. है (*hai*)
5. लगी (*lagtee*) — bhookh (f)
6. रही (*rahee*) — ThanD (f), continuous
7. चाहिए (*chaahiye*) (चाहिँँ *chaahiye*n also accepted)
8. लगती (*lagtee*) — dillee (f)
9. लगता (*lagtaa*) — shehar (m)
10. में (*mein*)

Exercise 10B

1. क्या आपको चाय पसंद है? (*kyaa aapko chaay pasand hai?*)
2. हमें पानी चाहिए। (*hamen paanee chaahiye.*)
3. मुझे ठंड लग रही है। (*mujhe ThanD lag rahee hai.*)
4. मेरी पत्नी को हिन्दी आती है। (*meree patnee ko hindee aatee hai.*)
5. उन्हें नहीं पता। (*unhen naheen pataa.*) (उनको unko also fine)
6. जैकब को मोमोज़ पसंद हैं। (*jaikab ko momos pasand hain.*)
7. उसे सिरदर्द है। (*use sirdard hai.*) (उसको usko also fine)

Exercise 10C

1. मुझे चाय पसंद है। (*mujhe chaay pasand hai.*)
2. मुझे मोमोज़ पसंद हैं। (*mujhe momos pasand hain.*) — plural हैं
3. मुझे भूख लगी है। (*mujhe bhookh lagee hai.*)
4. मुझे ठंड लग रही है। (*mujhe ThanD lag rahee hai.*)
5. हमें दो कमरे चाहिए। (*hamen do kamre chaahiye.*)
6. मुझे सिरदर्द है। (*mujhe sirdard hai.*) / मेरे सिर में दर्द है। (*mere sir mein dard hai.*)
7. क्या आपको हिन्दी आती है? (*kyaa aapko hindee aatee hai?*)
8. मुझे नहीं पता। (*mujhe naheen pataa.*) (मुझे नहीं मालूम also fine)

Exercise 10D

1. I'm getting sleepy.
2. Do you like this song?
3. He/she is afraid of dogs.
4. At first this food seemed strange; now I like it.
5. What would you like? / What do you need?
6. I know a little Hindi.

ANSWER KEY**Unit 11**

Exercise 11A

1. था (*thaa*)
2. थी (*thee*)
3. थे (*the*)
4. था (*thaa*) — paanee (m)
5. थी (*thee*) — bijlee (f)
6. थीं (*theen*) — respected lady
7. थे (*the*) — palang m plural
8. थे (*the*)
9. थीं (*theen*)
10. थे (*the*)

Exercise 11B

1. मैं दिल्ली में रहता था। (*main dillee mein rehtaa thaa.*)
2. वह चाय पीती थी। (*voh chaay peetee thee.*)
3. हम साथ पढ़ते थे। (*ham saath paRhate the.*)
4. मैं सो रहा था। (*main so rahaa thaa.*)
5. वह खाना बना रही थी। (*voh khaanaa banaa rahee thee.*)
6. तुम क्या कर रहे थे? (*tum kya kar rahe the?*)
7. मेरे दादा जी रोज़ सैर करते थे। (*mere daadaa jee roz sair karte the.*)

Exercise 11C

1. कल मौसम अच्छा था। (*kal mausam achchhaa thaa.*)
2. कल रात बिजली नहीं थी। (*kal raat bijlee naheen thee.*)
3. जब मैं छोटा था, हम शिकागो में रहते थे। (*jab main chhoTaa thaa, ham shikaago mein rehte the.*)
4. वह बहुत चाय पीती थी। (*voh bahut chaay peetee thee.*)
5. मैं सो रहा था। (*main so rahaa thaa.*) (a woman: सो रही थी so rahee thee)
6. तुम क्या कर रहे थे? (*tum kya kar rahe the?*)
7. रात को बारिश हो रही थी। (*raat ko baarish ho rahee thee.*)

Exercise 11D

1. Before the wedding, we were neighbours.
2. Earlier (before), I didn't understand Hindi.
3. My grandmother used to go to the temple every day.
4. Where were you last night? I was calling (you)!
5. There used to be nothing here; now there's a mall.
6. In (his) childhood he used to play a lot of cricket.

ANSWER KEY**Unit 12****Exercise 12A**

1. करूँगा (*karoongaa*)
2. आएगी (*aaegree*)
3. मिलेंगे (*milenge*) (all-female "we": मिलेंगी *milengee*)
4. आओगे (*aaoge*)
5. लेंगे (*leng*) (to a woman: लेंगी *leng*)
6. लूँगा (*loongaa*)
7. होंगे (*honge*)
8. होगी (*hoge*) — paarTee (f)
9. जाएँगे (*jaaenge*)
10. बताएगी (*bataaegree*)

Exercise 12B

1. मैं (कल) तुम्हें फ़ोन करूँगा। (*main kal tumhen fon karoongaa.*)
2. वह (कल) घर पर खाना खाएगी। (*voh kal ghar par khaanaa khaaegree.*)
3. हम मेट्रो से जाएँगे। (*ham meTro se jaaenge.*)
4. तुम कितने बजे उठोगे? (*tum kitne baje uThoge?*)
5. आप कहाँ रहेंगे? (*aap kahaan rahenge?*)
6. वे लोग फ़िल्म देखेंगे। (*voh log film dekhenge.*)
7. मैं गोश्त नहीं खाऊँगा। (*main gosht naheen khaaongaa.*)

Exercise 12C

1. मैं कल तुम्हें फ़ोन करूँगा। (*main kal tumhen fon karoongaa.*)
2. कल मैं घर पर था। कल मैं ऑफ़िस में हूँगा। (*kal main ghar par thaa. kal main ofis mein hoongaa.*) — same कल, tense decides the day.
3. वह नहीं आएगी। (*voh naheen aaegree.*)
4. आप क्या लेंगे? — मैं चाय लूँगा। (*aap kyaa leng? — main chaay loongaa.*)
5. हम शाम को मिलेंगे। (*ham shaam ko milenge.*)
6. शादी में बहुत लोग होंगे। (*shaadee mein bahut log honge.*)
7. अगले हफ़्ते हम आगरा जाएँगे। (*agle hafte ham aagraa jaaenge.*)

Exercise 12D

1. Yesterday I was in Delhi. (था = past, so कल = yesterday)
2. Tomorrow I'll go to Delhi. (जाऊँगा = future, so कल = tomorrow)
3. I won't be late — promise!
4. He'll be at home. / He's probably at home. (presumptive होगा)
5. The day after tomorrow is (will be) a holiday.
6. Okay then, see you around! / See you later!

ANSWER KEY**Unit 13****Exercise 13A**

1. बोलिए (*boliye*) — धीरे बोलिए।
2. बैठो (*baiTho*) — यहाँ बैठो।
3. खोलो (*kholo*) — दरवाज़ा खोलो।
4. सुनिए (*suniye*) — ज़रा सुनिए।
5. लीजिए (*leejiye*) — चाय लीजिए।
6. दो (*do*) — मुझे पानी दो।
7. आइए (*aaiye*) — अंदर आइए।
8. करो (*karo*) — जल्दी करो।
9. चलिए (*chaliye*) — मेरे साथ चलिए।
10. कीजिए (*keejiye*) — बत्ती बंद कीजिए।

Exercise 13B

1. यहाँ बैठिए। (*yahaan baiThiye.*)
2. धीरे बोलिए। (*dheere boliye.*)
3. यह लीजिए। (*yeh leejiye.*)
4. मुझे बताइए। (*mujhe bataaiye.*)
5. खिड़की खोलिए। (*khiRkee kholiye.*)
6. चाय पीजिए। (*chaay peejiye.*)
7. यहाँ न बैठिए। (*yahaan na baiThiye.*)
8. देर न कीजिए। (*der na keejiye.*)

Exercise 13C

1. यहाँ बैठिए। (*yahaan baiThiye.*)
2. मुझे पानी दो। (*mujhe paanee do.*)
3. अभी मत जाओ। (*abhee mat jaao.*)
4. अंदर आइए। (*andar aaiye.*)
5. थोड़ा धीरे बोलिए। (*thoRaa dheere boliye.*) Also fine: ज़रा धीरे बोलिए। (*zaraa dheere boliye.*)
6. खिड़की बंद करो। (*khiRkee band karo.*)
7. कल मुझे फ़ोन करना। (*kal mujhe fon karnaa.*)
8. चिंता न कीजिए। (*chintaa na keejiye.*)

Exercise 13D

1. Excuse me — please listen a moment. / Could I have a moment?
2. Don't worry.
3. Do come tomorrow, for sure. (gentle infinitive command + zaroor "definitely")
4. Do take a little more, won't you?
5. Come on, it's getting late.
6. Excuse me, please wait one minute.

ANSWER KEY**Unit 14****Exercise 14A**

1. गया (*gayaa*) — मैं कल बाज़ार गया। No ne with jaanaa.
2. गई (*gaae*) — मेरी बहन कल दिल्ली गई।
3. मैंने (*maine*) — मैंने चाय पी।
4. आए (*aae*) — हम शाम को घर आए।
5. उसने (*usne*) — उसने यह किताब पढ़ी।
6. खाए (*khaae*) — समोसे m pl → खाए।
7. पिया (*piyaa*) — दूध m sg → पिया।
8. पहुँचे (*pahunche*) — आप कब पहुँचे? No ne with pahunchnaa.
9. उन्होंने (*unhonne*) — उन्होंने काम किया।
10. खोला (*kholaa*) — दरवाज़ा m sg → खोला।

Exercise 14B

1. कल मैंने चाय पी। (*kal maine chaay pee.*)
2. कल वह बाज़ार गई। (*kal voh baazaar gaae.*)
3. कल हमने रोटी खाई। (*kal hamne roTee khaaee.*)
4. कल तुमने गाना सुना। (*kal tumne gaanaa sunaa.*)
5. कल मैंने काम किया। (*kal maine kaam kiya.*)
6. कल वे लोग जल्दी उठे। (*kal voh log jaldee uThe.*) No ne with uThnaa.
7. कल उसने किताब पढ़ी। (*kal usne kitaab paRhee.*)
8. कल मैंने अंडे बनाए। (*kal maine anDe banaae.*) anDe m pl → banaae.

Exercise 14C

1. मैंने चाय पी। (*maine chaay pee.*) I drank tea.
2. वह घर गई। (*voh ghar gaae.*) She went home.
3. तुमने क्या खाया? (*tumne kyaa khaayaa?*) What did you eat?
4. मैंने अपनी बहन को देखा। (*maine apnee behen ko dekhaa.*) I saw my sister. ko-object → default m sg.
5. उन्होंने खाना बनाया। (*unhonne khaanaa banaayaa.*) They made food.
6. मेरा फ़ोन किसने लिया? (*meraa fon kisne liyaa?*) Who took my phone? Also fine: किसने मेरा फ़ोन लिया?
7. हम रात को पहुँचे। (*ham raat ko pahunche.*) We arrived at night.

Exercise 14D

1. I went to sleep late last night. (sonaa: no ne, soyaa agrees with "I" m)
2. I made tea for you. (banaaee f, agreeing with chaay)
3. He/she gave me money.
4. Did you see this film? / Have you seen this film?
5. They came by metro.
6. I didn't buy anything.

ANSWER KEY**Unit 15****Exercise 15A**

1. है (hai) — वह अभी आया है।
2. हैं (hain) — मम्मी अभी बाज़ार गई हैं। Respect plural for an elder.
3. है (hai) — मैंने खाना खाया है।
4. थे (the) — हम पिछले साल दिल्ली गए थे।
5. थी (thee) — फ़िल्म f sg → देखी थी।
6. है (hai) — चाबी f sg → देखी है।
7. हैं (hain) — वे लोग अभी आए हैं।
8. थे (the) — पैसे m pl → दिए थे।
9. हैं (hain) — किताबें f pl → पढ़ी हैं।
10. थीं (theen) — लड़कियाँ घर गई थीं। Nasal on the last word only.

Exercise 15B

1. मैंने चाय पी है। (maine chaay pee hai.)
2. वह घर गया है। (voh ghar gayaa hai.)
3. हमने खाना खाया है। (hamne khaanaa khaayaa hai.)
4. मेरी बहन आई है। (merree behen aaee hai.)
5. मैंने यह फ़िल्म पहले देखी थी। (maine yeh film pehle dekhee thee.)
6. हम पिछले साल दिल्ली गए थे। (ham pichhle saal dillee gae the.)
7. उसने यह काम पहले किया था। (usne yeh kaam pehle kiyaa thaa.)
8. तुमने यह गाना पहले सुना था। (tumne yeh gaanaa pehle sunaa thaa.)

Exercise 15C

1. मैंने खाना खाया है। (*maine khaanaa khaayaa hai.*)
2. वह घर गई है। (*voh ghar gae hai.*)
3. क्या आपने यह फ़िल्म देखी है? (*kyaa aapne yeh film dekhee hai?*)
4. हम पिछले साल दिल्ली गए थे। (*ham pichhle saal dillee gae the.*)
5. मैंने यह किताब पहले पढ़ी थी। (*maine yeh kitaab pehle paRhee thee.*)
6. मम्मी अभी आई हैं। (*mummy abhee aaee hain.*)
7. मैंने अभी तक खाना नहीं खाया। (*maine abhee tak khaanaa naheen khaayaa.*) Adding है at the end is also fine.
8. हम पहले मिले थे। (*ham pehle mile the.*) milnaa: no ne.

Exercise 15D

1. He's just this minute left. / He just left.
2. I've seen this film twice.
3. I went to Sarojini Nagar yesterday. (Delhi-style thaa-past for a plain "went")
4. Have you ever seen (experienced) a Delhi winter?
5. I told you (so), didn't I!
6. I haven't had (drunk) tea yet.

ANSWER KEY**Unit 16****Exercise 16A**

1. सकता (saktaa) — मैं हिन्दी बोल सकता हूँ।
2. सकते (sakte) — क्या आप मेरी मदद कर सकते हैं?
3. सकती (saktee) — वह गाड़ी चला सकती है।
4. सके (sake) — हम कल नहीं आ सके।
5. सकता (saktaa) — क्या मैं अंदर आ सकता हूँ?
6. सकती (saktee) — क्या तुम धीरे बोल सकती हो?
7. सका (sakaa) — कल रात मैं नहीं सो सका।
8. सकेंगे (sakenge) — वे लोग कल नहीं आ सकेंगे।
9. सकती (saktee) — मेरी बहन तैर सकती है।
10. सकती (saktee) — आप यहाँ बैठ सकती हैं।

Exercise 16B

1. मैं हिन्दी बोल सकता हूँ। (main hindee bol saktaa hoon.)
2. वह खाना बना सकती है। (voh khaanaa banaa saktee hai.)
3. हम आज आ सकते हैं। (ham aaj aa sakte hain.)
4. तुम गाड़ी चला सकते हो। (tum gaaRee chala sakte ho.)
5. क्या मैं अंदर आ सकता हूँ? (kyaa main andar aa saktaa hoon?)
6. क्या आप धीरे बोल सकते हैं? (kyaa aap dheere bol sakte hain?)
7. मैं कल नहीं आ पाया। (main kal naheen aa paayaa.)
8. वह रात को सो नहीं पाई। (voh raat ko so naheen paaee.) Also fine: वह रात को नहीं सो पाई।

Exercise 16C

1. मैं थोड़ी हिन्दी बोल सकता हूँ। (*main thoRee hindee bol saktaa hoon.*)
2. क्या आप मेरी मदद कर सकते हैं? (*kyaa aap meree madad kar sakte hain?*)
3. क्या मैं अंदर आ सकता हूँ? (*kyaa main andar aa saktaa hoon?*)
4. कल रात मैं नहीं सो सका। (*kal raat main naheen so sakaa.*) Also fine: ... सो नहीं पाया। (*so naheen paayaa.*)
5. वह गाड़ी चला सकती है। (*voh gaaRee chala saktee hai.*)
6. मैं खाना खा चुका हूँ। (*main khaanaa khaa chukaa hoon.*) main, never maine.
7. वे लोग जा चुके हैं। (*voh log jaa chuke hain.*)
8. माफ़ कीजिए, मैं कल नहीं आ सकूँगा। (*maaf keejiye, main kal naheen aa sakoongaa.*) Also fine: ... नहीं आ पाऊँगा। (*naheen aa paaongaa.*)

Exercise 16D

1. May I ask you a question?
2. The tea is already made / ready.
3. I couldn't make it yesterday.
4. Could be. / It's possible. / Maybe.
5. Can you bring samosas for me?
6. I'm sorry, I couldn't do anything.

ANSWER KEY**Unit 17****Exercise 17A**

1. मुझे (*mujhe*) — मुझे अब जाना चाहिए।
2. पढ़नी (*paRhnee*) — किताब f sg.
3. करना (*karnaa*) — आराम m sg.
4. खरीदने (*khareedne*) — समोसे m pl.
5. लेनी (*lenee*) — दवाई f sg; लेनी पड़ी, both feminine.
6. हमें (*hamen*) — हमें आज घर जाना है।
7. पड़ता (*paRtaa*) — recurring compulsion.
8. पड़ेगा (*paRegaa*) — future compulsion.
9. की (*kee*) — ज़रूरत is feminine: पैसों की ज़रूरत।
10. देखनी (*dekhnee*) — फ़िल्म f sg.

Exercise 17B

1. मुझे जाना पड़ेगा। (*mujhe jaanaa paRegaa.*)
2. कल मुझे सब्ज़ी खरीदनी पड़ी। (*kal mujhe sabzee khareednee paRee.*)
3. आपको आज आराम करना है। (*aapko aaj aaraam karnaa hai.*)
4. मुझे जल्दी उठना पड़ेगा। (*mujhe jaldee uThnaa paRegaa.*)
5. मुझे दो किताबें पढ़नी हैं। (*mujhe do kitaaben paRhnee hain.*)
6. तुम्हें दवाई लेनी पड़ी। (*tumhen davaaee lenee paRee.*)
7. मुझे पानी पीना चाहिए। (*mujhe paanee peenaa chaahiye.*) पानी m sg → पीना.
8. हमें घर जाना चाहिए। (*hamen ghar jaanaa chaahiye.*)

Exercise 17C

1. मुझे अब जाना चाहिए। (*mujhe ab jaanaa chaahiye.*)
2. मुझे सब्ज़ी खरीदनी है। (*mujhe sabzee khareednee hai.*)
3. आपको आराम करना चाहिए। (*aapko aaraam karnaa chaahiye.*)
4. कल मुझे जल्दी उठना पड़ेगा। (*kal mujhe jaldee uThnaa paRegaa.*)
5. मुझे दवाई लेनी पड़ी। (*mujhe davaaee lenee paRee.*)
6. हमें आज घर जाना है। (*hamen aaj ghar jaanaa hai.*)
7. मुझे पैसों की ज़रूरत है। (*mujhe paison kee zaroorat hai.*)
8. मुझे दो किताबें पढ़नी हैं। (*mujhe do kitaaben paRhnee hain.*)

Exercise 17D

1. I need your help.
2. You should drink more water.
3. I have to go by metro every day.
4. I need a day off tomorrow. / I want a holiday tomorrow.
5. I have to wash (the) clothes.
6. What can you do — it has to be done. (the Delhi shrug of duty)

ANSWER KEY**Unit 18****Exercise 18A**

1. करूँ (*karoon*) — मैं क्या करूँ?
2. बैठें (*baiThen*) — हम कहाँ बैठें?
3. आए (*aae*) — शायद वह कल आए।
4. पिएँ (*piyen*) — चाय पिएँ?
5. हो (*ho*) — शायद बारिश हो।
6. रखूँ (*rakhoon*) — यह किताब कहाँ रखूँ?
7. सकूँ (*sakoon*) — ...ताकि मैं समझ सकूँ।
8. करे (*kare*) — भगवान करे, सब ठीक हो।
9. जाएँ (*jaaen*) — हम घर जाएँ?
10. पहुँचें (*pahunchen*) — शायद वे लोग देर से पहुँचें।

Exercise 18B

1. चलें? (*chalen?*)
2. बैठें? (*baiThen?*)
3. खाना खाएँ? (*khaanaa khaaen?*)
4. इंतज़ार करें? (*intazaar karen?*)
5. शायद वह कल आए। (*shaayad voh kal aae.*)
6. शायद बारिश हो। (*shaayad baarish ho.*)
7. अगर बारिश होगी तो हम घर पर रहेंगे। (*agar baarish hogee to ham ghar par rahenge.*)
8. अगर मौसम अच्छा होगा तो हम बाहर खाएँगे। (*agar mausam achchhaa hogaa to ham baahar khaaenge.*)

Exercise 18C

1. चलें? (*chalen?*)
2. मैं क्या करूँ? (*main kyaa karoon?*)
3. शायद वह कल आए। (*shaayad voh kal aae.*)
4. चाय पिएँ? (*chaay piyen?*)
5. अगर बारिश होगी तो हम नहीं जाएँगे। (*agar baarish hogee to ham naheen jaaenge.*)
6. अगर वह आए तो मुझे बताना। (*agar voh aae to mujhe bataanaa.*)
7. यह कहाँ रखूँ? (*yeh kahaan rakhoon?*)
8. भगवान करे, सब ठीक हो। (*bhagvaan kare, sab Theek ho.*)

Exercise 18D

1. Shall we meet tomorrow?
2. I might come late. / Maybe I'll be late.
3. If there's time, I'll definitely come.
4. Please speak slowly so that I can understand.
5. Should I make tea? / Shall I make tea?
6. God grant your day be good. / May you have a good day.

ANSWER KEY**Unit 19****Exercise 19A**

1. लिया (*liyaa*) — maine khaanaa khaa liyaa.
2. दो (*do*) — mummy ko bataa do.
3. गया (*gayaa*) — doodh khatam ho gayaa.
4. बैठा (*baiThaa*) — voh galtee kar baiThaa. (no ne — baiThnaa is intransitive)
5. डाली (*Daalee*) — maine pooree film dekh Daalee. (film (f))
6. जाइए (*jaaiye*) — aap baiTh jaaiye.
7. उठा (*uThaa*) — bachchaa achaanak ro uThaa. (ro paRaa also fine)
8. दो (*do*) — mujhe paise de do.
9. गई (*gaae*) — Tren aa gaae. (Tren (f))
10. जाएगा (*jaaegaa*) — kaam ho jaaegaa.

Exercise 19B

1. मैंने चाय पी ली। (*maine chaay pee lee.*) — chaay (f) → lee.
2. उसने मुझे सब बता दिया। (*usne mujhe sab bataa diyaa.*)
3. वह सो गया। (*voh so gayaa.*) — no ne with jaanaa.
4. काम खत्म हो गया। (*kaam khatam ho gayaa.*)
5. मैंने पूरी किताब पढ़ डाली। (*maine pooree kitaab paRh Daalee.*) — kitaab (f) → Daalee.
6. वह बड़ी गलती कर बैठा। (*voh baRee galtee kar baiThaa.*) — ne DROPS: the vector baiThnaa is intransitive, so no usne, and the verb agrees with "voh" (male). If the doer is female: वह बड़ी गलती कर बैठी। (*voh baRee galtee kar baiThee.*)
7. तुम खाना खा लो। (*tum khaanaa khaa lo.*)
8. दादी अचानक बोल उठीं। (*daadee achaanak bol uTheen.*) — respectful feminine plural.

Exercise 19C

1. मैंने खा लिया। (*maine khaa liyaa.*) — or maine khaanaa khaa liyaa.
2. मुझे अपना फ़ोन दे दो। (*mujhe apnaa fon de do.*)
3. ऑटो आ गया। (*auTo aa gayaa.*)
4. आप बैठ जाइए। (*aap baiTh jaiye.*)
5. चिंता मत करो, हो जाएगा। (*chintaa mat karo, ho jaaegaa.*) — or Tenshan mat lo, ho jaaegaa.
6. उसने हिन्दी सीख ली। (*usne hindee seekh lee.*) — hindee (f) → lee.
7. पापा को बता दो। (*paapaa ko bataa do.*)

Exercise 19D

1. It's gotten late. / We're late.
2. I've bought (gotten myself) a new phone.
3. In anger he went and said everything (blurted it all out — and regrets it).
4. Hang on, I'll just ask (I'll find out).
5. The child burst out laughing.
6. Right, done — shall we go now?

ANSWER KEY**Unit 20****Exercise 20A**

1. कि (ki)
2. क्योंकि (kyonki)
3. इसलिए (isliye)
4. जब (jab)
5. के बाद (ke baad) — khaane ke baad.
6. से पहले (se pehle) — sone se pehle.
7. जब तक (jab tak) — with naheen = "until."
8. कि (ki)
9. तब (tab) — or तो (to); both correct.
10. कि (ki)

Exercise 20B

1. राहुल ने कहा कि वह आ रहा है। (raahul ne kahaa ki voh aa rahaa hai.) — tense stays present.
2. प्रिया ने कहा कि वह कल आएगी। (priyaa ne kahaa ki voh kal aaegee.)
3. मम्मी ने कहा कि उन्हें भूख लगी है। (mummy ne kahaa ki unhen bhookh lagee hai.) — unhen = respectful "to her"; use is also heard.
4. उसने पूछा कि तुम कहाँ हो। (usne poochhaa ki tum kahaan ho.)
5. मैं चाय पीके काम करता हूँ। (main chaay peeke kaam kartaa hoon.) — peekar equally correct.
6. वह खाना खाके सो जाता है। (voh khaanaa khaake so jaata hai.)
7. हम मेट्रो में बैठके बातें करते हैं। (ham meTro mein baiThke baaten karte hain.)
8. वह नहाके ऑफिस जाता है। (voh nahaake ofis jaata hai.)

Exercise 20C

1. मुझे लगता है कि खाना बहुत अच्छा है। (mujhe lagtaa hai ki khaanaa bahut achchhaa hai.)
2. उसने कहा कि वह आ रही है। (usne kahaa ki voh aa rahee hai.) — NOT aa rahee thee.
3. मैं घर पर रहा क्योंकि बारिश हो रही थी। (main ghar par rahaa kyonki baarish ho rahee thee.)
4. जब तुम आओगे, तो हम खाएँगे। (jab tum aaoge, to ham khaaenge.) — future in both halves.
5. जाने से पहले मुझे फोन करना। (jaane se pehle mujhe fon karnaa.) — or fon kar denaa.
6. खाने के बाद हम टीवी देखेंगे। (khaane ke baad ham Teevee dekhenge.)
7. चाय पीकर वह ऑफिस गया। (chaay peekar voh ofis gayaa.) — peeke / chalaay gayaa also fine.

Exercise 20D

1. He said (that) he lives in Delhi. (His words were "I live in Delhi" — Hindi keeps the present.)
2. I know (that) you're busy.
3. When I was little, I lived in Mumbai. (female speaker — chhoTee, rehtee)
4. Until you speak up, nothing will happen.
5. She said (that) the food is ready (lit. has gotten made).
6. Bathe-and-wash and get ready — guests are coming. (mehmaan (m) guest)

ANSWER KEY**Unit 21****Exercise 21A**

1. जो (*jo*)
2. जिस (*jis*) — oblique before se.
3. जो (*jo*) — no postposition on the relative word itself.
4. जिन (*jin*) — plural oblique before ko.
5. जिस (*jis*) — jis ghar mein.
6. जो (*jo*) — jo bhee aaegaa.
7. जिसे (*jise*) — "the one to whom Hindi doesn't come." jisko also fine.
8. जहाँ (*jahaan*)
9. जिस (*jis*) — jis auTo vaale se.
10. जो (*jo*)

Exercise 21B

1. जो लड़की गाना गा रही है, वह मेरी बहन है। (*jo laRkee gaanaa gaa rahee hai, voh meree behen hai.*)
2. जो फ़िल्म हमने कल देखी, वह अच्छी थी। (*jo film hamne kal dekhee, voh achchhee thee.*)
3. जिस दुकान से हम दूध लेते हैं, वह बंद है। (*jis dukaan se ham doodh lete hain, voh band hai.*)
4. जो आदमी सोफ़े पर बैठे हैं, वे मेरे ससुर हैं। (*jo aadmee sofe par baithe hain, voh mere sasur hain.*) — respectful plurals throughout.
5. जिन लोगों के साथ हम काम करते हैं, वे लोग अच्छे हैं। (*jin logon ke saath ham kaam karte hain, voh log achchhe hain.*)
6. जहाँ शांति है, वह जगह मुझे पसंद है। (*jahaan shaanti hai, voh jagah mujhe pasand hai.*) — jagah (f), shaanti (f).

Exercise 21C

1. जो लड़का वहाँ खड़ा है, वह मेरा दोस्त है। (*jo laRkaa vahaan khaRaa hai, voh meraa dost hai.*)
2. जो चाय तुमने बनाई, वह बहुत अच्छी है। (*jo chaay tumne banaaee, voh bahut achchhee hai.*)
3. जिस आदमी से तुम कल मिले, वे मेरे ससुर हैं। (*jis aadmee se tum kal mile, voh mere sasur hain.*) — hain, not hai: respect for father-in-law.
4. जो भी आएगा, उसे चाय मिलेगी। (*jo bhee aaegaa, use chaay milegee.*)
5. जिस घर में हम रहते हैं, वह पुराना है। (*jis ghar mein ham rehte hain, voh puraanaa hai.*)
6. जो चाहिए, ले लो। (*jo chaahiye, le lo.*) — jo bhee chaahiye also perfect.

Exercise 21D

1. The woman at the door is my mother-in-law. (saas (f); hain shows respect)
2. The hotel we stayed at was cheap.
3. Don't put off till tomorrow the work that can be done today.
4. Whatever you say, I'll listen.
5. Next year we'll go (to the place) where my wife grew up. (patnee (f) wife)

ANSWER KEY**Unit 22****Exercise 22A**

1. से (*se*)
2. सबसे (*sabse*)
3. ज़्यादा (*zyaadaa*)
4. कम (*kam*)
5. जितनी (*jitnee*) — agrees with jaldee (f).
6. उतना (*utnaa*)
7. कितनी (*kitnee*) — agrees with saaRee (f).
8. से (*se*) — chaay kofee se zyaadaa pasand hai.
9. सबसे (*sabse*)
10. ज़्यादा (*zyaadaa*)

Exercise 22B

1. यह कमरा उस कमरे से बड़ा है। (*yeh kamraa us kamre se baRaa hai.*)
2. चाय कॉफी से सस्ती है। (*chaay kofee se saste hai.*)
3. तुम्हारा फ़ोन मेरे फ़ोन से नया है। (*tumhaaraa fon mere fon se nayaa hai.*)
4. दिसंबर नवंबर से (ज़्यादा) ठंडा है। (*disambar navambar se (zyaadaa) ThanDaa hai.*)
5. यह दिल्ली की सबसे अच्छी चाय है। (*yeh dillee kee sabse achchhee chaay hai.*)
6. वह क्लास का सबसे लंबा लड़का है। (*voh klaas kaa sabse lambaa laRkaa hai.*) — kaa agrees with laRkaa, not with klaas (f).
7. यह सबसे छोटा रास्ता है। (*yeh sabse chhoTaa raastaa hai.*)

Exercise 22C

1. दिल्ली मेरे शहर से बड़ी है। (*dillee mere sheher se baRee hai.*) — dillee (f) → baRee.
2. चाय कॉफी से सस्ती है। (*chaay kofee se saste hai.*)
3. यह सबसे अच्छा खाना है। (*yeh sabse achchhaa khaanaa hai.*)
4. मुझे आम सबसे ज़्यादा पसंद हैं। (*mujhe aam sabse zyaadaa pasand hain.*) — hai also accepted for a single mango.
5. जितनी जल्दी, उतना अच्छा। (*jitnee jaldee, utnaa achchhaa.*)
6. यह जगह कितनी सुंदर है! (*yeh jagah kitnee sundar hai!*) — or kitnee sundar jagah hai!
7. आज कल से ज़्यादा गरमी है। (*aaj kal se zyaadaa garmee hai.*) — or aaj kal se zyaadaa garam hai.

Exercise 22D

1. My Hindi is worse than your English. (kharaab = bad)
2. This shop is cheaper than that shop.
3. Dasherī is the finest mango (of all).
4. The more you speak, the more you'll learn.
5. What good news! (khabar (f) news)
6. This one is way (lit. "somewhere") better than that one.

ANSWER KEY**Unit 23****Exercise 23A**

1. बन (ban) — khaanaa ban gayaa: it got made (vi).
2. बनाती (banaatee) — she cooks it herself.
3. बनवाया (banvaayaa) — the halvai's hands, your order.
4. कटवाता (kaTvaataa) — the barber cuts; you get it cut.
5. सिखाती (sikhaatee) — teach.
6. सीखता (seekhtaa) — learn.
7. खिलाओ (khilaaO) — feed them.
8. दिखाया (dikhaayaa) — showed; foTo (m).
9. सिलवाया (silvaayaa) — sooT (m) suit, stitched by the tailor.
10. पिलाओ (pilaaO) — give them water to drink.

Exercise 23B

1. मैं कपड़े धुलवाता हूँ। (main kapRe dhulvaataa hoon.) — female: dhulvaatee hoon.
2. मैंने दर्जी से कुर्ता सिलवाया। (maine darzee se kurtaa silvaayaa.)
3. उसने घर साफ़ करवाया। (usne ghar saaf karvaayaa.) — karaayaa also fine.
4. मैंने बाल कटवाए। (maine baal kaTvaae.) — baal (m pl) → kaTvaae.
5. हम कुक से खाना बनवाते हैं। (ham kuk se khaanaa banvaate hain.)
6. यहाँ हिन्दी बोली जाती है। (yahaan hindee bolee jaatee hai.)
7. यह मिठाई दूध से बनाई जाती है। (yeh miThaaee doodh se banaaee jaatee hai.)

Exercise 23C

1. मम्मी बच्चों को खाना खिलाती हैं। (mummy bachchon ko khaanaa khilaatee hain.) — khaanaa optional.
2. मुझे अपना फ़ोटो दिखाओ। (mujhe apnaa foTo dikhaao.)
3. मैं हर महीने बाल कटवाता हूँ। (main har maheene baal kaTvaataa hoon.) — female: kaTvaatee hoon.
4. वह मुझे हिन्दी सिखाती है। (voh mujhe hindee sikhaatee hai.)
5. मैंने दर्जी से कुर्ता सिलवाया। (maine darzee se kurtaa silvaayaa.)
6. पापा को चाय पिलाओ। (paapaa ko chaay pilaaO.)
7. यहाँ हिन्दी बोली जाती है। (yahaan hindee bolee jaatee hai.)

Exercise 23D

1. Grandma feeds the children.
2. I had my wedding kurta stitched by the tailor.
3. Get the car fixed. (Unit 19 vector riding on the causative)
4. Show me your new book.
5. On Diwali, sweets are distributed (handed around).
6. "Sweeten our mouths" — treat us to sweets, there's good news! (khushkhabree (f) good news)

ANSWER KEY**Unit 24****Exercise 24A**

1. तो (*to*) — main to Theek hoon.
2. भी (*bhee*)
3. ही (*hee*) — aaj hee.
4. न (*na*)
5. भी (*bhee*) — ek bhee = not even one.
6. तो (*to*) — contrast with the cold food.
7. ही (*hee*) — main hee = I and no one else.
8. भी (*bhee*) — mujhe bhee.
9. न (*na*) — pleading na.
10. तो (*to*) — "then."

Exercise 24B

1. चाय वाला (*chaay vaalaa*)
2. दूध वाला (*doodh vaalaa*)
3. लाल वाली कमीज़ (*laal vaalee kameez*) — vaalee agrees with kameez (f).
4. बड़ा वाला (कमरा) (*baRaa vaalaa (kamraa)*)
5. ट्रेन आने वाली है। (*Tren aane vaalee hai.*) — Tren (f) → vaalee.
6. फ़िल्म शुरू होने वाली है। (*film shuroo hone vaalee hai.*)
7. मैं निकलने वाला था। (*main nikalne vaalaa thaa.*) — jaane vaalaa thaa also fine; female speaker: nikalne vaalee thee.

Exercise 24C

1. मैं तो ठीक हूँ। (*main to Theek hoon.*)
2. मैं भी आऊँगा। (*main bhee aaoongaa.*) — female: aaoongee.
3. खाना अच्छा है न? (*khaanaa achchhaa hai na?*)
4. छोटा वाला नहीं, बड़ा वाला दो। (*chhoTaa vaalaa naheen, baRaa vaalaa do.*)
5. बच्चों को एक-एक लड्डू दो। (*bachchon ko ek-ek laDDoo do.*)
6. मैंने सारा दिन काम किया। (*maine saaraa din kaam kiya.*)
7. ऑटो वाले से पूछो। (*auTo vaale se poochho.*) — oblique: vaale before se. poochh lo (Unit 19 flavor) even better.

Exercise 24D

1. That's exactly what I was saying!
2. The milkman is about to arrive (right now / any moment).
3. I didn't eat even one samosa — honest! (sach = true)
4. Wow yaar, you totally nailed it! (chhaa jaanaa — lit. to spread over everything)
5. The work's done, right? Good — the One upstairs will take care of everything else.
6. Hindi? I know a little bit (of it). (lit. a little-little comes to me)